

Chicago Tribune



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Judge lifts mail voting order hurdle

Democratic officials file new challenges as midterms loom

By Nicholas Riccardi
and Lindsay Whitehurst
ASSOCIATED PRESS

A federal judge Wednesday lifted a major obstacle to President Donald Trump's executive order limiting mail voting, even as Democratic state officials filed a new court challenge with the midterm elections fast approaching.

The fresh round of legal wrangling comes two days after the

Supreme Court handed down a procedural ruling in Trump's favor, and could mean the issue lands before the high court again before the pivotal contests for control of Congress.

The first mailed ballots are set to be sent out next week.

U.S. District Judge Indira Talwani in Boston agreed to lift an order prohibiting the U.S. Postal Service from carrying out Trump's order for November's elections. She

wrote that she was "compelled" to do so after the Supreme Court's conservative majority ruled that a similar injunction she granted in a separate case was premature.

Talwani nevertheless said the executive order could unleash "chaos" and referred to it as "likely unconstitutional."

The administration can now move forward and implement a Postal Service rule published late Friday. It would require states to

follow a uniform envelope style for mail ballots and to give the Postal Service a list of voters eligible to receive them.

A new lawsuit, filed by 25 Democratically controlled states against the U.S. Postal Service, marked a new phase in the high-stakes litigation.

It came after the Supreme Court ruled against them in a separate case, but did not say Trump's order was legal.

The high court majority found the initial Democratic lawsuit was premature, but that was before the

Republican administration issued a rule governing Postal Service delivery of mail ballots.

Election officials warn it will be impossible to implement before the first wave of mail ballots are sent out next week.

"Across the country, states are already deep into preparations for the 2026 elections. Now, at the last moment, the federal government is attempting to meddle in those preparations and potentially threaten countless Americans' right

See **VOTING** on Page A9

Surrounded by supporters outside St. Sabina Church, the Rev. Michael Pfleger, center, celebrates being reinstated on Wednesday after an allegation of sexual abuse dating back to the 1990s was deemed not credible. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

‘The archdiocese’s process is unjust, and it’s broken’

Reinstated St. Sabina pastor challenges the church’s child abuse inquiry procedures

By Allison Kiehl
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The grand concrete steps in front of St. Sabina Church were packed Wednesday morning as parish members crowded to stand with their newly reinstated pastor, the Rev. Michael Pfleger, both physically and spiritually.

A jovial energy enveloped the crowd of around 100 community members, Leo Catholic High School students and St. Sabina staff members, who stood shoulder to shoulder. Many wore custom T-shirts bearing slogans such as “Ain’t no pastor like the one I got” and “Truth will reveal.”

Cheers erupted as Pfleger, the church’s pastor for over 40 years and a community advocate, took to the microphone.

Pfleger spoke at a central podium not only to announce his renewed position at the church in the Auburn Gresham neighborhood, but also to challenge the Archdiocese of Chicago’s process for investigating child sexual misconduct, a system he has encountered multiple times in recent years.

“Brothers and sisters, the archdiocese’s process is unjust, and it’s broken,” Pfleger said. “There is no balance, nor fairness. Without a simple investigation, a

background check or even an interview, a priest can be removed and told to find a place to live and to find a lawyer to represent you at your own expense.”

This came after Pfleger himself was on leave for more than a month while the Archdiocese of Chicago investigated an allegation that he sexually abused a female student at St. Sabina 30 years ago. He was on leave from his South Side parish from July 11 until Monday, when Cardinal Blase J. Cupich reinstated him. The claims were ultimately deemed unfounded. This was the fifth time Pfleger has faced abuse allegations since 2021, with all

previous claims unsubstantiated as well.

Pfleger alleged that the current investigation process in cases of child sexual abuse assumes guilt until the accused person is proved innocent, contrary to United States legal ethics.

“The problem with the process in simple terms is that it’s too quick to accuse and to remove a priest, and too slow to resolve it,” said Pfleger’s lawyer, Jim Figliulo.

The archdiocese’s process of reviewing any misconduct allegations of child sexual abuse is thorough, according to Mayra Flores,

See **PFLEGER** on Page A4

NIPSCO applies for rate increases

Utility seeks up to \$7.33 a month in hikes as storm restoration continues

By Maya Wilkins
POST-TRIBUNE

Following a devastating Aug. 11 derecho that hit northwest Indiana and left hundreds of thousands of residents without power, the Northern Indiana Public Service Co. filed three electric rate increases with the Indiana Utility Regulatory Commission.

According to commission documents, NIPSCO filed three rate increases either on or after Aug. 11. One was filed Aug. 11, and the remaining two were filed Aug. 14 and 20.

The three rate increases will add up to \$7.33 per month, according to IURC documents and Citizens Action Coalition Program Director Ben Inskeep.

“I think this illustrates a broader problem with Indiana policy and how we regulate our utilities,” Inskeep told the Post-Tribune Tuesday. “The General Assembly has passed law after law over the past two decades that gives our utilities the ability to add these tracker mechanisms or build surcharge mechanisms that allow for these frequent rate changes in between base rate changes.”

Inskeep said the increases are trackers, which “allow the utility to recover expenditures on an ongoing basis by adjusting rates on a quarterly or biannual basis for certain categories of costs,” according to the Citizens Action Coalition’s website. Trackers allow utilities to recover costs, and if they underspend, they pass back a credit to customers.

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INSIDE



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Sox outfielder on a hitting hot streak

White Sox outfielder Tristan Peters is on a hot stretch at the plate, having hit a home run in four straight games. “He’s been incredible,” Sox starter Anthony Kay said. **Sports**

Himalayan disaster kills at least 160

Massive flash floods in a border area of Nepal and China on Wednesday killed at least 160 people and left hundreds of others missing. **Nation & World, Page B4**

Unaccompanied kids getting deported under DHS policy



State Sen. Cristina Castro speaks about unaccompanied immigrant children being targeted for deportation removal in court during a press conference on Wednesday at the National Immigrant Justice Center in Chicago’s Loop. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Children being denied due process in Chicago court, attorneys allege

By Madeline Buckley
and Caroline Kubzansky
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The boy who faced Immigration Court Judge Shawn Abraham needed the microphone lowered before his hearing could begin. His feet didn’t reach the floor.

He is 12 years old.

The lawyer and advocate who sat with him at the respondent’s table told Abraham that he had no caregivers in El Salvador, where Abraham would order him deported moments later.

He was one of more than a dozen unaccompanied minors without legal status who appeared

at Chicago Immigration Court Wednesday for a hearing that was unprecedented until recently. During the proceedings, an immigration judge entered removal orders against some of the children, despite their attempts to seek a long-held legal protection to remain in safety in the United States due to abuse or neglect.

Attorneys, advocates and elected officials said the Trump administration began employing the tactic against unaccompanied children in recent months, violating the rights of the children, many of whom have pending petitions for special immigrant juvenile status. Coupled with a loss of a federal government contract that covered legal services for children who enter the U.S. without

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Tribune books

“He Had It Coming: Four Murderous Women and the Reporter Who Immortalized Their Stories” “Chicago The Musical” played on Broadway for more than 9,600 performances since it premiered on Nov. 14, 1996, yet not many people know the characters of Roxie Hart, Velma Kelly and others are inspired by real women. Their stories were captured by Tribune reporters. This book includes original newspaper clippings, Watkins’ stories and a new analysis.

“Dinner at Home” Cooking at home doesn’t have to be difficult, but it should always be delicious. Jean-Marie Brownson, culinary director for Rick Bayless’ Frontera Foods, helped readers put inventive, yet simple, dishes on the table through her Dinner at Home column for the Tribune. Her book includes everything you need to create spectacular food any day of the week.

“Gangsters & Grifters: Classic Crime Photos From the Chicago Tribune.” This collection of photographs taken in the early 1900s through the 1950s features infamous criminals, small-time bandits, smirking crooks, pickpockets, hoodlums and wiseguys at crime scenes.

“Ask Amy: Advice for Better Living” For more than a decade, Amy Dickinson was the Tribune’s signature general advice columnist, helping readers with questions both personal and pressing. This book, which collects columns from 2011 to 2013, is a testament to her empathetic counsel and practical common-sense tips.

“Culture Worrier: Reflections on Race, Politics and Social Change.” Clarence Page’s newest book commemorates the 30th anniversary of his column’s first appearance in the Tribune. It is the first such collection of the Pulitzer Prize winner’s columns, covering topics such as politics, social issues, pop culture, race, family, new media and prominent figures, as well as his personal life.

“10 Things You Might Not Know About Nearly Everything.” You may never need to know the human body contains a half-pound of salt, but that’s just one of the obscure facts you’ll find about sports, history, religion, politics, arts and culture, food and leisure, and science and technology in this collection of columns from Mark Jacob and Stephan Benzkofer.

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Accuracy and ethics

The Tribune’s editorial code of principles governs professional behavior and journalism standards. Everyone in our newsroom must agree to live up to this code of conduct. Read it at chicagotribune.com/accuracy.

Corrections and clarifications: Publishing information quickly and accurately is a central part of the Chicago Tribune’s news responsibility.

- A photo caption on Wednesday’s Page 1 misstated the date on which workers were performing maintenance on CTA Blue Line tracks. They were performing the work on July 23.
- A photo caption on Wednesday’s Page 5 incorrectly stated the date when Dynegy Midwest Generation disclosed that it would reinforce the bank of the Middle Fork of the Vermilion River to halt erosion. The date was Aug. 7. The Tribune regrets the errors.

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Chicago and news: Phil Jurik, pjurik@chicagotribune.com
Sports: Amanda Kaschube, akaschube@chicagotribune.com
Opinion: Chris Jones, cjones5@chicagotribune.com

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Ashli Watts, with her two children, Phthalo Seriguchi, 3, and Saadiq Seriguchi, 3 months, attends the launch of Kennedy-King College’s midwifery program on Tuesday. Watts, a doula, is applying to join the inaugural class of midwives. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

‘This is a calling’ Kennedy-King College set to launch midwifery degree program

By **Kate Perez**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Ashli Watts’ gaze drifted between her children, attention split between her toddler in the chair in front of her and the 3-month-old in her arms. They were part of the reason she sat in an academic building in Englewood Tuesday morning, listening intently, then smiling at the announcement she hopes will help her change the lives of mothers across the city in a few short months: the new midwifery program at Kennedy-King College.

The school, part of City Colleges of Chicago, launched the new licensed certified professional midwifery associate degree program in partnership with the Black Midwifery Collective, a South Side nonprofit that aims to transform maternal outcomes. Midwifery offers a holistic approach to pregnancy and giving birth — for example, facilitating non-medicated births at home or in birthing centers and other monitored environments with a licensed midwife.

Beyond that, it is also seen as a potential way to combat prevalent maternal health crises, especially for Black women in Illinois, who, according to a 2025 Illinois Department of Health report, are more than twice as likely to die from any pregnancy-related condition and three times as likely to die from pregnancy-related medical conditions than white women.

The program is slated to teach students interested in midwifery over six semesters, including a new simulation lab complete with a home birthing center, before they apply for a state license to practice as a midwife, according to a news release. The Black Midwifery Collective worked with Kennedy-King and City Colleges of Chicago to develop programming to combat the need for mater-



Star August Ali, right, Black Midwifery Collective executive director and founder, hugs board member Alicia August-Wright during the launch of Kennedy-King College’s midwifery program on Tuesday.

nal healthcare options in the city, the collective’s founder and Executive Director Star August Ali told the Tribune. The program serves as “one way that we would be able to access this life-giving training to be able to come back to serve our communities,” she said.

The program’s location is intentional, too, Ali said, adding that she strategically chose the South Side because of its predominantly Black community. One of her biggest hopes is that the program will not only produce midwives of color who will then practice on the South Side, but also serve as a replicable model for other states that lack accredited midwifery programs, she said.

“This is a very huge one, and not only for Black and brown midwives, but for midwives all across the world, all across the country, because it’s setting up what will be the blueprint for the rest of the country,” Ali said. “It’s going to have a huge impact ... because it is centered in communities that need it the most.”

Classes begin in spring 2027 and the program is currently accepting applications for its first cohort, which Watts hopes she will soon join.

While she has yet to take her first class toward earning an associate degree, Watts’ presence in the maternal healthcare sphere took root years ago.

She currently works as a doula, a nonmedical professional who offers physical, emotional and educational support throughout a person’s pregnancy and postpartum period. Her passion for the work began when she and her sister had challenging experiences during their own pregnancies. It’s what led Watts to have a doula for the birth of her second child and to pursue the practice herself.

Becoming a certified midwife would take those practices a step further, she said, including addressing the needs of women who live in what are known as obstetric or maternal health deserts, or areas where women-centered health and pre- and postnatal care are scarce.

“I am very much interested in taking it up a notch, being more hands-on during the process of children coming into the world,” she said.

Tuesday’s launch served not only as an announcement of the new program but also as a celebration of the work it took to get there.

Much of that effort began as underground midwifery

practices by Ali and other organizers who worked to offer holistic birth options and combat the deaths of Black birthing people, according to Earline “Mekazin” Alexander, co-founder and executive director of Chicago-based reproductive justice organization BA NIA Inc.

Overall, the new program will offer people a path to learn midwifery, prepare to become certified midwives, and practice that care on the South Side of Chicago and other vulnerable communities, Alexander said. For her, it’s a calling.

“Who better knows the community than those who live in the community, than those who work in the community, than those who serve in this community?” Alexander said. “... The program at Kennedy-King is a declaration of our autonomy.”

For hopeful cohort member and applicant Emmaline Jones, that calling is echoed throughout her family tree.

Jones’ ancestry includes multiple midwives, healers and wellness practitioners — a path that has become clearer and more desirable to her as she’s aged. Coupled with the traumatic modern birthing experiences that some of her relatives have endured, Jones is hoping to gain entry into the program and continue not only her family’s tradition, but the larger midwife community’s.

“I’m from this neighborhood, and for me, why it’s so important to be a part of this, is holding onto a legacy of being able to provide wellness to our community, as well as safe options for Black women,” Jones said. “... For me, it’s to be able to hold on to my ancestral lineage, to reconnect with that, but also to bring forth even more wellness and healing for the next generation, and really, it’s about protection of our spiritual knowledge and legacy.”

Peekachu, a beluga whale rescued from Canada, dies at Shedd

By **Finnegan Belleau**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Peekachu, a 23-year-old beluga whale rescued from a closed marine park in Canada, died at Shedd Aquarium on Tuesday, staff announced in an online post.

She was blind in one eye but had little trouble socializing, according to the post. The whale wasn’t consistently eating her full diet, Shedd said, and blood samples taken Tuesday showed she was dehydrated and needed “supportive care.” Peekachu died suddenly that night while aquarium staff cared for her.

More details on her death weren’t available yet, according to the post, but Shedd planned to share an update as soon as possible following a medical examination.

The whale was one of eight belugas brought to Shedd from Marineland of Canada, a closed marine park in Niagara Falls, Ontario. The park’s owners threatened to euthanize 30 whales, according to a previous Shedd news release.

Facilities across the U.S. and Spain plan to rescue all of



Peekachu, one of four beluga whales relocated from a facility in Canada, swims with other transferred whales at Chicago’s Shedd Aquarium on July 23. **JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE**

them, according to the news release. A Shedd spokesperson confirmed Wednesday the aquarium still plans to rehome two additional belugas, bringing the facility’s total to 17.

This isn’t the first time belugas transferred from Marineland died at a facility in the U.S. Three whales brought to Mystic Aquarium in Mystic, Connecticut, in 2021 died afterward. A representative for the aquarium previously told the Tribune in an email that the deaths were

due to preexisting conditions undetectable in live animals.

Canadian nonprofit Animal Justice said in a news release the death of Peekachu seemed to be a “direct consequence” of transporting her in compromised health. Canadian officials appeared to have rushed export permits after Marineland of Canada’s owners threatened to euthanize the whales, according to the news release.

“Peekachu’s death is devastating but not surprising,” Kaitlyn Mitchell, direc-

tor of legal advocacy, said in the release. “Transporting sick belugas is a death sentence for those animals, yet the Canadian government has apparently signed off on export permits for all 30 Marineland whales without ensuring they were healthy enough to withstand the stress of transport.”

Beluga whales are found globally in Arctic and sub-Arctic waters, according to the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration. Many are near Alaska.

Some beluga populations are listed as endangered or depleted. Weighing an average of 3,150 pounds, the whales have been hunted for subsistence, commerce and sport.

In late July, Karisa Tang, lead veterinarian and vice president of animal health at Shedd Aquarium, said the remaining two belugas would be rescued within the next several weeks. Staff previously declined to provide a more specific timeline on when those rescues might take place or when the whales would be visible to the public.

ELECTION 2026

Pritzker pounces on Trump in bus tour kickoff

Governor says bid for 3rd term ‘about working people’

By Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Gov. JB Pritzker took aim at a familiar political target Wednesday as he kicked off a statewide campaign bus tour, blaming Republican President Donald Trump for many of Illinois’ struggles during the Democratic governor’s nearly eight years in office, while focusing less attention on his actual GOP opponent in the November election.

His bid for a rare third term as governor is “about working people, about affordability, about making sure that people have what they need to get ahead, and also that we’re protecting them from the damage that Donald Trump and his administration is doing in Washington, D.C.,” Pritzker said outside the Adler Planetarium, flanked by Christian Mitchell, his running mate for lieutenant governor.

Pritzker has intensified his criticism of Trump, his most ardent political foe, with some 70 days until the Nov. 3 election to hammer home for voters in deep blue Illinois that the race for governor is just as consequential as a presidential election, arguing that Trump’s policies have had an adverse effect on the state.

Pritzker has also sought to use second-time opponent Darren Bailey’s association with Trump to his advantage. The conservative former lawmaker from southeastern Illinois has, in the past, enthusiastically supported the president, who endorsed Bailey in his first run for governor in 2022 — a race Bailey lost to Pritzker by nearly 13 percentage points.

Trump has lost Illinois by more than 10 percentage points in each of the last three presidential elections and has this year seen low approval ratings, with the war in Iran



Gov. JB Pritzker and running mate Christian Mitchell greet people on the lakefront while kicking off a bus tour during his reelection campaign on Wednesday near the Adler Planetarium in Chicago. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

taking a toll on the U.S. economy.

“We’ve done a great job of fending off the very difficult circumstances that Donald Trump and his administration have put on the state of Illinois, continuing to balance budgets, for example, while also providing people with backup support for, well, healthcare and for food assistance that’s been taken away by the federal government,” said Pritzker, the billionaire heir to the Hyatt Hotels fortune, who is considered a possible 2028 presidential contender. “So, in this campaign ... we’re talking a lot about both protecting the state from that onslaught, but also about advancing the cause of getting jobs.”

Pritzker didn’t mention Bailey in his brief opening remarks outside the planetarium, only invoking his oppo-

nent by name in response to questions from reporters.

“Donald Trump is very unpopular because he’s put an enormous burden on the people of this country and the people of Illinois, and I think that the fact that he’s still got a little bit of power within the Republican Party is maybe evidence that Darren Bailey won his primary with Donald Trump’s support,” Pritzker told reporters.

Bailey and his running mate, Aaron Del Mar of Palatine, meanwhile, appeared outside a Tyson Foods plant in northwest Illinois on Wednesday after the company earlier this month announced it was laying off about 2,500 workers at its beef facility in Rock Island County. Bailey wasted no time attacking Pritzker and his policies, saying “his administration has failed” on

replacing lost jobs.

“JB Pritzker immediately pointed towards Washington and national economic conditions. The cattle shortage is real, but so is Illinois’ economic record,” Bailey said. “After nearly eight years in office, Pritzker cannot take credit every time a business opens and blame Washington every time one closes.”

Asked about Bailey’s criticism over the Tyson plant closure, Pritzker called the layoffs there a “terrible situation.” The governor said he’s spoken with a top company official who told him Tyson is willing to sell the facility to another firm. But Pritzker pivoted to criticizing Trump and pointed to national trends, noting rising beef prices and Tyson’s closure of at least one other facility, in Utah.

Despite his focus on

Trump and the impact of the president’s policies on Illinois, Pritzker took shots at Bailey while speaking to reporters, calling him a “Donald Trump sycophant” who is “going to lose in November.” Pritzker also reiterated his criticism of the former state senator from Xenia from last week when Bailey defended curricula used at the Full Armor Christian Academy, which Bailey founded, that teaches children the scientifically disproven idea that dinosaurs and humans walked the earth at the same time.

Earlier this week, the Bailey campaign slammed Pritzker for his rhetoric about Full Armor Christian Academy, alleging that a threatening message was sent to the private school. Bailey said authorities are investigating and he called it “reckless” for

Pritzker and his campaign to lob criticism at a school filled with children.

After Pritzker’s bus tour kicked off outside the Adler Planetarium, his campaign stopped about 2 miles west of the Loop for a rally with the International Union of Painters and Allied Trades District Council 14. It was an opportunity for the governor to pay tribute to union members who are key Democratic allies, and it happened the same day Pritzker received an endorsement from the influential International Union of Operating Engineers Local 150, which represents more than 24,000 construction workers and other tradespeople.

At the painters union hall, Pritzker talked about what he views as threats from the Trump administration to union workers, and Mitchell — a former state lawmaker from Chicago who served as one of Pritzker’s top aides during the governor’s first term — told a cramped room of union members and campaign supporters that unlike leaders “that fight for you,” Bailey wants to do the opposite.

“Our opponent, dangerous Darren Bailey, Donald Trump’s favorite lap dog, wants to take us right back to those bad old days under (former Republican Gov.) Bruce Rauner,” Mitchell said in his opening remarks, alluding to the anti-union agenda of Pritzker’s predecessor. “He’s using the same old demagoguery we often hear from the Republican Party, still beholden to corporate special interests and crony capitalists, like his boss, President Trump.”

Later in the day, Pritzker signed measures into law that would establish a regulatory framework for high-speed e-bikes, e-scooters and electric unicycles. The law goes into effect next year.

His office also announced that the state had received its 11th credit upgrade from one of the major Wall Street ratings agencies since 2021.

After cuts, CPS says it’s restored more than 300 full-time positions

By Kate Perez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As students returned to campuses this week, Chicago Public Schools has rehired more than 300 full-time employees.

Nearly 150 of those rehires are employees who were laid off this summer and are returning to their previous positions, as requested by their principals, Deputy Chief Talent Officer Jerry Taylor said during a virtual budget update Tuesday evening.

Earlier this month, the district said the money allocated in its amended \$10.1 billion budget won’t be enough to restore all 700 positions cut as it aimed to close a \$732 million shortfall. It’s unclear how many more teaching positions will be filled, but CPS officials said they will work to place available employees in positions that principals have identified as critical. However, \$100 million in state funds,

as designated in the amended budget, will not be enough to restore all the jobs that were slashed, district officials said Tuesday.

Still, district officials touted that CPS’ teacher vacancy rate had shrunk to 1.6% for the 2026-27 school year, an improvement over the 2.2% reported earlier this month. By comparison, the district had a 2.5% vacancy rate the year before.

The vacancy rates for special education staffers and bilingual teachers also improved since the previous budget update on Aug. 18, with both reporting a similar figure of 1.8% for the 2026-27 school year. Earlier this month, the district reported the special education staff vacancy rate was 2.4% and the bilingual teachers’ vacancy rate was 2.1%.

“When we think about vacancies, I want you to know that those aren’t empty classrooms. There are faces, there are children in those class-

rooms, and it’s very important that we’re able to identify and hire staff to fill those vacancies across the city,” CEO Macquiline King said. “I just wanted to restate that we’re making strides, but we still have some areas of growth to make on the South and the West sides of Chicago.”

The update comes as the district continues to battle financial uncertainty that is creeping into the school year.

CPS is considered only 70% funded under the state’s funding formula, and, to put pressure on lawmakers, the school board approved an amended budget in July that includes \$150 million in unconfirmed state funds. The amended budget also requires the district to restore the slashed positions.

District leaders previously warned that midyear cuts would be necessary if the funds don’t materialize, a message that King reiterated at Tuesday night’s meeting after spending time with



Students line up to enter the building on the first day of school on Monday at Leland Elementary in Chicago’s Austin neighborhood. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

lawmakers in Springfield last week.

While the meetings included talks about building ongoing relationships and expanding our advocacy, King did not say the district secured the funding it is banking on, instead calling it an “ongoing process.”

“In our conversations with lawmakers, we stressed

that if we do not receive the additional funding that we need ... we will be forced to make disruptive midyear cuts to our classrooms, and that has been our priority to protect classrooms,” King said. “However, in the event this year, if we do not receive the additional \$150 million, then we will be forced to look at and consider cuts to the

classroom.

Going forward, the focus is on ensuring the district is fully funded, she added.

“We’re going to continue to advocate for additional state funding. We are going to continue to implement the (fiscal year) budget, and we will continue to update you on how the budget is performing,” King said.



Chicago police and U.S. Postal Inspection Service police investigate the scene where a U.S. mail carrier was shot and killed in the West Pullman neighborhood on July 19, 2024. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Third person charged in 2024 killing of letter carrier

By Sam Charles
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A third person has been charged in connection with the 2024 killing of a U.S. Postal Service letter carrier on the Far South Side, authorities announced Wednesday.

Lyndell Deyoung, 35, faces two counts of murder in the July 19, 2024, shooting death of Octavia Redmond, 48, in the 12100 block of South Harvard Avenue, according to Chicago police. Deyoung was scheduled to make his initial

court appearance Wednesday.

“Through the course of the detectives’ investigation, a witness related that the 2024 killing of a U.S. Postal Service letter carrier on the Far South Side, authorities announced Wednesday. Lyndell Deyoung was the offender who planned the murder of Octavia Redmond,” Deyoung’s arrest report states. “Cellphone records also indicate his involvement and planning/arranging of the murder.”

In October 2024, a 15-year-old boy was also charged in the killing. The Postal Service said at the time that the

teen “exited a stolen white Dodge Durango, approached Redmond in the vicinity of South Harvard Avenue and West 122nd Street, and shot Redmond multiple times at close range.”

The teen pleaded guilty last month and was sentenced to five years in the Cook County Juvenile Center.

The day after the shooting, Chicago police investigators found the stolen vehicle burned out on the South Side. Another man was charged with arson in

connection with the vehicle fire. Court records show he pleaded guilty to arson last month and was sentenced to one year of probation.

Those who lived near the shooting scene previously described Redmond as a good-natured and friendly mail carrier.

“She was a really nice lady,” said resident Todd Lindberg, 56. “(She) did her job. She would go out of her way. If a letter came in after she passed your house she’d come back.”

Johnson orders vendors to disclose immigration enforcement contracts

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson signed an executive order Wednesday requiring city contractors to disclose past work done for other governments and law enforcement agencies — including immigration enforcement — but stopped short of banning them from doing business with the city.

Speaking at a news conference at Arise Chicago, an immigrants rights nonprofit, the mayor touted the move as the latest example of his administration standing up to President Donald Trump following last fall's mass deportation blitz in Chicago. The order comes amid a spate

of announcements from Johnson's office that could double as moves he touts as progressive wins for his base heading into the 2027 election.

It's not clear what practical effect, if any, the mayor's new disclosure rules will have. Asked what they would mean for existing city contracts, Johnson said, "The first step is to turn the light on, right?"

"It's about creating more of a transparent, open process for discovery," he said. "In terms of its ramifications, I believe ultimately the goal is to make sure that we are protecting taxpayers, right?"

In the next 60 days, current contractors and

subcontractors must disclose whether they've gotten over \$500,000 from governments or law enforcement agencies in the last five years, according to an announcement from the mayor's office. Vendors must also say whether they've faced investigations over civil rights violations including excessive force and unlawful detention. Those with more than \$100,000 in city contracts have to disclose workplace violations and charitable donations.

Johnson opened up his remarks by quoting his favorite Bible verse: "For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."

"Chicago spends billions of dollars every year purchasing goods and services. That

is our treasure, and today we're making it very clear where our heart is," he told reporters. "Our heart is with the immigrant families who have endured the fear and intimidation of the Trump administration's Midway Blitz assault, which launched almost a year ago."

But he also acknowledged that his order does not actually ban companies who have done business with U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement or Customs and Border Patrol from getting city contracts.

The new decree also calls for the chief procurement officer and a newly formed task force to come up with rules on how to address vendors with public integ-

rity violations. It follows an executive order from Johnson this month cracking down on — but also not banning — data center proliferation in Chicago. The mayor said it is up to the City Council to pass an actual moratorium.

And it also follows executive orders Johnson signed earlier this year calling on both Chicago police to investigate federal immigration agents and ban them from city property.

The latest executive action also reflects the mayor's position after three years of tough battles with aldermen. Johnson sees little opening to pass new legislation thanks to an obstinate opposition bloc that has defied him again

and again, but some of the most ardent progressives in his coalition have felt a resurgence of enthusiasm for his leadership under Trump's second term that has put Chicago and other liberal cities in the federal government's crosshairs.

On the issue of immigration enforcement, at least 21 aldermen have now signed onto a pledge to reject corporate and political action committee donations from companies connected to ICE. Though many were unlikely to receive such money anyways, the issue could serve as an animating force for communities across the city that remain angry at Trump's deportation campaign in Chicago.

PFLEGER

from Page A1

director of the Chicago Archdiocese's office of assistance ministry. When a claim is brought forward, be it recent or from decades ago, Flores' office meets with both the accuser and the accused. Afterward, the church official is temporarily removed from their position until an unbiased investigator determines if the claims are substantiated.

The cardinal has final say to accept the board's decision regarding the church members and reinstate them, or he can ask for more information, according to Flores.

After decades of sex abuse scandals in the Catholic Church, the Archdiocese of Chicago adopted policies and programs to "address the scourge of child sexual abuse and to support survivors."

Cupich previously told the Tribune all reports of abuse are reported to civil authorities and thoroughly investigated by an independent review board.

"Every allegation is taken seriously, and I know that's hard for some people to understand because it would be difficult for someone to just come and make an allegation," Flores said. "Each one is taken seriously, which is the



Backed by supporters, the Rev. Michael Pfleger, foreground center, holds a news conference outside St. Sabina Church in Chicago on Wednesday. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

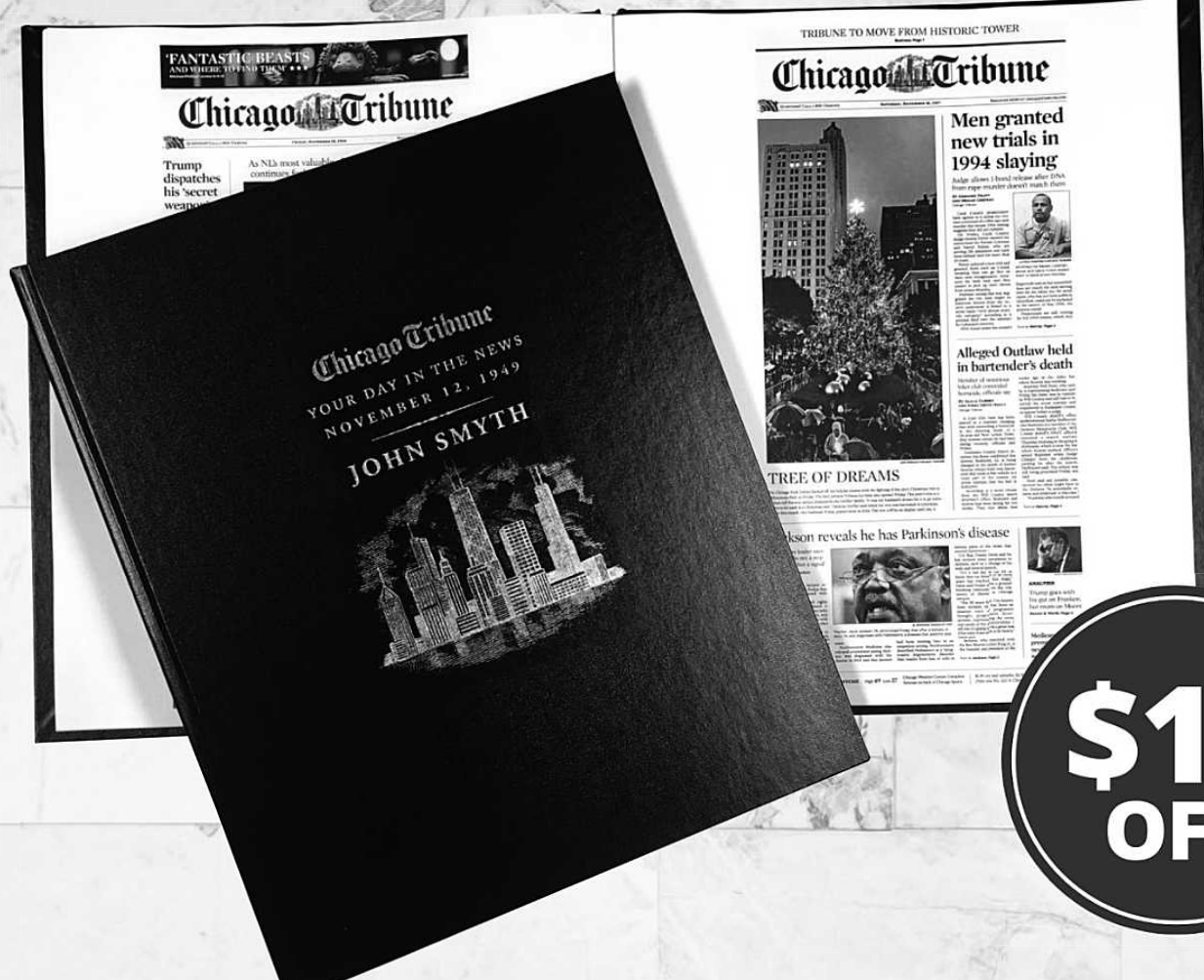


Joyce Maltbia looks on as the Rev. Michael Pfleger holds a news conference outside St. Sabina Church on Wednesday.

priests coming behind him. Everything he does is never just for done for him; it's done for others, as well," Hammond said.

With his child sexual misconduct investigation behind him, Pfleger will return to heading St. Sabina's Sunday services this weekend. Additionally, he will resume attending regular church outreach and social justice activities, including peace walks and marches.

"While you have thrown dirt at me, you have simply caused me to grow deeper roots so that I can grow taller and I can bear new fruit," Pfleger said. "I am not going to remain silent and I will not be silenced. In fact, I am going to turn up the volume on justice, on righteousness, on truth and on love."



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Long-simmering dispute in Oak Lawn boils over

Arab American activists rally, say police mistreated 14-year-old

By Olivia Stevens
DAILY SOUTHTOWN

Nearly 100 people rallied Tuesday outside Oak Lawn Village Hall ahead of the Village Board meeting, alleging police mistreated a 14-year-old at a previous Police and Fire Commission meeting.

Oak Lawn police in a news release Tuesday said the teen used obscene language during the public comment period at the Aug. 5 Police and Fire Commission meeting, and a woman interfered when officers attempted to escort the teen away from the podium.

But the Arab American Action Network says the boy was grabbed by multiple officers, picked up and slammed into a counter in the back of the public hall and placed in a choke hold before being pushed out of the room and forced to leave the meeting. Illinois law prohibits police from using a choke hold as a form of restraint unless deadly force is justified.

Ghada Morrar, who was charged with misdemeanor obstruction of justice, disorderly conduct and assault, was the boy's mother, activists say. They allege that like her teenage son, she was violently grabbed when forced to leave.

Organizers with the Arab American Action Network have shown up regularly to Police and Fire Commis-



Oak Lawn police observe public comment from members of the Arab American community during the Oak Lawn Village Board meeting on Tuesday. Activists allege an Oak Lawn officer put a teen in a chokehold during an Aug. 5 public meeting. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

sion meetings since 2022, protesting alleged officer misconduct. Recently, police say activists have “engaged in disruptive conduct that has interfered with the Commission’s ability to conduct its official business.”

“This conduct has included shouting obscenities at commissioners, physical confrontations with police officers, knocking over chairs, and refusing to comply with lawful requests intended to restore order. Juveniles have also been encouraged to attend and participate in

disruptions of Commission meetings,” the Police Department said in its news release.

But activists told the Village Board Tuesday that officers, not members of the public, were to blame for erupting tensions. Bill Beaulieu, an organizer with Southsiders for Peace, said if Police and Fire Commission Chair Jim Baker “can’t take being called a name, he should probably consider resigning, possibly getting some help.”

Yousef Masood said “many will call the Oak Lawn police incompetent” after the last

Police and Fire Commission meeting.

“While this is clearly true, incompetency can only go so far,” the 22-year-old from Chicago said. “You don’t accidentally assault a 14-year-old child and arrest a mother.”

Village Board members did not respond to similar concerns raised by more than a dozen people during Tuesday’s meeting.

Activists were quick to remind the Village Board of long-standing issues of racism within the Oak Lawn Police Department, including the

beating by a police officer of a 17-year-old that led to a lawsuit the village settled for \$825,000.

They have also continued to question how police handled the death of Murod Kurdi, a 28-year-old Palestinian American who was hit by a car outside his Oak Lawn home in June 2023. The driver told police she had alcoholic drinks before getting behind the wheel and in December 2023 was found guilty of failing to reduce speed and fined \$750.

An Illinois State Police

report found Oak Lawn police did not have probable cause to charge the driver with drunken driving.

“So no, I’m not surprised that the Oak Lawn police just 20 days ago used an illegal choke hold against a small boy,” said Muhammad Sankari, organizing director of the Arab American Action Network.

“And you all shouldn’t be surprised that we’re going to continue to be here, again and again. Because you have made it very clear, and the Oak Lawn Police Department has made it very clear, that you are not interested in any kind of justice, you are not interested in any kind of accountability,” he added.

Police said Wednesday they completed an investigation of the disturbance at the Aug. 5 meeting and said misdemeanor charges of obstructing a police officer were filed against Amira Altamimi, 21, of Chicago, Kobi Guillory, 29, a Chicago middle school teacher and leader of the Chicago Alliance Against Racist and Political Repression, and Ghada Morrar, 35, of Oak Lawn. Morrar also faces misdemeanor charges of disorderly conduct and assault.

The vehicle Guillory was traveling in was surrounded by multiple squad cars Tuesday night before police took the teacher into custody, the Chicago Alliance and Arab American Action Network said in a news release Wednesday.

ostevens@chicago
tribune.com

NIPSCO

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“So, NIPSCO builds into their base rates that customers pay a certain amount for each of these three types of things that are covered by these trackers,” Inskeep said. “... Really, these trackers are a way to benefit NIPSCO shareholders by reducing uncertainty about cost recovery and reducing what’s called regulatory lag, which is the time period from when NIPSCO spends a dollar to the time period that they’re recovering that dollar plus the profit margin from customers.”

One of the three trackers is for regional transmission organization adjustment, another is for fuel adjustment, and the last is resource adequacy adjustment.

On Monday, Indiana Gov. Mike Braun asked the Office of the Utility Consumer Counselor to file a complaint and petition the IURC to investigate NIPSCO following prolonged power outages. Inskeep said that would be a “separate and independent investigation” that doesn’t affect these rate increases, which are on a routine and schedule to specific statutory requirements.

However, this doesn’t mean that northwest Indiana residents shouldn’t be frus-

trated, especially as NIPSCO customers pay the highest bills in the state, according to the IURC’s annual residential bill survey.

“It’s not only frustrating for customers in Gary to lose power for two weeks, but when the power is back on, they see that NIPSCO has three rate increases in the hopper,” Inskeep said. “That adds insult to injury. But it’s also highlighting this problematic dynamic we have in Indiana, where utilities get everything they want from the General Assembly, and consumers get very little protections and are paying very high rates.”

In a late Tuesday statement, NIPSCO disputed that the filings constituted a rate increase.

“The regulatory filings made in August are routine quarterly or semi-annual proceedings previously authorized by the Indiana Utility Regulatory Commission (IURC),” the company’s statement read. “These filings recover NIPSCO’s fuel costs, regional transmission organization costs and resource adequacy and reliability costs, as well as allow NIPSCO to pass back credits to customers resulting from the benefits provided by NIPSCO’s renewable energy resources, including production and investment tax credits and excess energy sales.”

STORM RECOVERY EFFORTS STILL UNDERWAY

At about 4 p.m. Wednesday, 630 NIPSCO customers were still without power. Of those, 352 were Gary residents. Gary, Portage and Lake Station residents went the longest without power, according to previous updates from NIPSCO, as they were slated to receive power Tuesday, two weeks after the Aug. 11 storm. Lake Station still had 32 people without power Wednesday afternoon, and Portage had 77.

Following the Aug. 11 derecho, crews from Commonwealth Edison, Illinois’ largest electric utility, had about 410,000 people without power. The utility restored power in about five days, said spokesperson John Schoen.

ComEd called in about 2,000 contractors in addition to its employees to help. Following the completion of its storm restoration, Schoen said, ComEd put NIPSCO in touch with its contractors, and the utility worked with about 40 crews previously.

On Saturday, NIPSCO asked for 30 crews to help, Schoen said, and ComEd sent 32, which included 64 line workers and some support employees. “All in all, it’s about 80 employees that are there right now working with NIPSCO to get their system back up,” he said.

NIPSCO said it is priori-

tizing completing necessary repairs as power restoration edges toward completion.

“We do not compare our restoration efforts to other utilities as each electric system, damage profile, service territory and restoration event is unique,” the company’s statement read. “Our focus remains on the extensive damage sustained across NIPSCO’s transmission and distribution systems and safely restoring service to our customers.”

United Steelworkers Local 12775, which represents NIPSCO workers, called for stronger investment in permanent local utility staffing, emergency preparedness, workforce development and public transparency in a Tuesday news release. The union said reliable utility service is essential to public safety, healthcare, education, economic development, manufacturing, emergency response and quality of life.

According to its release, the union wants increased local frontline staffing to meet approved regulatory levels; strengthened storm response capabilities and emergency preparedness; expanded workforce development opportunities; prioritization of qualified local workers and established regional contractors; greater transparency around staffing, vacancies, storm restoration

performance, contractor utilization and workforce investments; and continued regulatory focus on reliability, workforce adequacy and emergency readiness.

“Investing in Local 12775 members and other qualified local utility workers is an investment in safer neighborhoods, faster restoration, stronger reliability, and family-supporting careers,” Union President Ryan Baker said in a news release. “Our members have earned the respect of their communities through their work ethic, technical skill, and commitment to service. They deserve the staffing levels, training, tools, and support necessary to continue doing that work at the highest level.”

In July 2011, more than 860,000 ComEd customers were without power due to a derecho that hit the Midwest, according to the Chicago Tribune. Following that storm, ComEd began making “a lot of” investments to its system, Schoen said.

“This includes technology that we put on the grid that helps when there’s a circuit or on a beater, it’ll help sort of isolate that problem and reroute the power so that it doesn’t impact as many customers as it might have otherwise,” Schoen said.

The utility also installed a Hendrix cable, which is thicker and more tree resis-

tant.

“This cable helps those braces sort of bounce off the lines instead of blasting right through them,” Schoen said.

However, the severity of the storm also impacts restoration, Schoen said, adding that the Aug. 11 derecho had 100 mph winds and the soil this year was more saturated due to higher rainfall.

“That’s part of the reason why this storm was so impactful,” Schoen said. “But in any event, that technology is helping us prevent outages.”

This year, about 2.4 million ComEd customers were affected by weather, Schoen said, but if it weren’t for technology upgrades, the utility estimates that another 2.7 million would’ve been without power. ComEd has meteorologists on staff who keep an eye on weather, so the utility is prepared for whenever the next major storm hits.

“We really feel that this sort of extreme weather is not a fluke,” Schoen said. “We think there’s a good chance that we’re going to be seeing more instances of this kind of extreme weather. So coming out of all the storms, we always look at the system, we always try to talk about what we can do better, (and) we always try to look for ways we can improve our processes.”

mwilkins@chicago
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JUDGES

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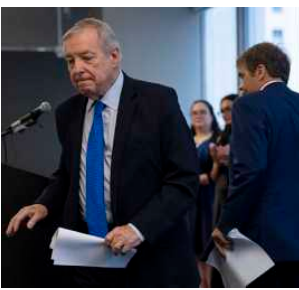
a parent or guardian, the practice creates a crisis for migrant children, who may be deported back to dangerous situations, they say.

“We failed those kids,” said state Sen. Cristina Castro, D-Elgin, pausing to apologize as she became tearful at a press conference held blocks from the site of the court call.

Retired immigration judge Jennie Giambastiani, who was the designated judge for Chicago’s juvenile docket for 17 years until she left the bench in 2019, said judges in the past had significant latitude to administratively close this kind of juvenile case while kids had their petitions adjudicated. Now, she said, “it’s become a numbers game.”

“I’m just distressed to see how children have become pawns of this immigration game,” she said. “I don’t see how it harms the U.S. to await adjudication of an administrative agency for a petition as opposed to cutting it off at the knees for purposes of meeting deportation quotas.”

Beginning on May 10, immigration officials announced that children who applied for special immigrant juvenile status are no longer



U.S. Sen. Dick Durbin finishes speaking Wednesday about unaccompanied immigrant children in Chicago being targeted for deportation removal in court under a new policy. BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE

automatically protected from deportation while they wait to become lawful permanent residents.

Federal officials had tried to roll back the automatic deportation freeze for SIJ applicants in 2025, but were stymied by an order from a federal judge in New York. In April, though, U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services issued a new policy that lets those previously automatic protections be adjudicated in cases that began after May 10.

At the press conference, attorneys signaled they would fight the new policy in federal court. In response to a request for comment, representatives with the Department of Homeland Security referred

to a press release from June that alleged “rampant fraud” in the process to seek special immigrant juvenile status.

Federal and state officials lambasted President Donald Trump and Chicago-based immigration court judges who they say are violating the legal rights of the children and potentially sending them back to abusive situations in their countries of birth.

“Did you think you saw the worst of the worst with ICE when they were shooting people in streets of Chicago, Minneapolis and other cities?” U.S. Sen. Dick Durbin said.

Immigration judges acting on behalf of the Trump administration have begun ordering deportations for children who have been deemed abandoned, abused, or neglected by their parents, even though they have pending petitions to legally remain in the country, attorneys say. State juvenile court judges have determined the children have faced abuse or abandonment, which allows them to seek special immigrant juvenile status as a pathway for legal permanent residence.

“The Trump administration’s mass deportation agenda is escalating its attacks on children,” said Michael Hoyt, managing attorney at the National Immigrant Justice Center. “The admin-

istration has weaponized the court system against them and violated their due process.”

During the proceedings on Wednesday, Abraham entered removal orders for at least six children.

Abraham — a former Cook County state’s attorney and assistant counsel to ICE — is brand-new to Chicago’s immigration court. He joined a court whose lineup of judges has seen drastic changes since the second Trump administration began and which recently became the national leader in deportation orders, owing in large part to what court observers and advocates have dubbed “mega-master” hearings.

Those hearings, which can produce dozens of removal orders at a time, and the firings and buyouts of the court’s longtime judges are both widely regarded as products of the administration’s efforts to remake the country’s immigration court system in the image of the president’s hardline immigration agenda.

The attorneys were able to prepare the children that faced the judge on Wednesday, said Laura Smith, executive director of the Children’s Legal Center. But when judges began ordering deportations earlier this summer,

it took the children and their attorneys by surprise, leaving the children sobbing after the hearings, she said.

“These children fled to the United States seeking safety and protection from the horrors that no children should have to endure, children who have been kidnapped, children whose parents have been killed and who have been completely abandoned by their families,” she said.

In the case of the 12-year-old boy, Abraham ordered him removed to El Salvador. Unlike most of the children who come to immigration court with their parents beside them, the only adults with the boy were an advocate and an attorney.

As he issued the deportation orders, Abraham repeatedly said that the children could not remain in the country while their applications for legal status waited in the queue with U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services because Congress had put a cap on the number of visas available, creating an “uncertain and lengthy period of time” before the children’s petitions could lead to legal status.

The advocates who came with the children to court passed out small fidget toys from a plastic gallon bag. They waited quietly, some

for more than two hours, in the benches of Courtroom 8, while Abraham set most of their next court dates to early September, denied motions to terminate pending cases and ordered children removed from the U.S.

Again and again, advocates and lawyers for the children told Abraham that they had no caregivers in their home countries or that they were considered abandoned by their parents. Most had been in the country for less than a year.

The final child to be called for his hearing had been in the U.S. since Nov. 22, 2025. He sat leaning forward at the table as Abraham walked through his reasoning for deporting him. Abraham then asked if he had any questions.

Speaking in Quiché through his interpreter, the boy did have a question.

“Why are you sending me back to Guatemala?” he said.

“You didn’t necessarily do anything wrong,” Abraham said. “But you are removable from the country based on the way you entered the country. Since you are removable, that’s why you are being ordered removed back to Guatemala.”

The boy had no other questions.

The Associated Press contributed.

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EDITORIALS

A suburban challenge to Chicago’s monopoly on Lake Michigan water makes major waves

Are the local water wars beginning?

Agencies representing more than 35 west and northwest suburbs announced plans Monday to build their own system for extracting and distributing Lake Michigan water in their communities. The two agencies, the DuPage Water Commission and the Northwest Suburban Municipal Joint Action Water Agency, unveiled a proposal that would spend up to \$6 billion to construct an intake facility in the lake off of north suburban Glencoe, pipe the water to a treatment plant to be built on 80 acres in Northbrook purchased just two years ago by the DuPage commission, and distribute the liquid from there to 1.5 million residents.

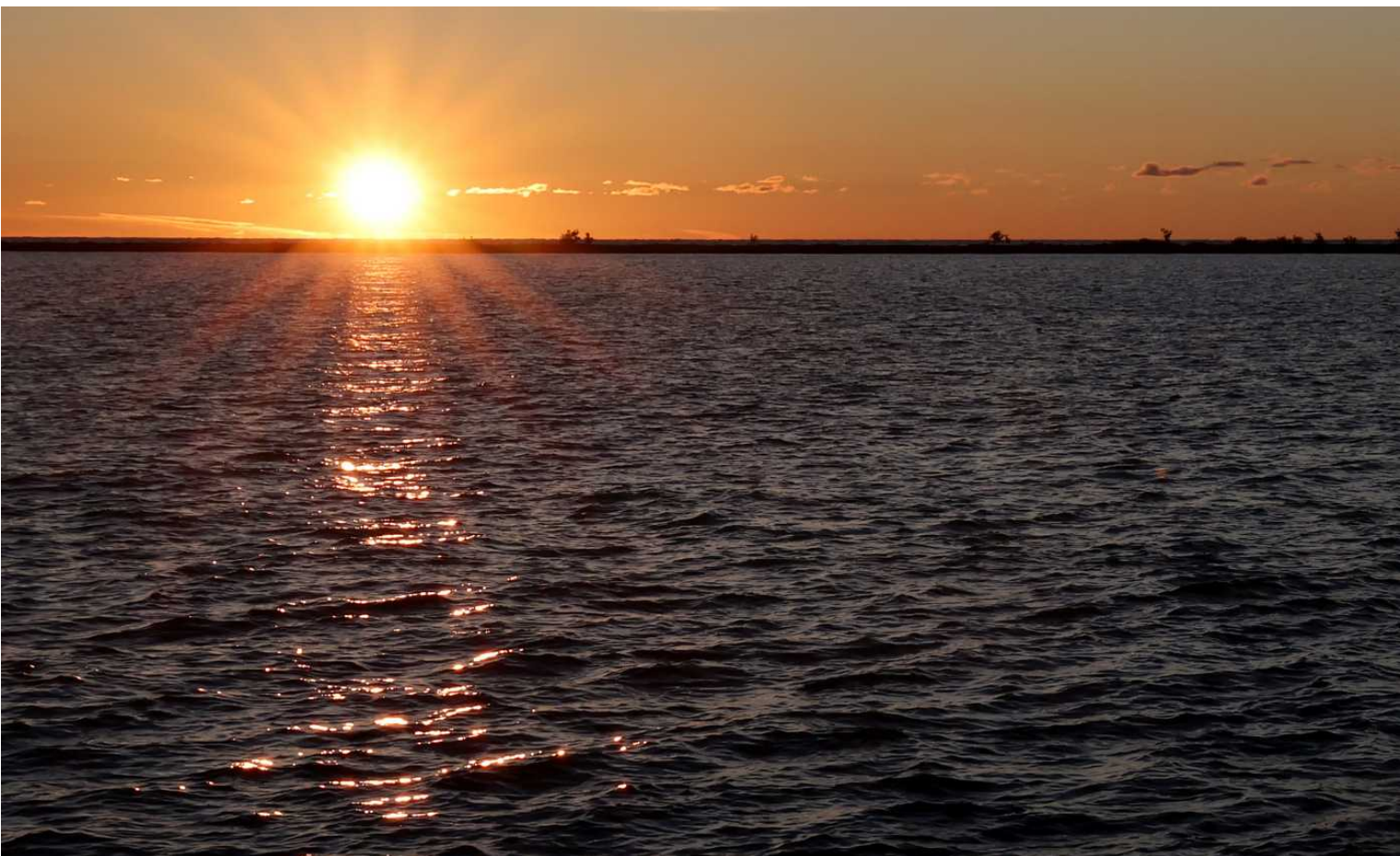
The big loser if this ambitious plan is realized? The city of Chicago, which has supplied water to these suburbs for decades.

The DuPage commission alone is paying Chicago’s Department of Water Management \$130 million this year, commission Chair Jim Zay told the Tribune Publishing-owned Daily Herald. The DuPage consortium is Chicago’s single largest wholesale customer, accounting for 15% of the city water system’s annual operating revenue, according to Fitch Ratings.

The threat to Chicago is several years away; the DuPage commission is contracted to buy water from the city until 2041. But that’s how long it would take to secure approvals, financing and build the competing system anyway.

The backers of the suburban plan complain that Chicago in the past has raised its rates suddenly and exorbitantly and that more recently the city’s service hasn’t been sufficiently reliable. “They don’t put anything back into the system; that’s the problem,” the Herald quoted Zay as saying. “This year we’ll pay them \$130 million, and they put nothing in for infrastructure.”

It’s understandable for suburbanites to want to be in control of such an essential service. And



Sunrise over Lake Michigan on Aug. 29, 2025. Many communities in the Chicago area receive their water from the lake. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

there’s reason, given Chicago’s precarious financial state, to worry about being beholden to the city.

What’s more, Chicagoland is blessed with a vast freshwater resource that many other regions envy. Another big straw in Lake Michigan won’t pose an environmental threat.

Unsurprisingly, Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson doesn’t like the idea.

A city spokesman told the Daily Herald that the project would require state legislation, multiple permits and “public capital subsidies.”

“The city continues to engage in conversations with the (DuPage Water Commission) and other stakeholders centered on maintaining a reliable supply of high-quality drinking water,” the spokesman said.

Whatever conversations are occurring clearly haven’t stopped the suburbs from taking concrete steps to go their own way.

We would suggest that the city pick up the pace of those discussions with an eye toward reassuring its biggest customer that it makes more sense to continue with its established water provider over the long haul rather than go to the tremendous expense of duplicating the service.

We live in an interconnected region after all, and water is much like electricity — a commodity that’s capital-intensive and so essential that it lends itself to utility-like treatment. Public resources aren’t infinite and emphasizing a regional approach to this issue theoretically would preserve that capital for investing in other priorities.

But in order for the city to succeed, it must convince these suburbs that it’s a reliable partner over the long haul, that it can be trusted. We’re not sure how doable that is, but that’s the task.

And if these suburban officials conclude that the risk of continuing to do business with Chicago for generations to come is greater than executing this complex and expansive infrastructure project, that’s their prerogative. To our minds, it’s not an easy call.

We can say this with certainty: If a new water system is what’s in the offing, future Chicago mayors will have to buckle up. The city will need to replace that large chunk of revenue evaporating some 15 years from now, and its new suburban competitor will be just that.

A competitor.

The new suburban service will be capable of serving more than 20 more communities home to another 775,000-plus people beyond the jurisdictions already in the two participating member organizations, officials said.

At least Chicago just inked a 100-year deal to serve Joliet that takes effect in 2030.

There are sure to be other suburban and exurban localities now on well water that will look for future access to Lake Michigan water as depletion of existing aquifers continues. There may well be opportunity in years to come for both Chicago and its potential suburban rival to serve a growing customer base.

If so, competition in this utility-like arena may end up being more beneficial than appears to be the case right now.

The AI vultures are monetizing the dead. Your old emails might be worth millions

If you recently left a job, it’s likely you lost access to your old inbox and the saved records of those tedious Zoom or Teams meetings. Leaving such digital detritus behind now is part of life. But we doubt you anticipated your employer being able to make money from what you had to say while gainfully employed.

Consider what just happened with the remains of what used to be Spirit Airlines, the bankrupt ultra-low-cost air carrier. Earlier this month, Google was the winner of a highly competitive auction not for the dead airline’s

planes or equipment but for the corpse’s data trove. Reportedly, the treasure included 100 million emails and 500 million Teams messages, not to mention a ton of lines of code.

Why did Google blow \$10 million on such seeming scrap? To train its artificial intelligence agents.

We’ll try not to get too in the weeds here, but in essence the Spirit purchase was like buying a massive business-school case study with bots as the intended students.

By seeing what humans did in

actual life, the AI creepy-crawlies can learn about, well, what humans did in actual life. It doesn’t matter if they did what they did well (and, in the case of Spirit, it all failed in the end). It’s all about using this specific business as a way for AI to learn how an airline actually operates in real life or, yet more generally, how humans typically work together in organizations.

And you thought those AI agents were merely ingesting books and newspapers. Nope. They are looking at your old out-of-office replies and ill-con-

sidered rants on Teams.

Google has said the data will be randomized before it is used, protecting people’s privacy. You’ll have to take Google’s word for that. But even aside from that genuine concern (there are, after all, 100 million emails), there is something dystopian about these hungry bots dissecting a failed human endeavor like birds of prey picking over a roadkill creature’s entrails. They’re figuring out where the dumb humans screwed up and how artificial intelligence can do better next time. And, apparently, we’re all perfectly OK

with that.

If you are an AI evangelist, you likely would cheer such an exercise as an excellent use of \$10 million.

For example, Spirit endured many passenger letters of complaint. This will help AI respond to future such gripes.

So where are you going to be working tomorrow?

Once the AI takeover is writ yet larger, sooner than you think, we might well be wondering why we so willingly handed over so many of the keys to our shared human kingdom.

ON THIS DAY 106 YEARS AGO RENT GOUGING

The sugar profiteer is a popular man about town these days compared with the rent gouger. ... the landlord is beyond condoning and out of the reach of mercy.

When the American people find a new trouble their instinct is for a new law, and in the present emergency, with citizens trying to keep roofs over their heads, the instinct is for a statute which will prevent the landlord from raising the roof by boosting the rent.

Some attempts at legislation have been made and more are demanded. ... One of the things that makes the rent high is the increase in materials and labor which makes a scarcity of houses. What makes the rent higher is the desire of the owner to get every red cent he can out of his investment. We have had some experience in regulating the profits from investments and some regulation is accepted in public policy. ... Other limitations were adopted as war measures but have no place in the normal life of the nation. Rent legislation is the longest step taken or proposed. There is something of the bolshevist in every citizen who thinks that combinations of men or circumstances are taking

advantage of him. The regulation of rents is a piece off the Moscow bolt of goods, but the average renter would not recognize it as such.

It is disturbing and harmful to public good to have the housing of families uncertain. Therefore there is the impulse to correct the public injury by invading the private rights of the owner. ...

If the state may tell a landlord how much he may charge a person whom he permits to occupy his property the only moral justification would be that the duty of the community is to make it possible for citizens to have homes. ... The state is entitled, in behalf of people who need homes, to say to the owner of a house that he must receive one or two other persons into his house as lodgers upon a fixed rental.

It would be contrary to public policy to have unused rooms in many houses and many people without rooms. Moscow would go to the logical conclusion in a minute. We might regulate rents, but hesitate to billet lodgers in the spare bedroom.

**Tribune editorial board,
Aug. 27, 1920**

EDITORIAL CARTOON



BILL BRAMHALL

OPINION



Supporters of the Rev. Michael Pfleger pray at St. Sabina Catholic Church in Chicago on July 17 when he faced sexual abuse allegations. The Chicago Archdiocese announced Monday that Pfleger has been cleared of wrongdoing. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Pfleger has been cleared of wrongdoing, but more needs to be done

By Jeffery M. Leving
SPECIAL TO THE TRIBUNE

The good news is that for the fifth time since 2021, the Rev. Michael Pfleger, pastor at St. Sabina Catholic Church in the Auburn Gresham neighborhood, has been cleared of any wrongdoing, after being accused of sexual abuse earlier this summer.

The Archdiocese of Chicago issued this announcement in a Monday news release. I expected nothing less. Pfleger has vehemently denied any wrongdoing each time an allegation was brought, and each time, he has been cleared after an investigation, making him perhaps the most investigated priest in the archdiocese's history.

I must ask: As things stand now with the archdiocese, has anything been done to ensure that frivolous allegations cannot be lodged, which force Pfleger to be sidelined while they are investigated?

Some may believe multiple allegations over time equate to something of

substance. I implore these people to realize that each time an allegation has been made, Pfleger has been extensively investigated and cleared. At this point, I wonder if the accusers may have an ulterior motive and whether the archdiocese should consider investigating them.

More important than that, however, the archdiocese needs to change how it handles accusations. Yes, each allegation needs to be taken seriously and investigated, and accusers should be heard and should not be shamed. However, this is 2026, and the pendulum has swung too far. Allegations now receive the consideration they deserve, but sadly, in some cases, mere allegations may be perceived by some as a finding of guilt.

I know the impact of this type of ordeal because I have defended multiple clients over the years who were falsely accused of abuse. Even though they were ultimately cleared, it takes a huge toll and affects their reputation no matter the result.

Pfleger is aware that his fearlessness in criticizing mayors, presidents or church leaders while speaking out and standing up against gun violence and social injustice has made him a target among some who do not agree with him. However, disagreement over his politics or the way he brings attention to uncomfortable topics does not make him a child abuser.

It's also important to realize that with someone well-known like Pfleger, the magnifying glass is larger. Notably, the allegations often make front-page news, but the exoneration gets less press, leaving many with the false impression that he must be guilty.

Pfleger himself and his parishioners, the vast majority whose support has not wavered, have tried to make this point to the archdiocese. They did so in a July letter urging the archdiocese to update its policies. They specifically object to the public announcement of an allegation and the automatic removal of a priest from ministry before any investigation has taken place.

In their letter sent to church leadership, they call it "unjust and unnecessary," particularly in cases in which the alleged abuse occurred more than a decade ago and the accused has not faced any allegations of misconduct in the intervening years. That is the case with each allegation that Pfleger has faced.

I believe, as the St. Sabina community does, that allegations of abuse should be fully and fairly investigated. I also believe, as these parishioners do, that the current process is unfair. There appears to be nothing stopping someone else from bringing a new allegation tomorrow or the next day or the day after that, forcing Pfleger and his flock to undergo another investigation that forces him from his ministry for months at a time.

This is wrong and needs to change.

Attorney Jeffery M. Leving is a specialist in fathers' rights. He also is a recipient of a 2023 Presidential Lifetime Achievement Award.

America needs its mayors to engage with the world

By Nina Hachigian
SPECIAL TO THE TRIBUNE

Mayors have always had one of the hardest — and most important — jobs. On any given day, mayors must make streets safer, prepare for extreme weather, attract jobs and investment, protect public health, earn residents' trust and, increasingly, protect their communities from democratic backsliding.

At a time when many challenges landing on a mayor's desk no longer stop at city limits, mayors need to learn from one another both at home and abroad. Yet a narrative has recently emerged that mayors and other local leaders are overstepping when they engage internationally — that building relationships with counterparts abroad amounts to a parallel foreign policy.

I see it differently. I have worked on both sides of this divide — as the first U.S. special representative for city and state diplomacy, inside Los Angeles City Hall as deputy mayor for international affairs and now as CEO of the Alliance for Local Leaders International (ALLIES), which helps local leaders learn from one another across borders.

Those experiences have shown me that the more responsibility mayors have for their residents' everyday lives, the more important it is that they have the freedom and capacity to work with counterparts around the world. Doing so can create jobs, solve shared problems, foster better understanding of diasporas and enrich cultural life at home.

Chicago offers a useful example. Mayor Brandon Johnson recently led a mission to Rome alongside nearly four dozen business, civic and faith leaders. Beyond strengthening Chicago's relationship with Pope Leo XIV, a Chicago native,



Mayor Brandon Johnson talks with Eugenio Patane, left, Rome's deputy mayor for mobility, and Andrea Sciotti, right, technical director at Roma Metropolitana, while touring a train station on May 29 in Rome after meeting with Pope Leo XIV the previous day at the Vatican. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

the trip also gave the delegation an opportunity to learn from Rome's experience with clean energy and innovative approaches to powering metro stops — an exchange of ideas that can directly benefit Chicagoans at home.

Chicago is hardly alone. In 2022, as the U.S. special representative for city and state diplomacy, I built a team to help mayors, governors and other local officials navigate international concerns. Over two-plus years, we connected with about 5,000 local leaders from all political parties and across the country, fielding questions ranging from helping constituents stranded overseas to boosting engagement with Ireland to determining whether someone claiming to be from the Chinese embassy actually was.

We provided many localities with customized foreign-direct-investment profiles and briefed hundreds on China's aggressive local-level outreach,

so leaders could engage with eyes open. In return, the State Department gained ground truth about what Americans actually cared about. We also saw how local ties could strengthen official bilateral relationships and how local leaders could advance practical cooperation on issues such as clean, affordable energy.

Now, at ALLIES, my team starts from a simple reality: Mayors are tackling challenges no city should face alone and that national governments aren't always addressing quickly or effectively. That includes deploying artificial intelligence responsibly, preparing for extreme weather, protecting biodiversity and defending democratic institutions.

Given these challenges, I hear more mayors asking: Who has solved this problem, and what can we learn from them? Sometimes, another American city has the answer. Sometimes, it's one overseas.

If Rotterdam improved flood resilience, shouldn't New Orleans learn from it? If Seoul has modernized city services, shouldn't American cities study that? If Warsaw has strengthened civic participation, shouldn't that inform communities here?

There's a straightforward, overlooked economic logic too. Mayors lead trade missions to open markets for local businesses, and economic development offices compete for foreign investment such as a factory or headquarters. Most recently, 11 American cities hosted World Cup matches and benefited from the resulting relationships, cultural connections and tourist dollars. If America wants to compete globally, our cities need more international expertise and better coordination.

But international issues also arrive at City Hall whether mayors seek them out or not. The Israel-Hamas war sparked protests and tension in cities nationwide, including Chicago. COVID-19 showed how quickly a public health crisis crosses borders. Cyberattacks can take down municipal water systems from thousands of miles away. Migration reshapes schools, shelters and budgets.

Mayors on the front lines don't get to opt out simply because these issues originate elsewhere. They turn to one another because they have to.

The same holds for democracy. We are not immune from the worldwide rise of authoritarianism — and mayors need each other's help. The Pact of Free Cities emerged in 2019 because local leaders in Central Europe were confronting autocrats in their national governments. As those governments centralized power and weakened independent institutions, city govern-

ments became some of the last places where transparency, everyday freedoms and accountability survived.

Today, local officials in America face similar pressures, including federal attacks on leaders, their residents and their funding. Learning from cities that have navigated these pressures can help American leaders govern more effectively.

To be sure, a city's diplomacy should be transparent: Residents deserve to know why their mayor is traveling, what partnerships their city has entered and what taxpayers get in return. But we can demand that cities engage wisely without making it harder for them to engage at all.

President Donald Trump's administration closed the State Department unit I ran after my departure. Restoring that capacity would mean giving local leaders the information and expertise they need to navigate foreign governments' outreach, understand the risks and opportunities, and make smarter decisions. China's increasingly sophisticated local diplomacy efforts alone make the case for maintaining that expertise.

In a rapidly changing world, helping local leaders learn from one another across borders may just be one of the most practical investments in stronger communities, more resilient cities and a more competitive America.

If we fail to equip our cities for the world that is coming, we risk surrendering one of our greatest sources of American strength.

Nina Hachigian is CEO of Alliance for Local Leaders International (ALLIES). She was the first U.S. special representative for city and state diplomacy and an ambassador to the Association of Southeast Asian Nations.

OPINION

After decades of sanctions on Iran, who has actually paid the price?

By Pegah Banihashemi
SPECIAL TO THE TRIBUNE

On Monday, the United States opened another chapter in its decadeslong campaign of economic pressure against Iran. The Treasury Department launched Operation Economic Outcast, describing it as an unprecedented economic campaign aimed at further isolating the Islamic Republic and those who enable it.

The objective sounds straightforward: Deprive Tehran of money, and it will have less to spend on missiles, military operations and armed groups across the Middle East. But this follows decades of sanctions. Americans should ask: Who has actually paid the greater price, the Islamic Republic or the Iranian people?

Without question, sanctions can hurt the Iranian government. They have constrained trade and oil sales while pushing Tehran to rely increasingly on elaborate shadow banking, shipping and financial networks to move money and evade restrictions. The Treasury Department says its pressure campaign has disrupted billions of dollars in projected oil revenue and led to the freezing of nearly half a billion dollars in regime-linked cryptocurrency.

Those are meaningful results. But economic pain does not stop at the doors of government ministries or Revolutionary Guard compounds.

Iranians woke up to yet another sharp fall in the value of their currency, with the U.S. dollar reaching roughly 2 million Iranian rials on the open market. For ordinary families, a currency collapse is not an abstract economic indicator. Its effects can quickly affect the price of food, medicine and other basic necessities.

When I speak with family and friends in Iran, I hear a new anxiety in their voices. The fear of another war has not disappeared, but it is now accompanied by the fear of soaring prices and economic collapse. They tell me that they are already feeling the effects in the cost of basic food.

The burden is especially harsh for retirees on fixed incomes, many of whom depend on medi-



Street vendors wait for customers around Tehran's Grand Bazaar on Monday. VAHID SALEMI/AP

cations. When the currency falls and prices rise, food and medicine become competing necessities. Ordinary people are absorbing the most immediate consequences of economic pressure.

Food and medicine are not generally the stated targets of U.S. sanctions. But humanitarian exemptions on paper do not necessarily translate into accessible goods in Tehran, Shiraz or Isfahan. When banks fear processing Iranian transactions, shipping becomes difficult, suppliers withdraw and payment channels disappear, ordinary commerce can become more expensive.

Indian exporters have warned that the combination of new U.S. sanctions and the United Arab Emirates' suspension of trade and financial transactions with Iran could severely disrupt Indian exports of rice, tea and pharmaceuticals, much of which has been routed through Dubai. Trade between India and Iran has already fallen by more than 90%.

Fundamentally speaking, in

regard to sanctions, what is the measure of success? If success means making Iran poorer, economic pressure can accomplish that. If success means making international commerce more difficult for Tehran, sanctions can accomplish that too. But if the objective is to fundamentally change the behavior of the Islamic Republic, the record is considerably more complicated.

The Iranian government has spent decades learning how to survive sanctions. It relies on intermediaries, shadow banking networks, front companies and unconventional payment mechanisms to maintain access to the international financial system. Indeed, the Treasury Department continues to announce new sanctions precisely because these networks continue to operate. In recent months, the Treasury Department has described Iranian shadow banking networks that process tens of billions of dollars in trade each year.

Just days before announcing

this latest campaign, the Treasury Department sanctioned another network that it says was moving as much as hundreds of millions of dollars to Hezbollah outside the formal financial system. That should prompt reflection.

After years of "maximum pressure," Iran and its allies are still developing methods to move money. Tehran still possesses military capabilities. Its government remains authoritarian and repressive. And Washington continues searching for new ways to cut off the same networks that previous sanctions were supposed to disable.

None of this means sanctions have accomplished nothing. Nor does it mean the United States should ignore Iran's nuclear ambitions, missile program, support for armed groups or repression of its own citizens. But it does mean we should distinguish between targeting a government and impoverishing the society living under it.

There is a legitimate case

for targeted sanctions against government officials, Revolutionary Guard commanders, weapons procurement networks and individuals responsible for repression. Freezing the overseas assets of an official responsible for human rights abuses is fundamentally different from policies that contribute to the collapse of an entire country's purchasing power.

Authoritarian governments also possess something ordinary citizens do not: the ability to decide who absorbs economic pain. When foreign currency becomes scarce, the government can prioritize its security institutions. When international banking channels disappear, politically connected networks develop alternatives. When inflation destroys household savings, however, a teacher, pensioner or shopkeeper has no shadow banking network.

Iran has nearly 90 million people. Those people are not interchangeable with the government ruling them. Many have protested that government, demanded political change and paid an extraordinary price for doing so. American policy should not make their lives increasingly unbearable and then point to their suffering as evidence that pressure on Tehran is succeeding.

The United States is entitled to defend its interests and confront genuine security threats from the Islamic Republic. But every foreign policy instrument should ultimately be judged by what it accomplishes — not merely by how much pain it can inflict. After decades of sanctions, Washington should therefore ask a question more difficult than whether it can make Iran's economy hurt.

Does making ordinary Iranians poorer actually make the Islamic Republic less dangerous? If the answer is still uncertain after decades of trying, another round of ever-harsher economic isolation deserves scrutiny, not celebration.

Pegah Banihashemi, a native of Iran, is a legal scholar and journalist in Chicago whose work focuses on human rights, constitutional and international law, and Middle East politics.

Voice of the People

Representative of the best in us

Dolly Parton was caring, generous, smart and kind, a good businesswoman and beloved by people of all backgrounds. She knew what she didn't know and would have joyfully recruited people who knew more than her to her staff or a Cabinet.

She represented beautifully what's best in America. Rest in peace, Dolly.
— Mark McKelvey, Chicago

Appropriate tribute to Parton

So many flowers have been laid in tribute to Dolly Parton. I think (and Dolly would agree) that if just one flower was purchased and \$10 donated to a food pantry in her name, that would be a better tribute to a remarkable woman.
— Jacqueline Nussbaum, Wilmette

'Jolene' offers important lesson

Congratulations to Chris Jones ("Why I Loved Parton and her Dollywood," Aug. 26) for his truly original and historically significant front-page homage to Dolly Parton — the "one American" who "belongs to everyone," as Jones accurately notes — as well as for Tess Kenny's excellent, down-to-earth coverage ("How do we go back to normal?" Chicagoans mourn death of Parton," Aug. 26) of Chicagoans' tribute outside Edgewater's Lytle House at the mural honoring the legendary queen of country music.

America, not just the industries and institutions Parton gently touched, has lost a wonderful human being and perhaps the one American everybody in America genuinely loved and admired.

She never took explicit political sides. But if I had to choose one of Parton's teachings that would make a positive difference today and in the years to come at the White House, the Pentagon, Capitol Hill and the Supreme Court, it would be what she implores Jolene to do in her unforgettable 1973 song by the same name: Don't use power against anybody "just because you can."

"Jolene, Jolene, Jolene. I'm begging of you, please don't take my man. ... Please don't take him just because you can."

Parton taught us, directly and indirectly, why we should care about our fellow human beings,



Dolly Parton performs "Hello God" with a church choir at the Country Music Association Awards show on Nov. 6, 2002, in Nashville, Tenn.

M. SPENCER GREEN/AP

no matter our gender and sexual orientation, no matter our skin color, no matter our political preferences and no matter our economic realities and privileges — all while always uplifting those who needed to be uplifted.

Thank you to Parton for all she did and how she did it! Rest in peace.
— Alejandro Lugo, Park Forest

Parton earned her plaudits

Don't get me wrong. I liked Dolly Parton as much as the next guy or gal, but her demise is being treated as though a head of state has passed. In fact, flags have been lowered to half staff through the weekend. But then we do love our celebrities, don't we?

At least on this occasion, the plaudits have been earned, and her modesty precedes her to the grave.

Safe travels, Dolly!
— Bob Ory, Elgin

Parton never forgot her roots

It's difficult to believe that singer-songwriter, actress, businesswoman and philanthropist Dolly Parton is no longer with us. Parton was dazzling and simply larger than life with an over-the-top personality that simply radiated. And there is no question that Parton gave at least 150% of herself when she performed and will no doubt be remembered as one of the greatest performers of the 20th and 21st centuries.

From humble beginnings to great success, Parton never forgot

her roots. Goodbyes are always sad, and Parton will be sorely missed.

— JoAnn Lee Frank, Clearwater, Florida

Tribune's neglect of the Sky

I was truly disheartened to see the Tribune story on the front page of the Aug. 26 Sports section ("Team owner Alter defends Kanter Freedom's ejection"). The story is about the brouhaha between a publicity-seeking former NBA player and talented Chicago Sky player Natasha Cloud.

Throughout this WNBA season, I have been waiting for the story that would earn the Sky space on Page One. Maybe when Sydney Taylor hit a last-second 3-point shot Aug. 1 to beat last year's WNBA champion the Las Vegas Aces? Or maybe when Taylor repeated the performance last week to defeat the current second-best WNBA team the Golden State Valkyries? Or maybe Cloud's recent stellar outing against the always-competitive New York Liberty with 35 points, nine rebounds and six assists?

No. No. and no. Instead of admiring and celebrating these athletic moments, the Tribune gave oxygen to a misogynistic male slug. Sky owner Michael Alter is quoted but not Cloud or a single Sky player.

Come on! We the sports fans of Chicago deserve better.

— Toni Coorlas DiOrio, Clarendon Hills

Tide turning against misogyny

Regarding the op-ed "The Tate brothers and the amplification of misogyny" (Aug. 24): Jodi Bondi Norgaard is right to argue that every click, share and view helps determine what our culture rewards. Andrew Tate's influence is a story about what happens when misogyny becomes profitable, entertaining and, eventually, influential.

But there is another part of cultural change worth considering: how something goes from being considered normal to being considered unacceptable.

Revisit enough comedies from the 1980s or '90s, and someone will inevitably say, "Well, that didn't age well." A joke about sexual harassment or a woman's appearance can now make an audience uncomfortable. No law required that change. The culture changed. We stopped celebrating those ideas. Eventually, they lost their status.

We can do the same with misogyny. And we should not mistake backlash for evidence that we have failed to make progress. History suggests the opposite. Major advances in women's autonomy have often provoked efforts to reassert older hierarchies. A figure such as Tate does not mean women have lost ground. It may mean the ground is being contested. Women have made enormous gains in education, employment, political power and legal rights in a single generation. The backlash is real, but so is the progress that produced it.

That means more than simply refusing to click. We can name the people and companies profiting from content that degrades women and then vote with our dollars. We can choose not to buy their products, watch their shows, subscribe to their platforms or give our attention to people whose conduct and values we find unacceptable.

And we should say why we are opting out. Naming something as unacceptable is part of changing the norm around it. Publicly saying, "I don't support this, and I won't spend my money or atten-

tion on it," is a form of accountability.

We have changed social norms before. Domestic violence was once dismissed as a private family matter. Sexual harassment was once treated as an unavoidable part of working life. Those attitudes did not change because everyone suddenly experienced a moral awakening. They changed because society gradually stopped accepting, excusing and rewarding them.

Misogyny will not disappear overnight. But it can lose its cultural status. At some point, future generations should encounter Andrew Tate the way we encounter some of the movies that "didn't age well": as evidence of how far the culture has come.

— Melissa Breger, professor, Albany Law School, Albany, New York

What public service can teach

The idea of mandatory national service, outlined in U.S. Rep. Tom Suozzi and Scott Galloway's Aug. 24 op-ed ("Mandatory service can renew young people's faith in America"), has long been something my husband has espoused. A Vietnam War-era veteran, Bud credits his time as a draftee for opening his world to the diversity of our country that the ethnic community he grew up in did not provide. Due to Parkinson's disease, he can no longer speak or write, so I am writing for him.

Our country's youths need a gap year to get to know each other, learn how government works for us and make an investment in the country that they can be proud of.
— Margaret Sents, Glenview

Note to readers

Construction on Chicago streets and bridges this summer has created headaches for many drivers. We'd like to hear from you about your frustrations with the delays and the city's management of the closures and detours. Send a letter of no more than 400 words by Wednesday, Sept. 2 to letters@chicagotribune.com. Be sure to include your full name and city/town.

For online-exclusive letters, go to www.chicagotribune.com/letters. Email your letter submissions, 400 words or less, to letters@chicagotribune.com. Include your full name, address and phone number.

TIM CURRY 1946-2026

Versatile actor burst onto scene in ‘Rocky Horror Picture Show’

By Mark Kennedy
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Tim Curry, a character actor who created a gallery of delicious, very loony villains for stage and screen, including Dr. Frank-N-Furter in “The Rocky Horror Picture Show” and the smug concierge in “Home Alone 2: Lost in New York,” died Tuesday night. He was 80.

Curry, who suffered a stroke in 2012 that put him in a wheelchair, died at his home in Los Angeles, according to his longtime manager and friend Marcia Hurwitz. No cause was disclosed.

Known for his arch humor, a putty-like face and gift with voices, Curry earned three Tony nominations — for “Spamalot,” “My Favorite Year” and “Amadeus” — and an Emmy nod in 1994.

“I like playing the more curious corners of the human mind and human behavior, partly because they’re a tad more interesting,” Curry said in 1993.

Curry burst onto the scene as the Transylvanian Frank-N-Furter in the sci-fi, cross-dressing rock musical “The Rocky Horror Show,” which premiered in 1973 at the Royal Court Theatre in London. He went with it to Broadway and then starred in the 1975 cult-classic movie alongside Barry Bostwick, Meat Loaf and Susan Sarandon.

The show was ahead of its time in terms of its representation of LGBTQ+ characters and has entered the pop culture lexicon for its many iconic and memorable scenes, including the song “The Time Warp,” which has been covered by handfuls of artists, and the often-quoted phrase, “Dammit, Janet!” The show was twice revived on Broadway, most recently in 2026 with Luke Evans playing Frank-N-Furter.

For many years after the film’s premiere, the British-born actor declined to



Iconic actor Tim Curry suffered a stroke in 2012 that put him in a wheelchair. PETER KRAMER/AP 2011

discuss it. He didn’t participate in activities promoting the film, which morphed into an interactive event at midnight shows. But he later warmed again to the project and embraced it at public events. Asked by LA Magazine how he viewed “Rocky Horror,” he responded: “With a sort of bemused tolerance. It’s neither a blessing nor a curse. I was lucky to get it.”

Curry’s Broadway career included starring in Tom Stoppard’s “Travesties” in 1975-76, playing Mozart opposite Ian McKellen’s Antonio Salieri in Peter Shaffer’s “Amadeus” and King Arthur in the 2005 production of “Spamalot.” The New York Times said his “stalwart, plummy-voiced Arthur wears a smile as inflexible as armor.”

His screen credits included starring as the child-killing monster in the 1990 mini-series version of Stephen King’s horror novel “It” and the double-dealing Cardinal Richelieu in 1993’s “The Three Musketeers” with Kiefer Sutherland, Charlie Sheen and Chris O’Donnell.

In his 2025 memoir, “Vagabond,” Curry warned readers that while there were scraps of his nature in his characters, he was none of them.

“The distinctions between who I really am and who I’ve pretended to be as an actor

have proven to be a source of great disappointment to some audiences. It has not caused me much personal distress beyond the periodic necessity to deter stalkers,” he wrote.

Born April 19, 1946, in Cheshire, England, Curry was the son of a Navy chaplain and a school secretary. He was 12 when his father died and his mother subsequently went to work. Young Tim learned to cook his own breakfast, resulting in a life-long passion for cooking, and sharpened his humor muscles.

“My father was a Methodist chaplain in the Navy, and we moved pretty much every 18 months,” he said. “So I had to make my mark in new schools and new playgrounds pretty quickly. And a sense of humor is the best way to do that. I was always a kind of mimic, one of those awful, relentless children, I should think.”

Acting did not occur to him until his middle teens, when he attended a school for the sons of Methodist ministers.

“I was lucky that it was a liberal kind of school; many of them in England are rather Dickensian,” he recalled to the AP. “There was a lot of theater, and I sang, too; I had been singing in church from the age of 7. I had enormous opportunities to express myself in that way. I just got hooked, really.”

His training continued in 1965 when he entered the University of Birmingham, at that time one of three English universities with a drama department.

He then went to London and talked his way into his first job, “Hair,” in the West End. Curry went on to the more formalized theater of the Royal Shakespeare Company and the Royal Court Theatre, where he was enlisted for “The Rocky Horror Picture Show.”

Curry never married and had no children.

VOTING

from Page A1

to vote,” New York Attorney General Letitia James, one of 25 Democratic attorneys general filing the lawsuit, said in a statement. “USPS has no authority to decide who can and cannot vote by mail.”

The Trump administration plan faces a third lawsuit originally filed in May in the nation’s capital, though courts there have so far declined to block it.

All previous challenges were filed before the administration published its mail ballot rule Friday night.

White House spokesperson Lauren Bis on Wednesday said the Postal Service’s proposals were “common-sense measures that protect the security of mail-in ballots” and that the administration would continue to work to implement them to boost “the safety and security of our elections.”

The Postal Service said it would not comment because of the pending lawsuit.

National Democrats on Tuesday cited the rule in asking the federal judge in the Washington case to block Trump’s order after he declined to do so last spring, saying the administration at the time had not taken concrete action.

In Boston, Talwani also found that the administra-

tion had violated a separate injunction she had placed on the Postal Service in drafting the new rule, although she did not take any action against the government. The League of Women Voters originally filed that lawsuit, and on Wednesday they also asked for a new court order blocking the mail voting plan.

Trump has targeted mail voting, which he falsely blames for his 2020 election loss and is disproportionately used by Democrats as a result of Trump’s condemnations. Since returning to power, Trump has tried to claim authority over election rules, saying he thinks Republicans should “take over” vote counting in Democratic areas.

He issued his first election executive order just months after retaking office, attempting to require documentary proof of citizenship to vote, among other changes. He has also been pushing a sweeping election bill that has stalled in the Senate amid opposition from Democrats and even some within his own party.

Meanwhile, Maine’s Republican nominee for governor recently told a crowd of supporters that he would ask a top Department of Homeland Security official to send U.S. Marshals and Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents to polling places in the state for

this fall’s midterm elections, according to audio obtained by The Associated Press.

During an Aug. 20 event in Arundel, Bobby Charles told a group of supporters that he would ask Tom Homan, the White House border czar, to send federal agents to polling places in the weeks before Election Day. The audio was first reported by the Bangor Daily News.

“Here’s my secret,” Charles told members of a Maine Young Republicans chapter. “I have a friend named Tom Homan. Tom and I used to get on Fox all the time together. Tom’s an awesome guy.”

“I’m going to ask Tom, I’m going to actually — three or four weeks before the election, maybe three — I’m going to make an appeal for ICE and Marshals to be at our voting booths,” Charles said, according to the audio.

On Wednesday, he explained his comments by saying state and local authorities who manage elections should have an open line of communication with federal authorities if needed to “prevent violence at a voting place, in order to prevent intimidation at a voting place and in order to prevent illegality at a voting place.”

He said his point was that Maine authorities should do everything legally possible to prevent illegal voting in the state.

Chicago Daily Tribune

ON AUGUST 27 ...

In 1776, British forces led by Lt. Gen. William Howe defeated the Continental Army of Gen. George Washington at Long Island, New York, in the Revolutionary War.

In 1883, the island volcano Krakatoa blew up; the resulting tidal waves in Indonesia’s Sunda Strait claimed some 36,000 lives in Java and Sumatra.

In 1908, Lyndon Baines Johnson, the nation’s 36th president, was born near Stonewall, Texas.

In 1945, U.S. troops began landing in Japan after the surrender of the Japanese

government in World War II.

In 1963, sociologist and civil-rights activist W.E.B. DuBois died in Accra, Ghana; he was 95.

In 1975, Haile Selassie, the last emperor of Ethiopia’s 3,000-year-old monarchy, died in Addis Ababa at age 83, almost a year after being overthrown.

In 1990, blues guitarist Stevie Ray Vaughan, 35, and four other people were killed when a helicopter ferrying the group crashed near East Troy, Wisconsin.

In 1995, American and Chinese officials agreed to begin planning a fall summit

between President Bill Clinton and Chinese President Jiang Zemin.

In 2004, President George W. Bush signed executive orders designed to strengthen the CIA director’s power over the nation’s intelligence agencies and create a national counterterrorism center.

In 2015, a former papal envoy accused of paying young boys for sex died before his trial at the Vatican could get underway; Jozef Wesolowski, 67, faced seven years in jail. Also in 2015 a truck found abandoned on the side of an Austrian highway contained the bodies of 71 migrants, likely Syrians fleeing civil war; four suspects were arrested in Hungary.



Chicago Tribune Death Notices

Chicago Tribune extends our condolences to the families and loved ones of those who have passed.

chicagotribune.com/deathnotice

Death Notices	Death Notices
Kriser, Geraldine Geraldine Kriser née Wise of Riverwoods, IL, passed away peacefully on August 25th surrounded by her husband and children. Born in Chicago in 1938, she met her husband, Charles F. Kriser of Highland Park, IL while both were studying at the University of Michigan, and they were married in 1959. Gerry is survived by Charles, their daughters, Jeanne, Amy, and Wendy, their eleven grandchildren, her brother, William, and a large, loving extended family. Donations in Gerry’s name can be made to the Jewish United Fund, the Anti-Defamation League, or to Family Focus in honor of her many years as an early childhood educator.	Richards, Peter Lloyd Pete Peter Lloyd Richards, 81, of Mt. Prospect, Illinois, passed away peacefully on August 18, 2026. A visitation and Celebration of Life will be held Friday August 28, 2026, from 2:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m. at Nelson Funeral Home, 820 S. Talcott Road, Park Ridge, Illinois. Please visit https://www.nelsonfunerals.com/obituaries for the full obituary and details.
Moles, Peter T. Peter Thompson Moles, 66, of Clarendon Hills, Illinois, died on August 19, 2026. Above all, Peter loved his God and his family. Coming in a close third, everyone knows, was a lifelong passion for his work in sales, and sharing his knowledge and experience training others to be successful. An eternal optimist, he believed without doubt that more great days were always ahead. His joy in life was unsurpassed. He was preceded in death by his parents, Tom Oscar and Marilyn Moles; and survived by his wife, Sarah, and her son, Beau Short; and former wife, Carrie Lyons, and children Jonathon Moles, Jessica Moles, Jenna Moles, and Jack (Charis) Moles; grandchildren Michael, Mason and Jocelyn Lipuma; Levi, Analeigh, Noah and Jireh Moles; and siblings, John Moles; Cathy (Scott) Koepke; Polly Moles; and Lisa (Peter) Sykes. Memorials may be made and sincerely appreciated to the faith-based recovery and residential program at Mt. Zion House/Mt. Zion Christian Church in Lake Geneva, Wisconsin (www.mtzn.com). Isaiah 40:31 “But they that wait upon the Lord shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.” A celebration of life will be held at 10 am on Saturday, August 29, at the Spirit of God Fellowship Church in South Holland, Illinois. Interment was private.	Sebastian, George J.  George J. Sebastian, of Sun City, Huntley, passed away at his home, surrounded by his family on August 11, 2026 following a lengthy illness. He is survived by his wife, Louise of Huntley; his son, George and daughter-in-law Julie, grandchildren, Aaron and Matthew (Chloe), and great grandchildren, Mason, Noah, Gatlin, Theo, Olivia; daughter, Annamarie and grandsons Daniel and Alexander; daughter, Katherine (Ehlert) and son-in-law Paul, grandchildren, Mandy (Justin), Jessie (Conor), and Luke (Kate), and great-grandson, Gavin. He was preceded in death by his parents and sister, Betty Jane Blodgett. Visitation will be held on Sunday, August 30, 2026 from 2:00pm-5:00pm at DeFiore Funeral Home, 10763 Dundee Road, Huntley. A memorial visitation will occur on Monday, August 31, from 10:00am-11:00am with a Celebration of Life Memorial Service at Shepherd of the Prairie Lutheran Church, 10805 Main Street, Huntley. In lieu of flowers, memorials may be made to Shepherd of the Prairie Lutheran Church. For further information please contact the funeral home at 847-515-8772 or condolences may be directed to www.defiorefuneral.com



Palluck, Gregory J.
Gregory Palluck, 85, passed away peacefully on Tuesday, August 25, 2026, surrounded by the love of his family. He was a devoted husband, father, grandfather, great grandfather and friend whose greatest joy in life was his family. For 61 years, he shared his life with his beloved wife, April. Together, they built a life filled with love, family, memories, and countless moments that will be cherished forever. He was a strong man in every sense of the word. In his last years he bravely battled COPD, pulmonary fibrosis, and congestive heart failure. Even through the challenges of illness, he continued to fight with the strength and determination that defined him. He was a true warrior who never stopped fighting for the people he loved. His greatest pride was his family. He was a devoted husband for 61 years to April (nee Haas) Palluck, loving father to Cheryl (Jim) Carter, Joseph (Gina) Palluck and Stacy (Paul) Seifert, a cherished grandfather to Josh, Matt, Eric, Aubrey, Grace, and Ian, and an adoring great grandfather to Aspen; dear brother to Robert (Marion) Paluck. He loved each of them without boundaries and in his own special way made each one feel important, loved, and part of something bigger than themselves. He leaves behind a legacy of love that will continue through his children and grandchildren. The lessons he taught, the stories he shared, the laughter he brought, and the love he gave will remain with his family for generations to come. He will be remembered not only for the years he lived, but for the lives he touched and the love and laughter he gave so freely. His family will miss his presence more than words can express, but they will carry him with them—in their hearts, in their memories, and in the love, they share with one another. Greg was preceded in death by his parents, Joseph and Rosalie (nee Koczmicki) Palluck. He was deeply loved. He fought bravely. He lived a long and meaningful life. And he will never be forgotten.

Everyone will meet at St. Alphonsus Catholic Church 605 State St, Lemont, IL 60439, on Saturday, August 29, 2026, at 9:45am for Mass of Christian Burial at 10:00am. Interment Private. Visitation on Friday, August 28, 2026, in the O’Neil Funeral Home Chapel 1105 E. 9th St. Lockport, IL 60441 from 4:00pm until 8:00pm. www.oneilfuneralhome.com



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Chicago Tribune

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Assumed Name

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation to the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in The State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook County.

File No. M26001932 on the Date: 08/14/2026
Under the Assumed Name of: **MENS DISTRICT**
with the business located at: **F125A WOODFIELD MALL, SCHAUMBURG, IL 60173**
The true name and residence address of the owner is: **HAKHEEM MILBES, 2525 EL CAMINO REAL STE 165, CARLSBAD, CA 92008**

Notice is hereby given, Pursuant to "An Act in relation to the use of an Assumed Business Name in the conduct or transaction of Business in The State" as amended, that a Certification was filed by the Undersigned with the County Clerk of Cook County.

File No. M26001936 on the Date: 08/17/2026
Under the Assumed Name of: **Chicago Notary by Grace**
with the business located at: **3959 N Janssen AVE G, Chicago, IL 60613**
The true name and residence address of the owner is: **Sarra Grace Wilkins, 3959 N Janssen AVE G, Chicago, IL 60613**

Garage & Yard Sales

Oak Lawn/Oak Meadows 8/27,28,29
SPRING ROAD 9am 5pm
Approx 101st St 1 blk w of Cicero, 3+ homes, rain/shine. Baby, toys, household, mens, tools, auto, lawn, clothing, shoes, antiques, lots more. Come check us out!

Farms and Ranches For Sale

Kankakee, IL \$600,000 60901
1550 West State Rte. 113 Farm



Beautiful small farm includes 15 acres cropland, large red barn, large white corn crib, garage, spring house, small outbuildings, spacious 1915 red brick two story house with basement, Hawkins family homestead since 1820 given by land grant by President Tyler. 4172397562

Juvenile Adoption**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF COOK COUNTY, ILLINOIS JUVENILE JUSTICE AND CHILD PROTECTION DEPARTMENT CHILD PROTECTION DIVISION**

IN THE INTEREST OF
Drea Steed

MINOR(S) CHILD(REN) OF Denisha Steed (Mother)

JUVENILE NO. 24JA00584

NOTICE OF PUBLICATION

NOTICE IS GIVEN YOU Lamondra Miller (Father), Unknown Father's respondents, and to **All Whom It May Concern**, that on 6/23/2026 a petition was filed under the Juvenile Court Act by **EILEEN M. O'NEILL-BURKE** in this court and that in the courtroom of Judge Pamela Saindon in the Cook County Juvenile Court Building, 1100 So. Hamilton Avenue, Chicago, Illinois, ON November 4, 2026, at 10:30 AM in CALENDAR 14 COURTROOM A or as soon thereafter as this case may be heard, a hearing will be held upon the petition to terminate your parental rights and appoint a guardian with power to consent to adoption.

THE COURT HAS AUTHORITY IN THIS CASE TO TAKE FROM YOU THE CUSTODY AND GUARDIANSHIP OF THE MINOR, TO TERMINATE YOUR PARENTAL RIGHTS AND TO APPOINT A GUARDIAN WITH POWER TO CONSENT TO ADOPTION. YOU MAY LOSE ALL PARENTAL RIGHTS TO YOUR CHILD. IF THE PETITION REQUESTS THE TERMINATION OF YOUR PARENTAL RIGHTS AND APPOINTMENT OF A GUARDIAN WITH POWER TO CONSENT TO ADOPTION, YOU MAY LOSE ALL PARENTAL RIGHTS TO THE CHILD.

UNLESS YOU appear, you will not be entitled to further written notices or publication notices of the proceedings in this case, including the filing of an amended petition or a motion to terminate parental rights.

UNLESS YOU appear at the hearing and show cause against the petition, the allegations of the petition may stand admitted as against you and each of you, and an order or judgment entered.

Mariyana T. Spyropoulos, CLERK OF THE CIRCUIT COURT OF COOK COUNTY, ILLINOIS 8/27/2026 123852

Juvenile Protection

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF COOK COUNTY, ILLINOIS JUVENILE JUSTICE AND CHILD PROTECTION DEPARTMENT CHILD PROTECTION DIVISION

IN THE INTEREST OF
CIARA MORRIS

MINOR(S) CHILD(REN) OF Josephine Meeks (Mother)

JUVENILE NO. 26JA00464

NOTICE OF PUBLICATION

NOTICE IS GIVEN YOU, Shadell Morris (Father), & Unknown (Fathers) respondents, and to **All Whom It May Concern**, that on 7/20/2026 a petition was filed under the Juvenile Court Act by **EILEEN M. O'NEILL-BURKE** in this court and that in the courtroom of Judge Sabra Ebersole in the Cook County Juvenile Court Building, 1100 So. Hamilton Avenue, Chicago, Illinois, ON October 7, 2026, at 9:30 AM in CALENDAR 9 COURTROOM A or as soon thereafter as this case may be heard, an adjudicatory hearing will be held upon the petition to have the minor declared to be a ward of the court and for other relief under the Act.

THE COURT HAS AUTHORITY IN THIS CASE TO TAKE FROM YOU THE CUSTODY AND GUARDIANSHIP OF THE MINOR, TO TERMINATE YOUR PARENTAL RIGHTS AND TO APPOINT A GUARDIAN WITH POWER TO CONSENT TO ADOPTION. YOU MAY LOSE ALL PARENTAL RIGHTS TO YOUR CHILD. IF THE PETITION REQUESTS THE TERMINATION OF YOUR PARENTAL RIGHTS AND APPOINTMENT OF A GUARDIAN WITH POWER TO CONSENT TO ADOPTION, YOU MAY LOSE ALL PARENTAL RIGHTS TO THE CHILD.

UNLESS YOU appear, you will not be entitled to further written notices or publication notices of the proceedings in this case, including the filing of an amended petition or a motion to terminate parental rights.

UNLESS YOU appear at the hearing and show cause against the petition, the allegations of the petition may stand admitted as against you and each of you, and an order or judgment entered.

Mariyana T. Spyropoulos, CLERK OF THE CIRCUIT COURT OF COOK COUNTY, ILLINOIS 8/27/2026 123851

Legal Notice**CHICAGO TRANSIT AUTHORITY Advertisement for Bids NOTICE OF TIME EXTENSION AND ADDITIONAL INFORMATION**

Notice is hereby given that the opening date heretofore advertised as Monday, August 31, 2026 has been extended to Wednesday, September 9, 2026 no later than 2:00 P.M. for the following items:
Req No.: C26CT103289242,
Invitation for Bids (IFB) Furnish, Deliver and Install Four (4) Automatic Parts Washers and One (1) Floor Mounted Gantry Crane.
PROPOSAL GUARANTEE: NONE
For additional information, please contact Jennifer Burkhardt, Procurement Administrator, jburkhardt@transitchicago.com. Any contract resulting from this advertisement will be awarded to the lowest responsive and responsible bidder.

The contractor will be required to furnish certified copies of any and all Insurance Policies required in relation to this contract prior to CTA's execution.
Chicago Transit Authority hereby notifies all bidders that it will affirmatively ensure that in regard to any contract entered into pursuant to this advertisement, Disadvantaged Business Enterprise will be afforded full opportunity to submit bids in response to this invitation and will not be discriminated against on the grounds of race, color, or national origin in consideration for an award.
PLEASE NOTE: The right is reserved to accept any bid or any part or parts thereof or to reject any and all bids.

CHICAGO TRANSIT AUTHORITY
By: Ellen G. McCormack
Vice President
Purchasing & Supply Chain
August 27, 2026
8/27/2026 124277

CHICAGO TRANSIT AUTHORITY Advertisement for Bids SMALL BUSINESS ENTERPRISE (SBE) PROGRAM**NOTICE OF TIME EXTENSION WITH ADDENDUM NO. 1 TO FOLLOW**

Notice is hereby given that the opening date heretofore advertised as Friday, August 28, 2026 has been extended to Friday, September 11, 2026 no later than 2:00 P.M. for the following items:

Req No. B26OP00064,
Invitation For Bids (IFB) for Small Business Enterprise (SBE) (Non- Negotiable) - Facility Extermination Services for Up to Thirty-Six Months with Two, One-Year Options.
PROPOSAL GUARANTEE: NONE
For additional information, please contact Michelle Beckwith, Procurement Administrator, mbeckwith@transitchicago.com. Any contract resulting from this advertisement will be awarded to the lowest responsive and responsible bidder.

The contractor will be required to furnish certified copies of any and all Insurance Policies required in relation to this contract prior to CTA's execution.
Chicago Transit Authority hereby notifies all bidders that it will affirmatively ensure that in regard to any contract entered into pursuant to this advertisement, Disadvantaged Business Enterprise will be afforded full opportunity to submit bids in response to this invitation and will not be discriminated against on the grounds of race, color, or national origin in consideration for an award.
PLEASE NOTE: The right is reserved to accept any bid or any part or parts thereof or to reject any and all bids.

CHICAGO TRANSIT AUTHORITY
By: Ellen G. McCormack
Vice President
Purchasing & Supply Chain
August 27, 2026
8/27/2026 123862

LEGAL ADVERTISEMENT
August 27, 2026
CITY OF CHICAGO
DEPARTMENT OF PROCUREMENT SERVICES

The Bidder must complete and submit an Electronic Bid prior to the bid due date. An electronic bid must be submitted through the City of Chicago's website at www.cityofchicago.org/eProcurement, on or before the due date and time stated below. The City's system will not accept electronic bids after the due date and time. Bidders must register for a log-in account to submit an electronic bid. Please allow up to three business days for creation of your log-in account. Paper bids will not be accepted. All Bids will be opened and publicly read aloud for the following:

DESCRIPTION: Provide Bottled Drinking Water and Water Cooler Rentals
DEPARTMENT: Department of Procurement Services
TYPE: Commodity

ELECTRONIC BID DOCUMENTS CAN BE DOWNLOADED AND RESPONDED TO FROM THIS URL ADDRESS:
www.cityofchicago.org/eProcurement

SPECIFICATION NO: 1197406C
RFO NO.: 56958
BID OPENING DATE: October 15, 2026
TIME: 11:00 a.m., Central Time
QUESTION DUE DATE: September 10, 2026, by 4:00 p.m. Central Time

PRE-BID CONFERENCE: September 3, 2026, at 11:00 a.m., Central Time, Pre-Bid Location: City Hall, Department of Procurement Services, 121 N. LaSalle Street, Room 806, Conference Room B, Chicago, IL 60602. All interested Attendees are encouraged to register in advance of the Pre-Bid Conference by emailing Tom Pasciak at Tom.pasciak@cityofchicago.org.

CONTACT: Tom Pasciak,
Procurement Specialist
Email: Tom.pasciak@cityofchicago.org
8/27/2026 120532

CITY OF EVANSTON NOTICE TO BIDDERS

The City's Purchasing Office will receive bids until **2:00 P.M. local time, Tuesday, October 13, 2026**, and will be publicly read virtually via Google Meets at 2:15 P.M. Interested parties can use the following link: meet.google.com/erk-vjvw-pza or join by phone 617-675-4444 PIN: 491 020 418 0044# to access the virtual bid opening. Responses will only be accepted electronically via E-bidding through DemandStar (www.demandstar.com). Although registration is required, vendors can download solicitations and upload responses for free. Bids shall cover the following:

Traffic Signal Improvements Project
Bid Number: 26-45

Work on this project includes traffic signal improvements, including fiber optic interconnect; sidewalk and curb ramp replacement; installation of Accessible Pedestrian Signals (APS); pavement patching adjacent to curb ramp improvements; parkway restoration; and related incidental work on various streets.

A Non-mandatory hybrid pre-bid meeting will be held at City Hall, 909 Davis Street - 332A Conference/Training Room - West, Evanston, IL 60201, at 11 A.M. on Thursday, September 10, 2026, and virtually on Google Meet Meeting ID: meet.google.com/mna-acgu-tdk. Phone Number: 563-447-1943; PIN:

The above item shall conform to the Invitation for Bids on file in the Purchasing Office. Parties interested in submitting a bid should contact the Purchasing Office to receive a copy of the bid or see the City's website at: www.cityofevanston.org/business/bids_proposals.php or DemandStar at: www.demandstar.com.

The City of Evanston (the City) in accordance with the laws of the State of Illinois, hereby notifies all bidders that it will affirmatively ensure that the contract(s) entered into pursuant to this Notice will be awarded to the successful Bidders without discrimination on the ground of race, color, religion, sex, age, sexual orientation, marital status, disability, familial status or national origin. The State of Illinois requires, under Public Works contracts, that the general prevailing rate of wages in this locality be paid for each craft or type of worker hereunder. This requirement is in accordance with the Prevailing Wage Act (820 ILCS 130) as amended. The City of Evanston reserves the right to reject any or all submittals or to accept the submittal(s) deemed most advantageous to the City.

The Evanston City Council also reserves the right to award the contract to an Evanston firm if that firm's bid is within 5% of the low bid.
Each Bidder shall be required to submit with their bid a disclosure of ownership interest statement in accordance with the provisions of City Code Section 1-18-1 et seq.
Failure to submit such information will result in the disqualification of such bid.

Jessica Cooper
Purchasing Specialist
August 27, 2026 - 124355

Legal Notice

Date Advertised:
Thursday, August 27, 2026
County of Cook
Office of the Chief Procurement Officer
For Cook County Department of Facilities Management
Bid for Janitorial Supplies
Bid No.: 2638-07221

Bid Document: The Bid document is available for download at:
<https://cookcountytill.bonfirehub.com/portal/?tab=openOpportunities>

Contact Person: If you are not able to download the bid or if you have other questions, please contact April Johnson, Contract Negotiator, at (312) 603-7617 or april.johnson@cookcountytill.gov

Questions: Questions can be submitted in writing to the contact person above until 12:00 PM Local Time - Chicago on September 3, 2026.

Bid Due Date, Time, and Location: Wednesday, September 23, 2026 at 10:00 AM Local Time - Chicago
All Bids must be submitted electronically and uploaded to <https://cookcountytill.bonfirehub.com/portal/?tab=openOpportunities> following the instructions set forth in the Bid Solicitation document.

Toni Preckwinkle
President,
Cook County
Board of Commissioners

Raffi Sarrafian
Chief Procurement Officer

Late Proposals Will Not Be Accepted
8/27/26 124452

LEGAL ADVERTISEMENT
August 27, 2026
CITY OF CHICAGO
DEPARTMENT OF PROCUREMENT SERVICES

The Bidder must complete and submit an Electronic Bid prior to the bid due date. An electronic bid must be submitted through the City of Chicago's website at www.cityofchicago.org/eProcurement, on or before the due date and time stated below. The City's system will not accept electronic bids after the due date and time. Bidders must register for a log-in account to submit an electronic bid. Please allow up to three business days for creation of your log-in account. Paper bids will not be accepted. All Bids will be opened and publicly read aloud for the following:

DESCRIPTION: AUBURN GRESHAM CORRIDOR IMPROVEMENTS
Section 1: 79th Street, Sangamon Street to Fielding Avenue and Halsted Street, 78th Street to 80th Street (SBI - I)
DEPARTMENT: Department of Procurement Services
TYPE: Construction

ELECTRONIC BID DOCUMENTS CAN BE DOWNLOADED AND RESPONDED TO FROM THIS URL ADDRESS:
www.cityofchicago.org/eProcurement

NOTICE OF ADDENDUM: Addendum # 1 will be e-mailed to all bidders on the Bid Opportunity Take-Out List

SPECIFICATION NO: 1269498
RFO NO: 76312.1
BID OPENING DATE: September 15, 2026
REVISED BID OPENING DATE: September 15, 2026 (remained the same) per Addendum #1
TIME: 11:00 a.m., Central Time

CONTACT: Sadi Sandoval,
Senior Procurement Specialist
Email: sadi.sandoval@cityofchicago.org

Bid Bond: Bids requiring a bid deposit must be accompanied by a Bid Bond, provided by a surety company authorized to do business in the United States, and made payable to the City of Chicago. A scanned copy of the bid bond must be attached to the online bid submission, with the original bond to be received by DPS within 3 business days of the bid opening. This is required of all bidders, not just the apparent low bidder.
Any late Bids received after announced date and time, for the opening of Bids, will not be accepted.
8/27/2026 124029

PUBLIC NOTICE
NOTICE is hereby given, pursuant to Section 2.02 of the Illinois Open Meetings Act [5 ILCS 120/2.02(a)], that the September 17, 2026, in-person meeting of the Cook Commission on Human Rights is CANCELLED for lack of a quorum.
/s/ Jennifer King
Director
8/27/2026 124407

Legal Notice

City of Chicago
Department of Family and Support Services
Legal Advertisement Request Form

DEPARTMENT OF FAMILY AND SUPPORT SERVICES (DFSS),
PROFESSIONAL LEARNING AND CONTINUOUS QUALITY IMPROVEMENT RFP

The Department of Family and Support Services (DFSS) Professional Learning and Continuous Quality Improvement RFP seeks qualified agencies to provide subject matter expertise and targeted supports for Department of Family Support Services (DFSS) Youth Services Division (YSD) direct service providers, to build organizational capacity and ensure consistent design and implementation of high-quality programming for Chicago youth.

DFSS anticipates funding up to three (3) agencies in three Program Streams:

Program Stream A: Youth Program Development

Program Stream B: Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI)

Program Stream C: Organizational Administration

Respondents will select one program stream per application.

The term of contract(s) executed under this RFP will be from **January 1, 2027, through December 31, 2028**. Based on need, availability of funds and contractor performance, DFSS may extend this term for up to three extensions with each extension not to exceed one year. Continued support will be dependent upon the selected Respondent's performance and the continued availability of funding. Depending on the selected Program Stream, DFSS anticipates that each award will be between \$68,824 and \$266,177 annually, for a total award amount of \$512,060. DFSS anticipates funding two to three agencies. This contract will operate on a reimbursement basis only. No advances will be given.

This initiative is administered by DFSS through City of Chicago Corporate funds. Consequently, all guidelines and requirements of DFSS and the City of Chicago must be met. Additionally, all delegate agencies must comply with the Single Audit Act if applicable.

For more information, please refer to the application posted on the City of Chicago's eProcurement page under current bids:

www.cityofchicago.org/eProcurement
Solicitation #67260

A NOTE ABOUT THE CITY'S EPROCUREMENT SYSTEM:

For those who have not done business with the City of Chicago before, registration in iSupplier is the first step to ensuring your agency's ability to conduct business with the City of Chicago and DFSS. **Please allow five to seven days for your registration to be processed.**

Current contractors need only to start an application via their existing iSupplier/eProcurement account.

All vendors must have a Federal Employer Identification Number (FEIN) and an IRS W9 for registration and confirmation of vendor business information.

RFP DUE DATE/SUBMISSION LOCATION:

October 2, 2026
12:00, NOON CST

Proposals must be submitted via on-line application.
E-mailed or faxed proposals will not be accepted.

PRE-PROPOSAL WEBINAR:

A Pre-Proposal Webinar will be held on **September 2nd, 2026 at 1pm**. Attendance is not mandatory but is strongly suggested.

Please register prior to the webinar's start using this link:

https://us02web.zoom.us/join/register/WN_C3Q6kzURQWaw69I7X9EYhtw

A link to the completed Webinar will be available on-line at the DFSS website after the time and date listed above for those who cannot attend at the live scheduled time. Please register prior to the Webinar's start. The purpose of this pre-submittal event is to clarify the RFP process and the scope of the required services.

Angela J. Green
Commissioner
Department of Family and Support Services



Brandon Johnson
Mayor
City of Chicago

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Chicago Tribune
placeanad.chicagotribune.com

CHICAGO

ACCUWEATHER



Meteorologists Larry Mowry, Cheryl Scott, Jaisol Martinez, Tracy Butler and Greg Dutra

AccuWeather Outlook: Sunny to partly cloudy; pleasant down-town. A moonlit sky tonight; good viewing conditions for the lunar eclipse.

Chicago forecast

Thursday Conditions						
8 a.m.	10 a.m.	Noon	2 p.m.	4 p.m.	6 p.m.	8 p.m.
AccuWeather.com UV Index™						
1	4	6	6	4	1	0
RealFeel Temperature®						
70°	78°	84°	84°	82°	77°	77°

Thursday Activities						
8 a.m.	10 a.m.	Noon	2 p.m.	4 p.m.	6 p.m.	8 p.m.
Golfing Index						
6	6	6	6	6	6	6
Fishing Index						
4	4	6	6	6	6	5

The higher the **AccuWeather.com UV Index** number, the greater the need for eye and skin protection. **0-2** Low, **3-5** Moderate, **6-7** High, **8-10** Very High, **11+** Extreme. The patented **AccuWeather.com RealFeel Temperature** is an exclusive index of effective temperature based on eight weather factors. **Golf and Fishing Indexes:** **0-2:** Poor; **3-4:** Fair; **5-6:** Good; **7-8:** Very Good; **9-10:** Excellent.

Chicago almanac

Wednesday temperatures			
O'Hare through 4 p.m.			
	Average	Record	
Wednesday high:	84°	81°	97° (1973)
Wednesday low:	70°	64°	47° (1887)
Local temperatures			
through 6 p.m. Wednesday			
Location	High	Low	Average
Aurora	84°	66°	81° 58°
Gary	86°	66°	82° 62°
Kankakee	84°	63°	82° 61°
Lansing	85°	62°	81° 61°
Midway	84°	69°	82° 65°
Romeoville	84°	66°	82° 62°
Valparaiso	84°	59°	82° 61°
Waukegan	81°	66°	79° 60°

Wednesday Precipitation			
Wednesday*	0.00"	Trace	0.13"
Month to date	4.23"	4.68"	3.58"
Year to date	30.18"	22.07"	26.04"
*24-hour period ending 4 p.m. Wednesday			

Pollen as of 8/26			
Trees	Grass	Weeds	Mold
Absent	Low	High	High
Source: Loyola Medicine via NAB			

Air Quality Index	
Wednesday's reading	
Moderate	
Thursday's forecast	
Moderate	
Primary pollutant	Particulates
Source: AirNow.gov	

Cosmos

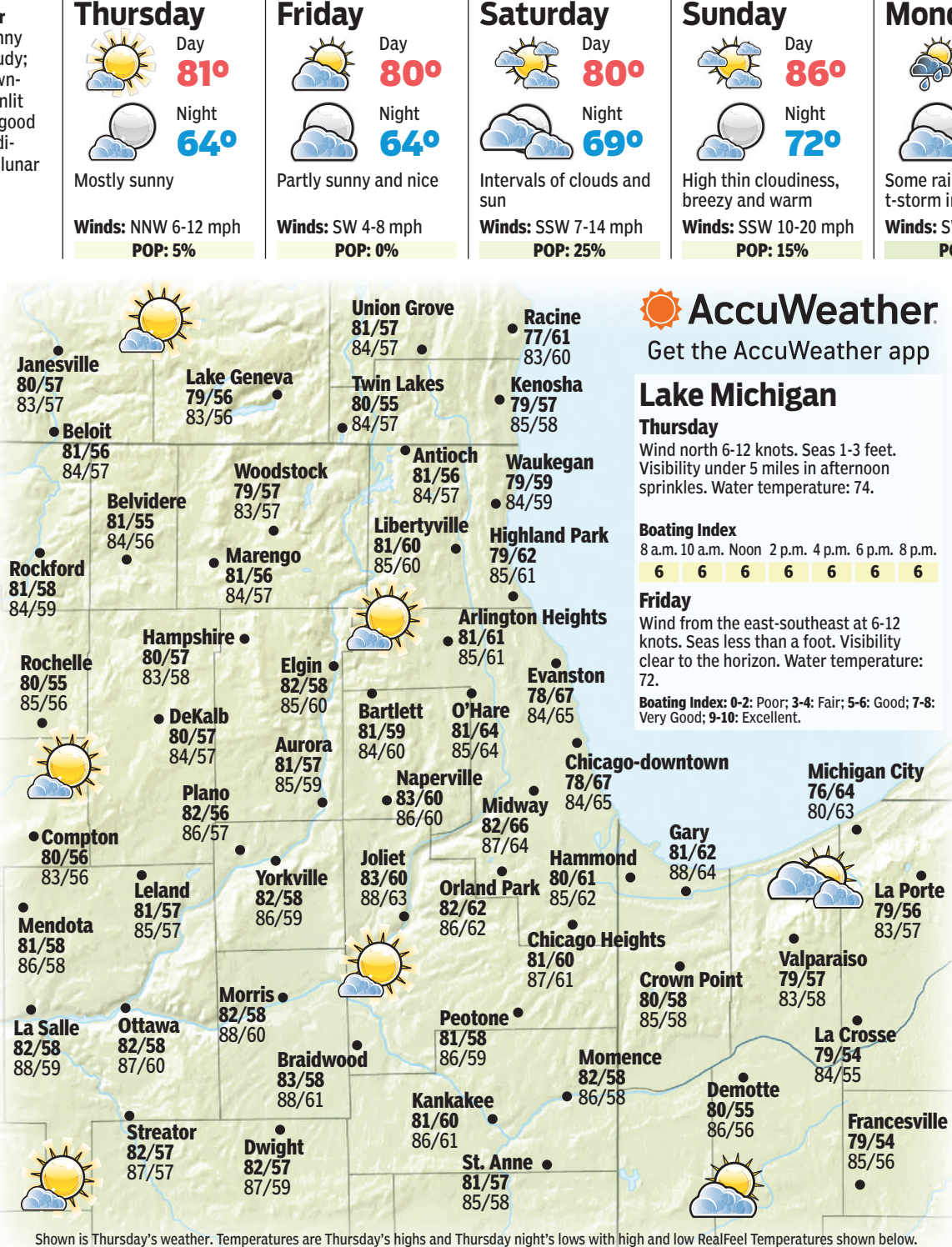
Sun and moon	
Sunrise	Thu. 6:11 a.m.
Sunset	Thu. 7:32 p.m.
Moonrise	Thu. 7:22 p.m.
Moonset	Thu. 5:29 a.m.
Full	Last
Aug 27	Sep 4
Sep 10	Sep 18

Thursday's Planet Watch	
Rise	Set
Mercury	6:10 a.m.
Venus	10:09 a.m.
Mars	1:38 a.m.
Jupiter	4:20 a.m.
Saturn	9:09 p.m.

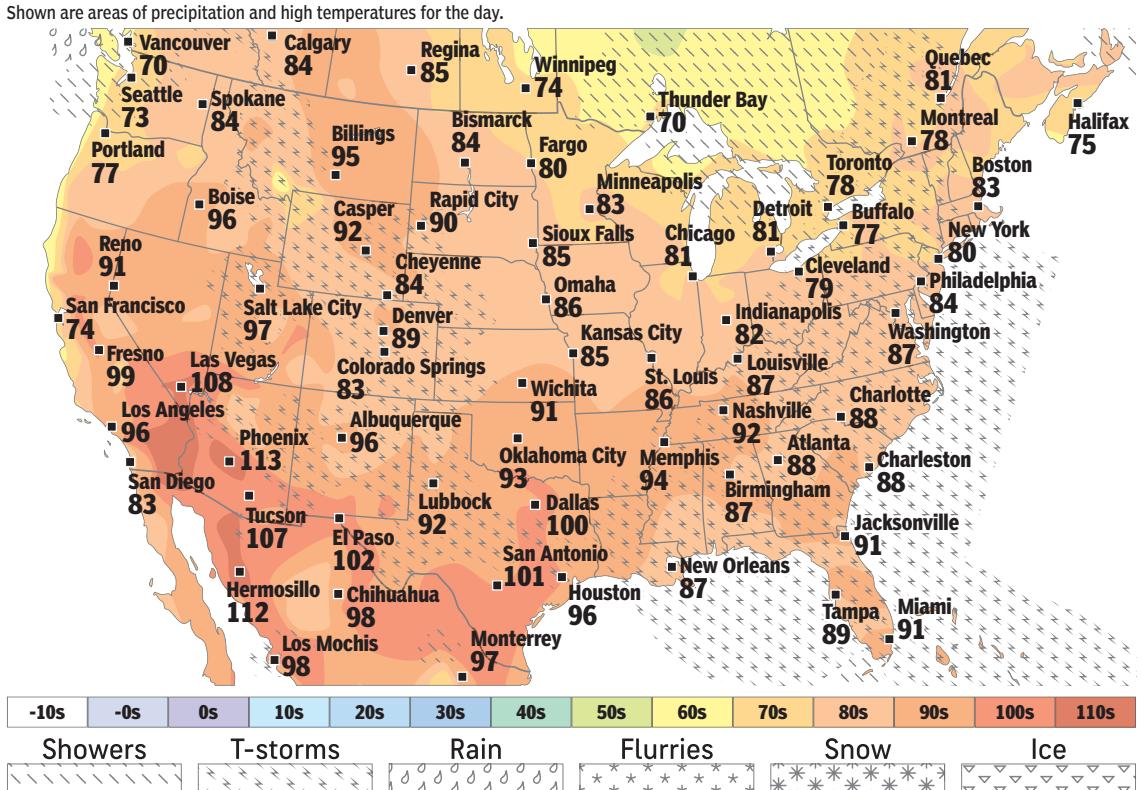
Best viewing times today: Venus: 8 p.m.
Mars: 5:40 a.m. Jupiter: 5:40 a.m. Saturn: 5:40 a.m. Mercury: not visible

National cities

	Thu.	Fri.
City	Hi/Low/W	Hi/Low/W
Abilene	101/74/t	99/75/s
Albany, NY	81/66/t	80/58/t
Albuquerque	96/69/pc	96/70/s
Amarillo	89/66/t	93/69/pc
Anchorage	61/51/s	60/52/r
Asheville	84/65/t	82/65/t
Aspen	85/52/t	84/54/pc
Atlanta	88/72/t	89/72/t
Atlantic City	82/73/t	78/71/t
Austin	102/75/t	100/76/t
Baltimore	88/69/t	86/66/t
Billings	95/65/pc	85/64/t
Birmingham	87/72/t	90/70/t
Bismarck	84/58/s	85/61/t
Boise	96/64/pc	83/65/pc
Boston	83/71/c	82/67/t
Brownsville	99/79/pc	99/79/pc
Buffalo	77/62/t	73/54/pc
Burlington, VT	82/65/t	75/52/sh
Charleston, SC	88/75/t	86/74/t
Charleston, WV	86/64/t	82/61/s
Charlotte	88/71/t	87/71/t
Chattanooga	90/71/t	90/69/t
Cheyenne	84/59/t	89/62/pc
Cincinnati	83/64/s	83/61/s
Cleveland	79/63/pc	75/55/pc
Colorado Spgs	83/57/t	88/61/pc
Columbia, MO	86/63/s	86/62/s
Columbia, SC	89/73/t	87/70/t
Columbus, OH	83/64/s	82/58/s
Concord	83/66/pc	83/56/t
Corpus Christi	101/77/s	99/77/t
Dallas	100/78/s	98/79/s
Daytona Beach	89/74/t	92/75/t
Denver	89/64/t	93/67/pc
Duluth	74/51/sh	74/56/c
El Paso	102/75/s	101/76/s



National forecast



World cities

	Thu.	Fri.
City	Hi/Low/W	Hi/Low/W
Acapulco	93/77/t	92/77/sh
Algiers	95/72/pc	88/73/s
Amsterdam	83/64/t	72/62/sh
Ankara	90/59/s	80/56/s
Athens	96/76/s	93/76/s
Auckland	64/53/c	64/56/r
Baghdad	116/86/pc	113/91/s
Bangkok	92/81/r	92/81/r
Barbados	88/80/t	88/80/t
Barcelona	87/74/s	88/70/c
Beijing	85/68/pc	74/64/r
Beirut	89/78/s	89/78/s
Berlin	81/62/s	80/61/c
Bermuda	88/80/pc	88/79/pc
Bogota	69/48/r	70/48/c
Brussels	84/63/t	70/60/r
Bucharest	78/60/sh	80/57/s
Budapest	86/63/s	90/69/pc
Buenos Aires	62/54/c	62/49/pc
Cairo	100/78/pc	98/79/s
Cancun	94/76/s	94/76/r
Caracas	91/78/r	92/77/r
Casablanca	82/66/s	81/62/pc
Copenhagen	72/60/pc	68/60/r
Dublin	64/58/sh	71/56/sh
Edmonton	85/51/pc	72/46/s
Frankfurt	91/67/pc	74/58/t
Geneva	86/66/pc	68/55/sh
Guadalajara	84/61/pc	83/61/pc
Havana	93/74/r	93/74/r
Helsinki	69/51/s	69/56/c
Hong Kong	89/82/sh	90/83/r
Istanbul	87/71/s	79/67/sh
Jerusalem	91/71/s	89/71/s
Johannesburg	69/45/pc	70/44/pc
Kabul	91/66/pc	93/69/pc
Kingston	94/80/s	92/81/s

Weather history

Over 1,000 people drowned when a storm surge accompanying a hurricane inundated Charleston, S.C., on Aug. 27, 1893. Such events led to the adoption of hurricane safety plans by emergency officials.

Weather Trivia™

Q: Which five letters are not used to name Atlantic tropical storms?

Do you have a weather question for the ABC 7 team? Submit them at abc7chicago.com/weather or send them to:

Ask ABC 7 Weather Team
190 N. State Street
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Regional cities

	Thu.	Fri.
City	Hi/Low/W	Hi/Low/W
Illinois		
Carbondale	87/61/s	87/59/pc
Champaign	82/59/s	81/57/pc
Decatur	83/61/s	84/58/s
Moline	83/58/s	85/62/s
Peoria	82/61/s	82/61/s
Quincy	83/61/s	84/62/s
Rockford	81/58/s	83/60/s
Springfield	83/60/pc	84/59/s
Sterling	83/57/s	83/61/s
Indiana		
Bloomington	83/60/pc	82/59/s
Evansville	88/66/pc	86/62/s
Fort Wayne	87/57/pc	80/55/s
Indianapolis	82/62/pc	83/60/s
Lafayette	81/58/pc	80/58/s
South Bend	79/55/c	80/56/s
Wisconsin		
Green Bay	79/55/pc	77/60/pc
Kenosha	79/57/s	81/62/pc
La Crosse	83/58/s	85/67/s
Madison	80/57/pc	82/61/pc
Milwaukee	77/62/s	79/64/pc
Wausau	79/53/pc	79/60/s
Michigan		
Detroit	81/62/pc	78/60/s
Grand Rapids	80/55/pc	77/57/pc
Marquette	68/49/sh	69/52/pc
Sault Ste. Marie	71/54/sh	68/53/pc
Traverse City	72/53/sh	73/55/pc
Iowa		
Ames	83/57/s	84/65/s
Cedar Rapids	81/58/s	83/63/pc
Des Moines	83/62/s	86/66/s
Dubuque	80/58/pc	81/61/s

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Ikea coming to Gurnee Mills this fall



A new Ikea store, under construction in Gurnee on Wednesday, will be smaller than the massive full-size stores. JOE LEWNARD/DAILY HERALD

\$2 million in village incentives help to land Swedish retail giant

DAILY HERALD

Gurnee Mills announced a host of new retailers opening this fall at the state’s third-largest mall. The biggest name among those is Ikea’s new 66,000-square-foot store — smaller than the massive full-size stores in Schaumburg and Bolingbrook — opening in a portion of the former Sears Grand Store at 6170 W. Grand Ave. The Swedish furniture giant is converting the space to showcase more than 5,000 products. Full planning services also will be avail-

able to help create kitchens, wardrobes, living rooms, storage and more. The company’s new format store will be its third location in Illinois. It will offer home furnishing accessories and small furniture for delivery or free store pick up. The store is located in Parking Lot B next to Hobby Lobby. The village of Gurnee offered \$2 million in incentives to land the retail giant. Ikea is expected to generate \$2.9 million in sales tax over six years and the village expects to come out \$900,000 ahead. Fashion Q, a women’s fast fashion and apparel store, will open in September near the mall’s Entry B. Nali Jewelers, a family-owned fine jewelry store featuring an assortment of high-quality pieces, also

will open next month near Entry E. Archive Room, which offers deadstock vintage grails to modern luxury essentials, is expected to open in October near Entry C. Also opening in October are Sophia’s Mexican Grill, offering traditional Mexican street eats, in Dining Pavilion North near Entry J, and Toys ‘R’ Us near Entry A. Mall visitors also can explore several new retail and entertainment destinations, including Abuela’s, AJ’s Putt ‘N’ Play, Chocolate Moonshine Co. and Rally House. Come spring, Sky Zone trampoline park, a leader in indoor active entertainment designed for families, will open its new location featuring multiple private party rooms and a Fuel Zone with food and refreshments near Entry J.

Evanston pairs small business startups with vacant retail space in Space to Place incubator



Making a match

By Phil Rockrohr
FOR THE PIONEER PRESS

Evanston has a lot of empty ground-floor retail spaces, while its many residents who are trying to start businesses face the steep costs of establishing a brick-and-mortar presence. The city’s Space to Place retail incubator program is an attempt to fill both needs. Katie Boden, economic development coordinator for the city, said 38 budding store operators applied for space in the inaugural program before the August deadline. “That’s a pretty good response,” Boden said. “We’re really excited about the number of responses we got and the number of people who completed the application.” The city’s economic development team and retail activation strategist Claire Seizovic, who is partnering with the city on the project, will whittle down those 38 applicants to approximately 16 operators who will get the chance to open a temporary business in downtown

Evanston on Oct. 1. “As we go through and review the applications, we’re going to see what works best for the space,” Boden said. Each retailer will get 100 square feet of retail space in a shared 3,000-square-foot storefront downtown, she said. The economic development team examined various ideas for an incubator program for several years before Seizovic, who had privately offered two weekend vendor popup markets in Evanston, reached out to the city with the Space to Place proposal, Boden said. “We have a lot of home-based businesses and makers here, including many who pivoted after Covid,” she said. “Claire has done this in other cities. She is now an Evanston resident and was interested in doing this.” Seizovic said Space to Place was designed in response to a survey of interested business operators last spring. “The survey told us exactly what Evanston business owners need: affordable space, real mentorship, and a clear path

to permanent tenancy,” she said in a prepared statement. Space to Place will provide the retail space until Dec. 31 and offer business training and expert coaching to help operators identify opportunities to open in their own storefronts, Boden said. “The hope is that we’ll be able to help transition them to some more permanent spaces,” she said. “They can look at downtown options or other business districts with cheaper rent. We will identify wrap-around support and funding sources. Ideally, people who want to take it to the next step can get assistance with finding a space and getting support.” Space to Place will present educational workshops during the three-month incubator process and help operators identify their next steps if desired, Boden said. “If a couple transition to permanent storefronts, we would consider that success,” she said. The “wraparound support” will include helping retailers understand business planning and insurance and

legal requirements and identifying Evanston businesses that will offer that support, Boden said. “We will provide them with industry experts to make sure they have all the tools they need,” she said. “We will direct them to potential grants or funding services they could leverage, as well.” The spring survey elicited about 100 responses and confirmed interest in the program, Boden said. The inaugural Space to Place will be limited to retail sales, including prepared food, but not yet space for food preparation. “This is the pilot, the first iteration of doing this,” she said. “Ideally, if we can continue going forward, we will probably look at how we can better support food businesses. For this market, we will be limited to prepackaged items. There is not a kitchen space. We got a lot of interest in that, as well.” The only costs to participants will be \$175 a month in rent and sharing 10 percent of gross monthly sales with the city, Boden said.

Above: Evanston will host a Space to Place business incubator this fall in a rear alley at 1712 Sherman Ave. in Evanston. It gives fledgling businesses a chance to sell products and develop their business approaches. This photo shows a past market at the location. ALEXA VISCUS

General Mills removes artificial colors from all its US cereals

By Victor Stefanescu
THE MINNESOTA STAR TRIBUNE

General Mills has met its own deadline to remove artificial colors from all its cereals, including Trix and Lucky Charms, sold in the United States. The company said Wednesday it met its deadline to remove these colors by the end of the summer and will strive to remove them from all U.S. grocery store products by the end of 2027. Opponents of these dyes have argued consuming them can lead to health concerns. “As the leader in cereal, General Mills is focused on giving people what they are looking for from the brands they know and love,”

said Bethany Quam, the leader of General Mills’ cereal business, in a news release. “This achievement reflects how we are evolving with consumer needs while continuing to offer food that tastes great, delivers quality and provides value.” Based in Golden Valley, General Mills has long sold pantry staples such as Cinnamon Toast Crunch and Cheerios. These products make up a significant chunk of the company’s grocery store product portfolio, which includes Gushers, Totino’s Pizza Rolls and more. Pressure has mounted in recent years on big food companies to make their products healthier as the “better-for-you” food trend swept through households. This, and government oversight, has spurred

food companies to change some of their ingredients and the use of artificial colors such as Red No. 40, Yellow No. 5 and Blue No. 1 in their products. General Mills committed in July 2025 to remove artificial dyes from school food by the summer of 2026, a goal it met months early this March. The company, which is looking to increase sales, said in a news release Tuesday that it has nixed the colors from 90% of its U.S. grocery store foods. The colors removal, the company said, “reflects how General Mills continues to evolve with consumers by delivering great-tasting, affordable choices while expanding its range of options available for different needs and preferences.”



General Mills has removed artificial colors from all its cereals sold in the U.S., including Trix. ARNE BERULDSSEN/TNS

Meta settles social media addiction claims for \$17B

Facebook, Instagram to adopt child-safety features under deal

By Barbara Ortutay and Kelvin Chan
ASSOCIATED PRESS

OAKLAND, Calif. — Meta agreed Wednesday to pay \$17 billion and add stronger child-safety measures to its Facebook and Instagram platforms as part of a landmark legal settlement that ended a trial over teen social media addiction and settled claims filed by 47 states.

The settlement resolved a pivotal case years in the making that sought to hold the tech giant accountable for the role its platforms played in undermining children’s mental health. The effort targeted features designed to hook young people’s attention.

“For years, Meta intentionally deceived the public about the addictive and harmful design features that have wreaked havoc on youth mental health,” Virginia Attorney General Jay Jones said. The settlement “will put an end to these dangerous practices and deliver meaningful relief that will protect children from online harm.”

If approved by the court, the deal will stop an avalanche of litigation by states against Meta, although the company still faces lawsuits from individuals and school districts across the United States. For the states, the settlement delivers money for programs to benefit kids’ mental health, including after-school or summer activities and digital literacy counselors.

Advocates cheered the new protections, including default time limits and the disabling of features such as “like” counts.

But “we cannot truly protect all children and teens until these protections are required on every platform and are permanent — that’s something only Congress can do,” said Sacha Haworth, executive director of The Tech Oversight Project.

California Attorney General Rob Bonta said the money would be paid out over 10 years, with the state getting at least \$1.5 billion. New Jersey expects to receive at least \$525 million. Massachusetts said it was in line for at least \$366 million. Virginia’s share is worth \$353 million.

The agreement cuts short an ongoing court case involving California, Colorado, Kentucky and New Jersey, which were

among 29 states that sued Meta in 2023. CEO Mark Zuckerberg was among those expected to take the stand before a jury in federal court in California.

The lawsuit accused Meta of contributing to the youth mental health crisis by deliberately designing features that addict children to its platforms and hiding them from the public. The case also argued that Meta violated federal laws by routinely collecting data on children younger than 13 without their parents’ consent.

The trial kicked off last week in Oakland, California, with U.S. District Judge Yvonne Gonzalez Rogers overseeing the proceedings. Adam Mosseri, the head of Instagram, began his testimony late Tuesday and defended Meta’s record and progress on child safety and privacy.

The cases in other states had been expected to go to trial later. In addition, nine attorneys general filed lawsuits in their respective states.

Under the proposed settlement, Meta agreed to adopt a series of safety features. An independent auditor will assess how Meta is implementing the safety features and how effective they are.

Growth of US economy in Q2 stays on 1.5% pace

By Paul Wiseman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The U.S. economy grew at a sluggish 1.5% pace from April through June. But consumer spending stayed strong.

Growth in gross domestic product — the nation’s output of a goods and services — decelerated from a 2.1% pace from January through March, the Commerce Department reported Wednesday. The second-quarter growth number was unchanged from the department’s first estimate.

Still, consumer spending — which accounts for about 70% of U.S. economic activity — increased at a healthy 3.4% annual clip, up from 0.5% in the January-March period.

The reason for the lackluster growth was imports. They are subtracted from growth because GDP is only supposed to count domestic production. Imports rose at a 12.5% annual pace from April through June, partly due to a surge in shipments of computer chips and other products that support artificial intelligence investment, and sliced 1.64 percentage points off second-quarter growth.

The U.S. economy has proven surprisingly resilient in the face of fighting with Iran and a spike in energy prices. Business investment, excluding housing, rose at a 8.5% pace in the second quarter, reflecting the AI investment boom. And a measure of the economy’s underlying strength — which strips out volatile government spending and trade numbers — grew at a strong 4.2% rate, up from 1.7% in the first quarter.

Investment in housing rose, ticking up for the first time since the end of 2024. The housing market has been depressed by high mortgage rates.

Wednesday’s report was the second of three Commerce Department looks at second-quarter GDP growth. The third and final report is due Sept. 30.

Scream factor overlooked

Universal built ‘whisper quiet’ coaster to appease neighbors, but riders prove enthusiastic

By Brooks Barnes
THE NEW YORK TIMES

TOLUCA LAKE, Calif. — After three years of painstaking work, Universal Studios Hollywood recently pulled off a seemingly impossible feat: It built a 72-mph, looping roller coaster with spinning “Fast & Furious” cars — that barely makes a sound.

Universal had good reason to obsess. Residential neighborhoods press against the theme park, and its own movie studio operates alongside it. To silence the ride, Universal went so far as to fill the 4,100-foot track with pea gravel, muting the vibrations that give coasters their roar.

When riderless testing began last month, residents in nearby Toluca Lake were delighted, with several calling the attraction “whisper quiet.”

Then came the riders.

Every 30 seconds or so, for 10 hours straight, according to interviews with more than a dozen homeowners, the air is now filled with the sound of humans who fear they’re in mortal peril.

“Screams — bloodcurdling screams,” said Craig Strong, who has lived near Universal Studios Hollywood for 25 years. “Some people can hear it inside their homes with the windows closed.”

Neighbors have one demand. Universal must somehow find a way to muffle its very happy customers.

Comcast, which owns the park, has been counting on Hollywood Drift to revive attendance and compete with an expanding Disneyland to the south. Universal Studios Hollywood attracted 8.8 million visitors in 2024, down 10% from 2023, according to the Themed Entertainment Association, which has yet to release 2025 figures.

Universal declined to say how much the ride cost.

But theme park analysts say attractions of this size and complexity typically cost \$200 million or more.

Hollywood Drift was still in “technical rehearsals” last week, according to Universal, with no opening date beyond what the company has said since February: “summer.”

Universal said in an email to neighborhood groups that audio measurements showed the ride was “operating in compliance with sound ordinance requirements.”

Universal added that it was nonetheless “exploring additional measures to further lessen sound levels experienced in adjacent neighborhoods.” Workers have begun



The new Fast & Furious: Hollywood Drift roller coaster runs Aug. 10 at Universal Studios Hollywood in Los Angeles. ADAM AMENGUAL/THE NEW YORK TIMES

expanding a sound wall.

Universal took screaming into account from the start. Using computer modeling, ride designers mapped where screams were most likely to occur and incorporated defenses. Hollywood Drift was built with two “scream screens,” half-pipe-like glass shields meant to “encase sound at the source,” Universal has said. There is also a 940-foot sound wall made with Acoustiblok, a dense, rubbery material used to insulate buildings near airports.

What worked in computer models,

however, has proved less effective against actual lungs.

Now residents are making noise of their own, flooding elected officials with complaints and demanding that neighborhood councils, which serve as conduits to City Hall, get involved. One coalition said it had hired its own sound consultants. Another said it had approached law firms to find out what representation would cost.

“I have a feeling this isn’t going to be over anytime soon,” said Leonard R. Garner, who has lived next to Universal for 28 years.

Inflation gauge remains elevated amid Iran war

By Christopher Rugaber
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — An inflation measure closely watched by the Federal Reserve stayed elevated last month in the latest sign that many Americans are still struggling with higher costs.

Stubbornly high prices are shaping up to be a key issue in the midterm elections, particularly as the Iran war keeps gas prices high, President Donald Trump is threatening new tariffs on Canada and China, and spending on AI infrastructure has pushed up the cost of computers, gaming consoles and semiconductors.

Inflation remained high in July even as gas prices fell, partly because the cost of

services — including healthcare, utilities and financial services — jumped.

Yet the government plans to change the way it calculates the cost of some services starting with next month’s figures, which could lower measured inflation.

The Commerce Department’s Wednesday report showed that prices rose 3.7% in July compared with a year earlier, the same as June. Inflation has worsened since the U.S. and Israel attacked Iran in late February, when it stood at 2.9%. It’s noticeably above the Fed’s target of 2%.

Wednesday’s figures are from the personal consumption expenditures price index, a separate gauge from the more widely followed consumer price index, which was reported earlier this month. The

PCE index is running hotter than the CPI, partly because it puts less weight on rental costs, which have been cooling steadily in recent months.

Excluding the volatile food and energy categories, core inflation was also unchanged at 3.3% in July. It had fallen to 2.6% before President Donald Trump imposed sweeping tariffs in April 2025.

On a monthly basis, overall prices rose 0.2% from June to July, after declining 0.1% the previous month and jumping 0.5% in May. Core prices also moved up 0.2% from June to July, up from 0.1% in the previous month. Some Fed officials have said that core inflation running at about 0.2% a month would be a reassuring sign that inflation is heading back to the 2% target.

Business briefs

MUSK FIRM TO BUILD ROCKET LAUNCHING SITE IN LOUISIANA

ABBEVILLE, La. — Elon Musk’s space company SpaceX plans to spend \$100 billion to build a massive new spaceport in Louisiana to launch rockets, state officials and the company announced Tuesday.

The spaceport would be located on 125,000 acres of land formerly owned by Exxon along Louisiana’s southern coast about 200 miles west of New Orleans in Vermilion Parish.

The location provides key advantages, state officials said, including access to abundant natural gas and the ability to launch to a wide range of trajectories.

It would be SpaceX’s fourth and largest launch site, playing a key role in ramping up missions of its reusable Starship launch system, according to a news release.

The Louisiana site could support thousands of launches each year, the news release said. — *Associated Press*

PRO-RUSSIAN HACKERS ATTACK DIGITAL SERVICES IN NORWAY

OSLO, Norway — A pro-Russian hacker group on Wednesday claimed responsibility for a cyberattack that has affected multiple Norwegian government digital services.

The cyberattack has been ongoing since Monday, Are Kvistad, a spokesperson for the Norwegian Digitalization Agency (Digdir), told The Associated Press.

The denial-of-service attacks meant that hackers pushed massive traffic toward the agency in order to block services, including one that enables citizens to use one login across multiple public services. However, the Digdir spokesman said that the agency kept the services running “practically all the time.”

In a Telegram post Wednesday, the pro-Russian hacker group Server Killers said it had declared cyber war on Norway after the country renewed its security cooperation with Ukraine on Sunday. — *Associated Press*

DUBAI AIRPORT REPORTS DROP IN Q2 TRAFFIC DUE TO CONFLICT

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — Dubai International Airport, one of the world’s busiest hubs, said Wednesday it saw a sharp drop in passengers during the second quarter as the Iran war disrupted air travel and prompted many travelers to choose routes that avoided the Middle East.

The airport recorded 13 million passengers during the second quarter of 2026, following 31.5 million passengers in the first quarter. That was a 31.3% drop over passenger traffic in the first half of 2025, the airport said.

Air traffic in the United Arab Emirates and elsewhere in the Gulf region was disrupted by shutdowns and restrictions after the United States and Israel attacked Iran on Feb. 28.

Aircraft movements totaled 150,600 in the first half, down 32.1% year on year, with only 62,500 in the second quarter, the airport said. — *Associated Press*

Tech companies undergoing detox of generative AI waste

By Tiffany Hsu
THE NEW YORK TIMES

SAN FRANCISCO — The worst of artificial intelligence slop has cluttered Google searches with recipes for glue-topped pizza, Amazon listings with sham biographies and Facebook feeds with images of Shrimp Jesus.

The digital sewage heap has sprawled across tech platforms, cheapening meaningful content and polluting the information ecosystem, as chatbots and video generators continue to advance.

Now, Silicon Valley wants to take out the trash.

Spotify said it removed 75 million bulk uploads, duplicate songs and other “spammy” tracks last year — a sizable chunk of the music streaming platform’s total portfolio. LinkedIn said in July that “AI slop is a top priority for all of us” and developed a button for users to report it. Researchers from YouTube’s parent company, Google, described how a video service wiped 130,000 channels of low-quality content off its platform over six months.

Tech companies are undertaking a generative waste detox, overwhelmed in many cases by the same slop first made possible by their own AI tools. Mobile messaging apps, restaurant review sites, scholarly archives and dating services are all rooting out or downplaying junk generated by AI.

People are tiring of AI’s effect on the environment and its pressure on jobs and mental health. AI slop is just another “festering wound,” said Aidan Walker, a content creator and researcher studying online trends for the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace, a global affairs think tank.

“Users have gradually gotten more and more upset about it,” he said. “The climate of opinion has now recognizably shifted, so these companies are finally confronting these problems.”

Generative AI can



The Google campus is located in Mountain View, California. **KELSEY MCCLELLAN/THE NEW YORK TIMES 2025**

produce increasingly realistic images, audio and videos, but only some of it qualifies as slop. Tech companies are largely targeting the kind of low-grade clickbait that is easy to make, spread, consume and forget — the fast fashion edging out couture, the pink slime subsuming the steak.

Unchecked, the synthetic swamp online could “crowd out human creativity, corrode cultural value and destabilize public discourse,” European researchers wrote last year.

Slop has become so prevalent that dictionary publisher Merriam-Webster chose it as its word of the year in 2025.

Deezer, a French streaming service, said this spring that nearly half the tracks updated to its system each day were artificially generated, many of them never heard by users. AI generates more than a third of what is uploaded to Apple Music.

Adam Mosseri, head of Instagram, said last year that it would soon “be more practical” to trace “real media than fake media.” His observation came not long after Meta, Instagram’s parent company, rolled out an all-AI video stream derided by many as a showcase for slop.

Many tech companies now trying to manage AI slop are also the ones enabling it. In July, Meta promised to support a European pact to make AI-generated content

more identifiable via detection, labeling and tagging. That same month, the company also released an image generator that automatically opted in public Instagram accounts as a reference for the tool. (Meta removed the feature after three days of backlash.)

“AI slop is a double-edged sword in that a lot of these platforms experienced upticks in engagement as a result of it,” said Paul Shovlin, an expert in AI at Ohio University. “But then, it got to a point where it became a liability because there’s so much flotsam and jetsam that it’s now hard for users to find the kind of quality that they’re looking for.”

Chris Best, CEO of Substack, wrote last month that “it’s getting harder to tell what’s real on the internet,” and that “platforms that reward fakeness will create a race to the bottom.” The newsletter platform announced its own AI detection tool for users, powered by Pangram, which is designed to scan replies, comments and posts longer than 100 words and decide whether they were likely written by hand or with AI.

Some newsletter writers complained the tool mistook posts written by humans as AI-generated and put undue pressure on authors to defend their reputations against an opaque metric.



Minister of Finance and National Revenue Francois-Philippe Champagne speaks Tuesday on Canada’s response to U.S. tariffs in Ottawa. **JUSTIN TANG/CANADIAN PRESS**

Canada targeting hundreds of goods as trade war intensifies

By Wyattte
Grantham-Philips
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Canada has pledged to roll out “dollar-for-dollar” countertariffs on scores of U.S. goods next month in response to President Donald Trump’s latest import taxes, which have plunged the North American neighbors deeper into a bitter trade war.

Ottawa released a list of more than 700 targets.

Starting Sept. 8, Canada’s government says it will impose steeper import taxes on goods ranging from fish and cheese to smartphones and steel imported from the United States.

Canada said it was focusing its retaliation on products “most affected by U.S. tariffs.” The levies will be set at 15%, 25% or 50% — rates that the government said would match U.S. tariffs on goods targeted in Washington’s latest round as well as products covered by previously imposed sectoral duties.

Some of the many U.S. items Canada is now targeting include:

- Live and frozen fish, crustaceans, oysters and mussels
- Cheese and curd products
- Natural honey, molasses and baking mixtures
- Perfume, makeup and hair

- Carpets and other floor coverings
- Toilet paper, facial tissues and envelopes
- T-shirts, jackets, coats and gloves
- Various metal products made of steel or aluminum, including wire, rods, pipes and foil
- Stoves, ranges, refrigerators and other household appliances
- Smartphones and video game consoles
- Motorcycles and trailers
- Fishing rods and exercise equipment

The new tariffs on these products will carry rates of 15%, 25% or 50%. Canada’s tariffs on many American products would double from 25% to 50%, with the largest share of the new measures affecting steel and aluminum.

The Trump administration already outlined its own lengthy list of more than 550 Canadian products that are now subject to 50% tariffs. That list includes natural honey, vegetable seeds and flower bulbs; alcoholic beverages such as beer and vermouth; ice skates and other sports accessories; various household goods; and smartphones.

Trump imposed the tariffs by reaching back to a long-dormant Great Depres-

sion-era law. Section 338 of the Tariff Act of 1930, which has never been used before, authorizes the president to impose import taxes of up to 50% on goods from countries that have discriminated against U.S. businesses.

Trump claimed that Canada discriminated against U.S. autos, alcohol and dairy products, following the implementation of his earlier import taxes last year. It’s worth noting that the list of Canadian goods facing the latest levy is more diverse.

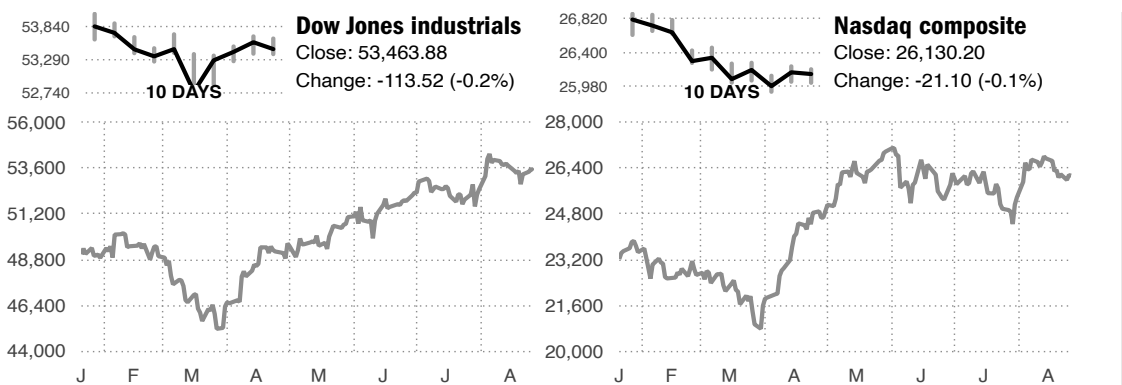
Threats of stronger countermeasures and further escalation have continued to pile up and it’s possible that more products could face steeper import taxes.

Trump took to social media Monday to say that his administration would also increase tariffs on Canadian cars, trucks, automotive parts and steel to 50% starting Jan. 1, 2027. Like other countries, Canada currently faces a broader 25% tariff on autos. A 50% sectoral tariff on most steel imports is already in effect.

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney accused Washington of trying to subordinate Canada and said U.S. demands during the failed talks showed that Americans wanted to “destroy our major industries.”

Market Roundup

 DOW 53,463.88 -113.52 -0.21%	 NASDAQ 26,130.20 -21.10 -0.08%	 S&P 500 7,675.70 -1.58 -0.02%	 EURO 1.1652 -0.0018 -0.16%	 CRUDE OIL 82.23 -0.13 -0.16%	 GOLD 4,598.20 -39.90 -0.86%	 6-MO T-BILLS 3.91 -0.01 -0.26%	 30-YR T-BONDS 5.17 0.01 0.15%
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StocksRecap

	NYSE	NASD
Vol. (in mil.)	3657	3361
Pvs. Volume	3878	3395
Advanced	1202	1396
Declined	1400	1925
New Highs	41	132
New Lows	26	129

	HIGH	LOW	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	WK	MO	QTR	YTD
DOW	53,639.75	53,379.40	53,463.88	-113.52	-0.21%	▲	▲	▲	+11.24%
DOW Trans.	21,713.14	21,384.10	21,583.06	+127.44	+0.59%	▲	▲	▼	+24.35%
DOW Util.	1,099.66	1,089.71	1,095.11	+5.21	+0.48%	▲	▼	▼	+2.53%
NYSE Comp.	24,819.29	24,735.53	24,742.07	-26.58	-0.11%	▲	▲	▲	+12.44%
NASDAQ	26,189.81	26,021.63	26,130.20	-21.10	-0.08%	▼	▲	▼	+12.43%
S&P 500	7,690.73	7,657.41	7,675.70	-1.58	-0.02%	▲	▲	▲	+12.13%
S&P 400	3,834.02	3,796.90	3,822.79	+23.02	+0.61%	▼	▼	▼	+15.66%
DOW Total	76,169.45	75,847.56	76,024.37	-2.03	-0.00%	▼	▲	▲	+12.63%
Russell 2000	3,014.88	3,000.08	3,005.90	-4.12	-0.14%	▼	▲	▼	+21.11%

LOCAL STOCKS

NAME	CLOSE	CHG	%CHG	YTD CHG	LO	HI	DIV
ANI Pharmaceuticals Inc.	74.56	-1.09	-1.4%	-4.38	70.15	99.50	...
AbbVie Inc.	262.90	-2.89	-1.1%	+34.41	190.75	267.47	6.92
Abbott Laboratories	114.10	-2.03	-1.7%	-11.19	81.97	137.49	2.52
Acco Brands Corp.	4.19	-0.02	-0.5%	+4.6	2.81	4.56	0.30
Allstate Corp., The	261.81	+4.19	+1.6%	+53.66	188.08	277.22	4.32
AptarGroup Inc.	135.24	+5.2	+0.4%	+13.28	103.23	146.91	1.92
Archer Daniels Midland Cc	80.09	+9.3	+1.2%	+22.60	55.58	88.46	2.08
Baxter International Inc.	26.50	+2.1	+0.8%	+7.39	15.73	30.00	0.04
Boeing Co.	212.09	+1.01	+0.5%	-5.03	176.77	254.35	8.22
Brunswick Corp.	79.67	-0.66	-0.8%	+5.43	58.56	90.25	1.76
CDW	141.46	-0.63	-0.4%	+5.26	97.12	171.55	2.52
CF Industries Holdings Inc	125.70	-1.56	-1.2%	+48.36	75.42	141.96	2.40
CME Group Inc.	280.96	+3.66	+1.3%	+7.88	218.31	329.16	5.20
CNA Financial Corp.	49.45	+3.1	+0.6%	+1.71	41.53	55.71	1.92
Century Aluminum	43.95	-0.25	-0.6%	+4.77	20.91	70.43	...
Chicago Rivet & Machine C	10.34	+3.7	+3.7%	-3.57	8.50	15.00	0.12
ConAgra Brands Inc.	16.19	-0.08	-0.5%	-1.12	12.53	20.32	0.70
Deere & Co.	634.54	+3.88	+0.6%	+168.97	433.48	674.19	6.48
Distribution Solutions Grp	34.81	.00	0.0%	+7.42	19.02	35.06	0.48
Dover Corp.	204.66	+2.60	+1.3%	+9.42	158.97	237.54	2.10
Enova International Inc.	236.62	-6.77	-2.8%	+79.42	103.02	267.45	...
Equity Lifestyle Propert. In	64.65	-0.70	-1.1%	+4.04	58.72	69.00	2.17
Exelon Corp.	44.44	+1.3	+0.3%	+8.5	42.58	50.65	1.68
Federal Signal Corp.	121.53	+0.88	+0.7%	+12.94	101.18	134.51	0.60
First Indust.Realty Trust In	62.86	-0.63	-1.0%	+5.59	50.24	69.88	2.00
First Mid Bancshares Inc.	50.30	+1.6	+0.3%	+11.30	34.16	53.36	1.04
Fortune Brands Innovation	46.31	+6.4	+1.4%	-3.71	32.34	64.84	1.04
FreightCar America Inc.	7.27	+0.2	+0.3%	-3.80	7.08	14.90	0.36
Fuel Technologies Inc.	1.43	+0.5	+3.6%	-0.13	1.17	3.65	...
GATX Corp.	178.49	-0.76	-0.4%	+8.89	150.42	205.56	2.64
Gallagher & Co., Arthur J.	265.03	-3.48	-1.3%	+6.24	190.75	313.55	2.80
Grainger Inc., W.W.	1335.39	+33.71	+2.6%	+326.34	906.52	1419.91	9.96
Great Lakes Dre.&Dock Cc	17.00	.00	+0.2%	+3.88	10.71	17.02	0.08
Groupon Inc.	19.06	-0.53	-2.7%	+1.45	9.17	29.90	...
Hub Group Inc.	40.00	+0.77	+2.0%	-2.61	32.90	53.26	0.50
Huron Consulting Group Ir	156.57	-2.63	-1.7%	-16.34	84.88	186.78	...
Hyatt Hotels Corp.	177.57	+5.6	+0.3%	+17.25	134.18	206.86	0.60
IDEX Corp.	234.89	+4.62	+2.0%	+56.95	158.19	243.80	2.92
IF Bancorp. Inc.	26.55	.00	-1.5%	-0.41	23.95	29.00	0.40
Illinois Tool Works Inc.	285.51	+3.86	+1.4%	+39.21	238.82	303.16	6.88
Ingredion Inc.	104.74	-0.29	-0.3%	-5.52	94.44	130.48	3.28

JBT Marel Corp.	119.93	+2.00	+1.7%	-30.74	113.23	170.19	0.40
JPMorgan Chase & Co.	356.50	-0.19	-0.1%	+34.28	279.10	366.50	6.00
John B. Sanfilippo & Son I	75.76	+9.3	+1.2%	+5.16	59.07	92.08	0.95
Jones Lang Lasalle Inc.	386.08	-6.71	-1.7%	+49.61	259.83	393.84	0.43
Kemper Corp.	28.41	+6.3	+2.3%	-12.13	22.69	54.64	1.28
Knowles Corp.	34.54	+9.0	+2.7%	+13.11	20.57	42.93	...
Kraft Heinz	24.79	-0.53	-2.1%	+5.4	21.04	28.09	1.60
LKQ Corp.	25.75	+3.8	+1.5%	-4.45	21.17	37.13	1.20
Lifeway Foods Inc.	26.47	+3.1	+1.2%	+2.24	17.31	34.20	0.08
Littelfuse Inc.	418.72	+13.33	+3.3%	+165.80	233.36	500.57	3.20
MYR Group Inc. (Del.)	312.83	+16.69	+5.6%	+94.33	171.51	503.56	...
McDonald's Corp.	266.93	-1.17	-0.4%	-38.70	260.96	341.75	7.44
Methode Electronics Inc.	17.06	+1.01	+6.3%	+10.42	4.88	20.38	0.20
Middleby Corp	115.44	+1.47	+1.3%	-4.16	89.15	148.20	...
Mondelez International Inc	63.00	+0.02	+0.0%	+9.17	51.20	66.65	2.00
Morningstar Inc.	212.44	-2.57	-1.2%	-4.87	141.49	265.73	2.00
Motorola Solutions Inc.	487.28	+1.89	+0.4%	+103.96	359.36	493.57	4.84
NISOURCE Inc.	41.13	+4.8	+1.2%	-0.63	38.45	49.21	2.00
Northern Trust Corp.	187.65	+8.4	+0.4%	+51.06	121.12	193.89	3.52
Oil-Dri Corp. of America	90.48	-1.21	-1.3%	+41.54	45.61	107.00	0.90
Old Republic Intl Corp.	42.45	+3.4	+0.8%	-3.19	36.65	46.76	1.26
Old Second Bancorp Inc.	25.23	+0.6	+0.2%	+5.73	16.65	26.06	0.28
OneSpan Inc.	15.36	-0.02	-0.2%	+2.52	10.07	18.48	0.52
Packaging Corp. of Americ	246.68	+1.4	+0.1%	+40.45	191.50	259.98	6.00
Paylocity Holding Corp.	152.04	-0.20	-0.1%	-0.46	93.27	181.97	...
Portillo's Inc.	4.75	-0.10	-2.1%	+2.1	3.78	7.18	...
Richardson Electronics Ltr	17.78	+9.1	+5.4%	+6.90	9.37	23.15	0.24
Ryan Specialty Holdings Ir	43.26	-0.67	-1.5%	-8.37	29.28	59.18	0.52
Stapan Co.	62.67	+6.3	+1.0%	+15.31	41.82	68.00	1.58
Suncoke Energy Inc.	9.82	+0.6	+0.6%	+2.62	5.52	9.93	0.48
Telephone & Data Systems	33.28	-0.54	-1.6%	-7.72	31.51	49.12	0.16
Titan International Inc.	7.05	-0.14	-1.9%	-0.78	6.37	11.70	0.02
Tootsie Roll Industries Inc.	41.31	-0.08	-0.2%	+4.68	34.44	45.06	0.36
TransUnion	84.50	-0.51	-0.6%	-1.25	63.37	95.50	0.50
US Foods Holding Corp.	108.46	-0.43	-0.4%	+33.14	69.88	111.42	...
Ultra Beauty Inc.	543.18	+5.97	+1.1%	-61.83	443.60	714.97	...
United Airlines	114.83	-2.58	-2.2%	+3.01	84.64	138.77	...
Ventas Inc.	93.50	-3.33	-0.4%	+16.12	66.38	101.60	2.08
Wintrust Financial Corp.	153.10	+2.01	+1.3%	+13.28	119.61	167.22	2.20
Yunhong Green CTI Ltd.	2.92	.00	0.0%	-0.71	2.38	10.29	...
Zebra Technologies Corp.	359.83	-0.68	-0.2%	+117.01	199.05	386.23	...

Commodities

Wheat rose 6.56% to \$7.31, leading gains. Natural gas increased 2.60% to \$2.84. Orange juice fell 3.21% to \$1.51, marking the largest decline.



Foreign Exchange

Indian Rupee rose most at 1.82%, while British Pound fell most at -0.38%. South Korean Won increased 1.66%. Swedish Krona gained 0.67%.



Interest rates



The yield on the 10-year Treasury note rose to 4.65%.

Yields affect interest rates on mortgages and other consumer loans.

	PRIME	FED	FUNDS
YEST	6.75	3.63	
6 MO AGO	6.75	3.63	
1YR AGO	6.75	3.63	

	CLOSE
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Himalayan disaster kills at least 160

47 from US among hundreds missing in Nepal, China floods

By Niranjan Shrestha and Sibi Arasu
ASSOCIATED PRESS

UDIN DHUNGA, Nepal — Massive flash floods in a border area of Nepal and China on Wednesday killed at least 160 people and left hundreds of tourists, workers and others missing after sweeping through communities and bringing travel in some areas to a halt.

Experts said an avalanche from a glacier was the likely cause in the warming Himalaya region.

Police in Nepal reported at least 157 dead. China's state broadcaster CCTV reported at least three dead and 265 missing in the Tibet region's Gyirong County near the border.

Drone footage showed roads destroyed and buildings buried by thundering water the color of wet cement.

The region's steep valleys are economic lifelines and travel corridors but precarious ones when disaster strikes.

Images showed what appeared to be the second floors of buildings in Nepal's hard-hit Nuwakot district slathered in mud after the torrent rushed by. Debris hung from tree branches and wires, vehicles were buried and some stunned survivors were caked in mud.

There was little time for anyone to flee.

"When I reached Dhunge bazaar, in half an hour, the flood came and damaged all the market. People were preparing to go to office



A boy stares at the devastation caused by flash floods Wednesday in Nepal's Nuwakot district. **NIRANJAN SHRESTHA/AP**

then," resident Shoyam Rajbhandari said. "How many people are missing or dead, we don't know."

Officials in Nepal said 403 people, including 341 foreign nationals, were reported missing.

Sunil Sharma, a tourism board spokesperson, said 133 were from India on pilgrimage to Mount Kailash in Tibet, a sacred site for Hindus.

Also missing were 47 from the United States, 34 from Australia, 33 from Britain and 24 from Canada, he said.

The State Department said it was aware of Americans affected.

At least 62 missing Nepali citizens were among hundreds of locals trekking

in the Gosaikunda Lake area in hard-hit Rasuwa district bordering Tibet's Gyirong, coinciding with the local festival of Janai Purnima on Friday, Sharma said.

Though the current monsoon season is less favorable for trekking in Nepal, it's a major season for Kailash trekking, which follows the route in Nepal's Rasuwa district.

Nepal police spokesperson Abi Narayan Kafle said at least 28 police officials were missing.

Officials warned residents in several districts to stay away from the banks of the Trishuli, Bhotekoshi and Narayani rivers.

At least 19 bridges and nearly 25 miles of road were

swept away. The Bhotekoshi flooded around 9 a.m. Wednesday, destroying several villages and hydropower projects, officials said.

"We have asked both India and China to help us with the rescue efforts," said government spokesperson Sasmit Pokharel.

The U.S. Geological Survey first reported a magnitude 4.4 earthquake early Wednesday, 41 miles north of Kathmandu, near the border. The USGS later updated to call the shaking a 5.2 magnitude landslide.

South Korean government officials said nine citizens working on building a hydropower plant in Nepal were among those reported missing. Malaysia's foreign ministry said its embassy received

reports from travel agencies that they had lost contact with 11 Malaysians believed to be in Rasuwa district. The Russian Embassy in Nepal said four citizens reportedly in the affected area were missing.

Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke with Nepal's Prime Minister Balendra Shah and offered help.

"India is prepared to provide Nepal with all possible types of humanitarian assistance. Our teams are closely coordinating on rescue and relief efforts," Modi said on social media.

Some United Nations bodies were deploying "in an effort to meet what will clearly be massive humani-

tarian need," U.N. spokesperson Stephane Dujarric said.

In a joint statement, Australia, Britain, the European Union, Finland, France, Norway and Switzerland expressed solidarity with people in Nepal, adding: "We encourage all those in affected areas to follow the guidance of local authorities and official safety advisories as the situation continues to evolve."

Climate experts at the Kathmandu-based International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development said an avalanche from a glacier likely caused Wednesday's flash flood.

"Hydrological observations indicate the exceptional speed and magnitude of the flood wave," they said in an emailed statement, noting that water levels at one point on the Trishuli river rose by as much as 27 feet in a half-hour.

The Lhende Khola River, a tributary of the Bhotekoshi, had maximum flooding, they said.

The region saw similar flash floods in August last year, when a glacial lake in Tibet overflowed because of high temperatures. Nine people were killed, and critical infrastructure, including a bridge connecting Nepal and China, was damaged.

The Himalayan region, which spans several countries, is especially vulnerable to heavy rains, floods and landslides because of warming due to human-caused climate change.

Researchers in Kathmandu found this year that glaciers across the Hindu Kush Himalaya region are melting at an accelerating rate, with ice loss rates doubling since 2000.

Short-timers take aim at Social Security problem

Senate lame ducks Cassidy, Durbin work to stop projected cuts

By Kevin Freking
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — With the few months they have left as senators, Democrat Dick Durbin and Republican Bill Cassidy have embarked on a mission to save tens of millions of Social Security beneficiaries from a projected 22% cut in their benefits, starting in just six years.

It is one of the most perilous political efforts that a member of Congress can undertake, so it is telling that the push is being led by two lawmakers who have little to lose at this stage of their careers.

"We've been at this six years, eight years. It's incredible how long I've been at it," Cassidy said. "But Durbin came up to me and he goes, 'Bill, I'm leaving the Senate soon. We need to take a ride at it.'"

Their idea to extend Social Security's solvency is one of a few that have been formally offered this Congress. None has gained much traction, but

it is a start as more lawmakers weigh in on a problem that will likely confront the group of senators elected this fall as well as the next president. Pressure for action is sure to grow as 2032 draws closer.

The measure that Durbin, D-Ill., and Cassidy, R-La., are pushing would not dictate an outcome, but instead set up a process for Congress to take action. It calls for the bipartisan Social Security Advisory Board to collect public input and submit draft legislation to Congress that would keep the program's retirement trust fund solvent for at least 50 years.

The resulting bill would then be introduced by the majority leaders of the Senate and House. If they do not want to go along, any member could sponsor the bill. It would then be referred to the two committees with jurisdiction over Social Security — the Senate Finance Committee and the House Ways and Means Committee.

Both committees would have the chance to debate the bill and amend it if they wish. If not, the original bill drafted by the advisory board would be placed on the Senate and

House calendars for consideration. Lawmakers could offer substitute proposals, with final votes after 100 hours of debate. Passage would require a three-fifths vote in the 100-member Senate and a simple majority in the 435-member House.

Even though the bill does not prescribe a solution for replenishing Social Security, sponsors have struggled to win support.

Cassidy voiced exasperation in a recent floor speech.

"For some people, the time to do Social is never," Cassidy said. "Don't disturb Congress. They don't want to take a tough vote. Even if that vote only sets up a process."

AARP has come out against the bill, saying that the effort amounts to "fast-tracking" Social Security changes through a process that limits what type of amendments are offered and sets arbitrary procedural deadlines.

Separately, Cassidy has a proposal with Sen. Tim Kaine, D-Va., that calls for the creation of a \$1.5 trillion fund that would be invested in stocks and other higher-risk assets over 75 years.

The seed money would be financed by the Treasury



Sen. Bill Cassidy, seen Aug. 6, and Sen. Dick Durbin are working to save tens of millions of Social Security beneficiaries from a projected 22% cut in benefits. **WIN MCNAMEE/GETTY**

Department through additional borrowing.

At the end of the 75 years, the fund's assets would be used to repay the Treasury for the seed money as well as the borrowing that would occur over those years to keep Social Security payments going out — now projected at about \$26.6 trillion.

Cassidy projects such an investment fund would earn enough to cover about two-thirds of that \$26.6 trillion in borrowing, meaning other actions such as raising payroll taxes or cutting benefits would still be required to completely close the gap.

But those tax increases or benefit cuts would be smaller

than otherwise necessary without the investment fund.

"The advantage of the 'Save Our Seniors Fund' is that it lessens your political battle," Cassidy said.

Debt watchdogs are worried. The Committee for a Responsible Federal Budget said "this is a dangerous, debt-funded gamble that would come with huge risks and costs."

Sens. Elizabeth Warren, D-Mass., and Bernie Moreno, R-Ohio, do not agree on much, but they have joined forces in calling for lifting the cap on the Social Security payroll tax.

The payroll tax that funds Social Security applies to

a maximum of \$184,500 in income. That means most pay Social Security taxes on all of their income, but the wealthier do not.

Some conservative groups have forcefully pushed back on the idea, saying the tax increase would lead to lower wages and fewer jobs at businesses seeking to offset the additional tax burden.

Eliminating the cap would generate more than \$3.2 trillion for the trust fund over the course of a decade, according to the Peter G. Peterson Foundation, a nonpartisan debt watchdog.

Others have called for lifting the cap, but only above a certain income threshold.

FDA OKs landmark pancreatic cancer drug that improves survival time

By Matthew Perrone and Luran Neergaard
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Food and Drug Administration on Wednesday approved a groundbreaking new drug for advanced pancreatic cancer, offering U.S. patients a more effective treatment against one of the deadliest types of cancer.

FDA officials gave expedited approval to the first-of-a-kind pill, called daraxonrasib, which blocks

a mutated protein that fuels tumor growth in more than 90% of pancreatic cancer cases. It's an approach that previously eluded drugmakers for decades.

The daily pills will be sold by Revolution Medicines under the brand name Rasonque. A one-month supply would cost about \$39,800, the company announced.

Patients taking the drug nearly doubled their survival time, with fewer severe side effects, in a study that randomly assigned them to

receive the experimental treatment or more chemotherapy.

The company-funded study enrolled 500 patients whose metastatic, or spreading, cancer had quit responding to prior treatment.

Patients getting the new treatment lived for a median of 13.2 months compared with 6.7 months for chemotherapy recipients. Side effects included skin rash, mouth sores, diarrhea and other digestive issues.

"This is not a cure,

it's one more option for these patients," said Dr. Pashoon Kasi of City of Hope Orange County, a California-based cancer center. "But it's the best option we've ever had."

Pancreatic cancer is among the most deadly forms in large part because it is hard to detect before it starts spreading to other organs.

The American Cancer Society estimates about 67,000 new cases will be diagnosed in the United States this year and more than

52,000 people will die from the disease.

The five-year overall survival rate is 13%.

The drug garnered public attention earlier this year when former Sen. Ben Sasse, R-Nebr., described on CBS' "60 Minutes" how he has had less pain while taking it. A surge in public interest led the FDA to allow "expanded access," before the drug's official approval, for patients who met certain criteria.

Doctors who treat pancre-

atic cancer hope the drug may usher in more new options for other forms of cancer, with scores of experimental drugs in development.

"I think this has opened doors for many other companies," Kasi said. "Downstream I think there are going to be a lot more trials looking at this approach in other tumor types."

The Redwood City, California-based drugmaker is studying its technology for several other forms of cancer, including lung cancer.

Shorter programs soar in popularity

Earning bachelor's in 3 years viewed as solution or shortcut

By Heather Hollingsworth
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Giles Sims, 34, was sick of getting passed over for jobs because he didn't have a college degree.

But with a wife and a widowed mother to help support, he needed a quick solution. So the laid-off web developer turned to one of a growing number of three-year degree programs.

"I can't afford to be out of the workforce for four years. That just seems like forever, and the three-year made it seem less daunting," said Sims, a student at Ensign College, a private Salt Lake City school that recently changed all its bachelor's degrees to require fewer classes than a traditional four-year degree.

The condensed programs have exploded in popularity. As of this spring, 26 states have a college that offers at least one reduced-credit, three-year bachelor's, according to the nonprofit research group RAND.

Advocates say these programs are a solution to the college affordability crisis and a godsend for nontraditional students like Sims.

Critics, however, worry that they'll narrow too much what students learn, confuse employers, limit graduate school options and create headaches in fields that require state licenses.

The American Association of University Professors says the programs devalue the meaning of a college credential.

"This is not innovation. This is just cutting corners," said Todd Wolfson, AAUP's president.

For decades, colleges have offered accelerated programs that let students finish faster, often by forgoing long summer breaks, maximizing transfer credits and condensing semester-long



Giles Sims, seen Aug. 6 on the Utah campus, is getting a 90-hour degree from Ensign College. **MARIELLE SCOTT/AP**

courses into shorter, five- to 10-week terms.

But those programs maintained the same course load, measured as credits. The new programs let students finish faster by completing as few as 90 credit hours. That shaves a year off the typical 120-hour bachelor's degree.

Three-year bachelor's degrees are common in other countries including the United Kingdom, India, France and Italy. But they can create complications for graduates seeking admission to U.S. graduate schools, which sometimes require extra coursework.

Some of the earliest colleges in colonial America, modeled after English institutions like Oxford and Cambridge, initially had three-year degrees, said John Thelin, the author of "A History of American Higher Education." By the 19th century, the four-year format had taken hold, partly because there wasn't an established system of public

high schools to prepare students, Thelin said.

"The colleges would have to kind of start from scratch," he said.

The idea of bringing three-year degrees to the U.S. got attention in 2009 when Robert Zemsky, the founding director of the Institute for Research on Higher Education at the University of Pennsylvania Graduate School of Education, argued in a Newsweek cover story that three-year degrees could shake up a broken system.

But there was a roadblock, he recalled recently. "Accreditors said, 'College is 120 credits, not 90 credits,'" he said.

Years passed. In 2022, amid mounting concerns about college affordability, Zemsky helped revive the idea. The College-in-3 Exchange was born, and dozens of higher education institutions joined the network to look for ways to help students get degrees faster.

The Northwest Commis-

sion on Colleges and Universities was the first accreditor to say yes in 2023, when it approved reduced-credit programs at Ensign and Brigham Young University-Idaho. Other accreditors quickly followed.

As of May, 119 reduced-credit programs had been publicly announced, according to the RAND analysis, which was conducted to help education officials in Ohio as they weigh the feasibility of reduced-credit degrees.

It comes at a time when tuition and fees averaged \$11,950 for in-state students at public schools and \$45,000 at private nonprofits last school year, although many students get discounts that reduce the price, according to a report from the College Board, the nonprofit that oversees the SAT.

Private nonprofit schools offer three-quarters of the reduced-credit programs, frequently online. Typically, they compress the majors by reducing electives. Business

degrees in fields such as marketing and management are the most common, followed by computer and information sciences.

Other majors, such as engineering, with its extensive math requirements, have been harder to shrink. And RAND found just six reduced-credit degrees in teacher education, which involves real-world experience requirements and state licensure.

Jill Cohen, 42, lives on a ranch in rural Yoder, Colorado, and is completing her teaching degree through one such program at Indiana Wesleyan. She quit her old job selling life insurance and turned to teaching after a farming accident nearly claimed her life. Already, she is in the classroom, teaching middle school English, as she works on the degree through a special "Grow Your Own" program designed to address staff shortages.

Because her home is busy — she has twin 12-year-olds,

along with a menagerie that includes horses, goats and chickens — she appreciates the streamlined degree.

"Why do I need to take, you know, underwater basket weaving when I could just take the evolutionary structure of the English language — what I'm going to be teaching," she said.

However, programs with state licensing requirements are one of the biggest worries for Jenna Kramer, a policy researcher at RAND.

Indiana Wesleyan, which has a growing slate of reduced-credit offerings, said its education programs are designed to meet Indiana licensing requirements. Students from elsewhere will need to check if the programs meet their state requirements, said Pam Downing, the school's director of communications, in an email.

The RAND report also found the programs are so new that there are no standard practices for admitting three-year degree recipients into graduate school.

Gabriella Staten, a 20-year-old student in the reduced-credit digital marketing program at Mount Mary University, a Catholic women's institution in Milwaukee, estimates it will save her at least \$20,000. While she wonders whether employers will take her degree as seriously as a four-year degree, she decided she could prove herself.

"Even if they were to look a little bit down on the three-year pathway, I can show them otherwise with the work," she said.

Wesley Hardy, who is three semesters into a bachelor of applied science in accounting at Ensign, also sees the pros and cons. He likes that the three-year format will get him into the workforce faster.

But he noted that the requirements to become a certified public accountant vary by state. Many require 120 semester hours to sit for the exam and 150 to become licensed. Graduate school often is needed.



A woman, who lost her baby in a hospital fire, reacts Wednesday at the facility in Islamabad, Pakistan. Officials said 14 newborns died in the fire. **AP**

Fire in hospital nursery kills 14 newborns in Pakistan's capital

By Munir Ahmed
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ISLAMABAD — A fire triggered by an exploding air conditioner killed 14 newborns in a hospital nursery Wednesday in Pakistan's capital, officials said.

One baby of the 15 who were in the nursery at the Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences was rescued, the hospital said.

Television footage showed rescue workers using ladders to reach the third-floor nursery through broken windows.

Grieving parents and relatives gathered at the hospital, some weeping while others demanded answers about how the fire began and whether the nursery had adequate firefighting equipment.

Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif fired Pakistan's health secretary, Aslam Ghauri, within hours of the fire.

The fire raised new concerns about the condition of some of Pakistan's public healthcare infrastructure.

The prime minister ordered an investigation and said in a statement that "the strictest action should be taken."

Healthcare professionals have long raised alarms about

what they say is widespread official neglect of Pakistan's public hospitals and clinics. The hospital, also known as PIMS, is the most prominent public health institution in Islamabad, a city of more than 2 million people that otherwise has some of the best infrastructure in Pakistan.

A woman who identified herself as Mrs. Mohammad Sami said she gave birth three days earlier and her baby was receiving intensive care in the nursery when the fire broke out.

"I don't know what to say or whom to blame," she said through tears. "I have lost my child."

The fire was confined to the nursery at the institute. The rest of the facility was unaffected with no other injuries reported, hospital officials and witnesses said.

The blaze was later extinguished, Islamabad Chief Commissioner Suhail Ashraf said.

It was among Pakistan's deadliest recent tragedies involving children. In June, 14 schoolchildren were killed when the roof of a tutoring center under construction collapsed in the eastern city of Lahore.

Dr. Aneez Jalil, a hospital spokesperson, said a doctor

rescued one baby. She said the bodies of six babies had been handed over to their families, while the remaining bodies would be released soon.

The Islamabad district magistrate appointed a fact-finding committee and asked it to submit a report within 24 hours. The panel will investigate the cause of the fire and its spread, determine whether adequate fire-safety measures were in place and evaluate the emergency response, according to a government order.

Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi and Sharif, the prime minister, expressed sorrow over the fire.

"A tragedy involving children is an irreparable loss," said Sharif, who held a high-level meeting with officials from relevant agencies hours after the fire.

President Asif Ali Zardari also offered condolences to the families, describing the deaths as "heartbreaking and an irreparable loss."

He called for those responsible to be brought to justice and urged hospitals to ensure effective fire-safety measures and emergency procedures.

The New York Times contributed.

Kremlin: CIA director holds talks with his counterparts in Moscow

ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Kremlin said Wednesday that CIA Director John Ratcliffe held talks in Moscow with his intelligence counterparts, a rare and secretive visit at a time when relations with Washington remain strained over Russia's war in Ukraine.

Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said Ratcliffe did not meet with Russian President Vladimir Putin, who was informed of the contacts that were "on the intelligence agencies' level."

"Of course, President Putin is immediately informed of everything," Peskov added, refusing to say what was discussed.

Russian state news agencies reported that a U.S. military plane landed in Moscow's Vnukovo airport Tuesday and departed later that day.

President Donald Trump played down the significance of Ratcliffe's trip, saying it was "sort of semi-routine."

"I hate to disappoint people," he said on conservative broadcaster Glenn Beck's radio show Wednesday.

A senior Ukrainian official told The Associated Press that Washington informed Kyiv a delegation would be traveling to the Russian capital and asked it to suspend strikes until it left. The official said the request did not apply to all Russian territory, but specifically to Moscow, St. Petersburg and some northern regions.

Strikes on other parts of Russia continued, the official said, speaking on condition of anonymity.

CBS News first reported on the visit.

Peskov said that "contacts between intelligence agencies are, in and of themselves, a positive phenomenon, a positive process," but he stressed that Russia-U.S. relations remain in a "profound crisis."

He added that it was "too early to say" what impact Ratcliffe's visit would have on the ties between the two



President Donald Trump, left, and CIA Director John Ratcliffe speak July 31 as they depart following a meeting at Camp David, near Thurmont, Md. **NATHAN HOWARD/POOL**

countries.

Andrei Soldatov, an expert on Russia's security services, said visits like the one by Ratcliffe do not "happen every year."

Official channels of communication between Moscow and Washington have been kept alive since the 1980s and exist so both sides can talk if American or Russian lives are in danger or for other reasons, Soldatov said.

In 2021, Nikolai Patrushev, the secretary of Putin's Security Council, met CIA Director William Burns in Moscow months before Russian forces invaded Ukraine. Burns later met Sergei Naryshkin, the head of Russia's foreign intelligence agency, in Turkey in November 2022 to warn Russia not to deploy a nuclear weapon in Ukraine.

Details of Tuesday's discussions have not been revealed, but such meetings normally take place only when there is a matter of pressing national security and when it is in "American national interests," Soldatov said.

Russia-U.S. relations sank to Cold War lows after Moscow's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022, but appeared to warm after Trump returned to office. He had promised to end the war swiftly, holding multiple phone calls with Putin and even hosting him in Alaska

a year ago.

In his radio appearance Wednesday, Trump repeated that he wants to see the Russia-Ukraine war end.

Efforts to negotiate a peace deal have largely stalled, with U.S. attention turning to its war with Iran, and both Moscow and Kyiv stepping up their long-range attacks on each other.

Putin has rejected Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy's push for an immediate ceasefire, arguing that Russia wants a comprehensive settlement, not a temporary truce.

In the Russia-Ukraine war, long-range Ukrainian drones struck a major warehouse belonging to Russia's biggest online retailer, burning it to the ground, local authorities said Wednesday.

The depot in the Tambov region southeast of Moscow had been hit July 18, killing seven people. That attack was the start of Ukraine's aerial campaign that has delivered repeated blows to Russian e-commerce giant Wildberries.

The company's size and commercial importance brought comparisons with Amazon.

The overnight attack on the Wildberries facility in Tambov was confirmed by the company, which said the depot was evacuated. It didn't say the extent of the damage.

Hungary water practices come up dry

Prolonged droughts, climate change cause lakes, rivers to vanish

By Justin Spike
ASSOCIATED PRESS

GÁRDONY, Hungary — A fisherman disembarked from his boat in a small harbor on Lake Velence in Hungary recently, trudging up the dock plank that had become extremely steep as the water receded to record lows.

Árpád Selmecsi said navigating even a small fishing boat on Hungary's third-largest lake is becoming increasingly difficult as the water level has ebbed to around 8 inches, well below the 5 feet optimal for August. Beaches across the lake, once popular with tourists, have been closed.

Lake Velence's decline is part of a broader water crisis confronting Hungary as increasingly prolonged droughts and climate change-driven heat waves have pummeled Europe.

"I've lived on Lake Velence since I was a child, and I've never seen the water so low," said Selmecsi, 58. "It's terrible. My heart aches every single moment."

This summer, wildfires scorched the continent from the United Kingdom to Greece, while in Hungary, drought has damaged crop yields, led to drinking water shortages and threatened to shut down the country's only nuclear power plant.

But the lack of rainfall linked to human-driven climate change is only part of Hungary's water problem. Experts say the country's long-standing practice of channeling water away from its landscape and draining natural wetlands has left it vulnerable as droughts become more frequent and severe.

Around 99% of Hungary's lands are under severe or extreme drought conditions, according to the national meteorological service, and desertification, a process



Boats lie on cracked soil at a dried-out marina Aug. 13 on Lake Velence, Hungary. Hungary is suffering a historical loss of wetlands. BELA SZANDELSZKY/AP

where vegetation recedes because of high heat and low rainfall, threatens much of the Great Hungarian Plain.

Yet more than a quarter of Hungary consists of low-lying land that naturally retains precipitation, and in past centuries its many rivers and streams made it rich in freshwater resources. However, a 2023 study published in the journal *Nature* estimated Hungary's historical wetland loss at more than 80%.

Zsuzsanna Ujj, a biodiversity policy specialist and project coordinator with environmental group Friends of the Earth Hungary, said the country "has not been a good steward of its waters in the last 200 years."

A major contributor is Hungary's network of more than 25,000 miles of drainage canals — a length that exceeds the circumference of the Earth — which drain accumulated precipitation from

fields, wetlands and the soil to make room for agriculture and other enterprises.

The priority on draining land rather than allowing natural flooding cycles to occur has contributed to a consistent drop in the water table and the drying out of wetlands and topsoil. With less water available to evaporate, the air dries out, further reducing the chances of localized precipitation.

Ujj said that Hungary — which is among the most drought-exposed countries in Europe and ranks 16th globally, according to a report by the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development — "needs to realign its water management practices, shifting from a drainage-based approach to one focused on water retention."

The drying out of Hungary isn't limited to streams and wetlands.

Lake Garancsi, a small recreational lake around 12 miles northwest of Budapest, was once a popular destination for fishing, swimming and ice skating, and was the setting of the 2001 cult Hungarian comedy "Üvegtigris" ("Glass Tiger").

But the lake, present since the Middle Ages, has shrunk so dramatically in recent years that none of the previous recreational activities are permitted, and most of the former lake bed is now exposed, cracked and dry.

What remains of the water is so shallow and warm that all of the fish and most of the other wildlife have disappeared, and authorities have predicted no water will be left by the end of summer.

Zoltán Mettner, who runs the Glass Tiger bar on the shores of the lake, said conditions have gotten worse every year. After spending years beside the lake, he said

looking at it now is "terrible, there's no other way to put it."

"It's sad enough that we've let things get this far, and that we couldn't have taken gradual steps to prevent this lake from being completely destroyed," he said.

Hungary's new government has promised to begin taking those steps.

In late June, on the same day the country set a high temperature record 107.6 degrees, Prime Minister Péter Magyar told lawmakers that his government would put water management policies "on new footing," and launch a comprehensive water conservation program to mitigate the effects of drought.

"Many have said year after year that water shortage will be one of Hungary's problems and one of the most important strategic issues to be solved. They were right," Magyar said.

In addition to poor water retention practices, Magyar said that aging water utility infrastructure causes 20-25% of the country's drinking water to leak out through damaged pipes, costing \$54.4 million annually.

"For years, even the existence of the problem was denied and relativized," Magyar said. Now, he added, "water retention will be the basic principle of Hungarian water management."

Yet implementing such sweeping changes will be time consuming and costly, while Hungary's current water crisis threatens its ability to produce adequate energy.

The Danube, the European Union's longest river which runs through 10 countries from southwestern Germany to the Black Sea, has set successive records this summer for low water levels.

NEWS BRIEFING

US declares drought disaster in Puerto Rico areas amid water crisis

FROM NEWS SERVICES

SAN JUAN, Puerto Rico — The U.S. government announced a drought disaster Wednesday for more than two dozen cities and towns in Puerto Rico as water woes deepen across the U.S. Caribbean territory, with no relief in sight.

More than 33% of Puerto Rico is under extreme drought, and another 30% under a severe drought. July was the driest month on record for San Juan in more than 120 years and the second hottest for the island's capital.

Gov. Jenniffer González said she had formally requested the declaration from the U.S. Department of Agriculture more than two weeks ago.

"From the very beginning, we made clear the needs of our farmers," she said.

The declaration covers 26 of Puerto Rico's 78 municipalities, including Cabo Rojo, Ponce, Yauco, Aibonito and Lares.

The disaster declaration allows farmers and agricultural producers in those regions to access emergency loans.

"This is an important step," Puerto Rico Agriculture Secretary Irving Rodríguez said. "We urge all producers affected by the drought to document their losses."

Naia Seda is among the farmers anxious to apply for financial help. She has a 15-acre farm on which she cultivates avocados, plantains, lemons, cassava and other crops.

It hasn't rained since April. Her farm, which she has cultivated since 2009, is crisscrossed with cracks several feet deep.

"I've never seen something like this on my farm," she said.

Seda lamented how her crops are shriveling and fruits are dropping to the ground before they've ripened because of the high heat.

The irrigation canal that her farm and 300 others in the southwestern municipality of Lajas depend on used to supply water as requested. Seda received that supply three times a week.

In June, Puerto Rico officials limited the amount to once a week.

Judge denies extradition: A federal judge Wednesday refused to order Texas to extradite an Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer charged with shooting a man and lying about it during the immigration crackdown in Minneapolis.

U.S. District Judge Fernando Rodriguez Jr. wrote in an order that he couldn't prevent a county sheriff from releasing Christian Castro or order Texas Gov. Greg Abbott to sign his extradition warrant.

The Cameron County sheriff said he would release Castro at midnight.

Castro is charged in Minnesota with assault and falsely reporting a crime in the Jan. 14 shooting of Julio Cesar Sosa-Celis, 24.

Castro is accused of firing a gun through the front door of a Minneapolis home, shooting Sosa-Celis in the leg.

Prosecutors say Castro also falsely accused Sosa-Celis and another man of attacking an ICE officer with a broom handle and a snow shovel.

After a Minnesota judge issued a nationwide warrant for Castro's arrest in May, authorities, including Minnesota's Bureau of Criminal Apprehension, arrested Castro in Cameron County on May 29. Minnesota authorities have sought his extradition since his arrest, but he remains in custody in Brownsville, Texas, a city bordering Mexico.

Under Texas law and barring extradition, Castro must be released after 90 days of detention, which is Thursday.



Always loved: Flowers, notes and photographs are left Wednesday on musician Dolly Parton's star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame in Los Angeles. Parton, 80, died after a brief battle with cancer Tuesday in Nashville, Tennessee. JAE C. HONG/AP

Secret Service investigation: Three U.S. Secret Service officials were placed on administrative leave Tuesday, pending the outcome of an investigation by the agency's professional standards office.

The three were operating in non-law enforcement capacities and were being investigated for potential misconduct, the agency's public information office reported. However, the cause for the action remained unclear as the Office of Professional Responsibility was beginning its review.

The Secret Service has been under scrutiny as President Donald Trump has been the subject of at least three assassination plots in the past two years.

Graham's GOP win: U.S. Sen. Darline Graham won the Republican nomination to replace her late brother on South Carolina's general election ballot, notching another win for President Donald Trump after he threw his support behind the political novice.

Graham defeated U.S. Rep. Ralph Norman in Tuesday's special Republican primary runoff, two weeks after they were the top two finishers in a 10-way primary.

Despite being a political unknown, Graham bested some of South Carolina's top political names in the special election spun up after Lindsey Graham's sudden death last month. She was appointed by Gov. Henry McMaster to serve out the remaining months of her late brother's current term and swiftly won an endorsement from Trump, who encouraged her to enter the race for a full term and campaigned for her in the state last week.

Thai woman sentenced: A Thai woman accused of killing her ex-husband, a U.S. diplomat, has been sentenced to one year in prison for violating Myanmar's immigration laws, but she still might go to trial for murder, a lawyer familiar with her case said Wednesday.

The court in Yangon's Kamayut township on

Tuesday found Pavinee Supasirivisan guilty under a provision applying to any foreign national who commits a crime in the country, according to the lawyer.

The charge carries a sentence ranging from six months to five years, the lawyer said on condition of anonymity to avoid possible repercussions from Myanmar's military-backed government, which exercises tight control over information. Pavinee is being held at Insein Prison.

Neither U.S. nor Myanmar officials have publicly named the dead man, but the New York Post and other Western media have identified him as 43-year-old Daniel Paul Riva, who served as a U.S. State Department assistant regional security officer. An online obituary for someone of that name has details including the same day of death as the victim and recollections of him having worked in several U.S. diplomatic missions.

The U.S. State Department had confirmed the death of a

U.S. government employee, but refused to provide further information, including the victim's name, citing privacy reasons.

Harry, Meghan back in UK: Prince Harry and his wife, Meghan, arrived in the United Kingdom on Wednesday, as they make a fresh start in Britain after six years in the U.S., U.K. media reported.

The news comes less than a week after the couple surprised fans and critics alike with plans to return to Britain. Their arrival was reported by news organizations including the BBC and the Daily Telegraph, with the newspaper reporting that their plane landed at Birmingham International Airport around noon.

The couple's children, Prince Archie, 7, and Princess Lilibet, 5, have already enrolled at British schools and will start classes in September. The family plans to live at a private, nonroyal residence outside of London, but haven't said exactly where that will be.



Built to scale

Planning to stay a long time, Washington couple helps design intimate house with enough space to also entertain friends



Above: Wallpaper monkeys sport cowboy hats and lassos in the powder room of Laurie and Phil Erickson's home. **RAFAEL SOLDI PHOTOS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES**

Top: The Ericksons' house has three volumes containing the primary suite, left, the main living space and a guest wing next to a pool in Ellensburg, Washington. The couple wanted an intimate house that could also be scaled for entertaining a group of old friends.

Inset: The swimming pool and low-slung house were designed by architecture firm Tokul.

By Tim McKeough | THE NEW YORK TIMES

When Laurie and Phil Erickson attended Central Washington University in Ellensburg, Washington, in the 1980s, they didn't think much about their surroundings. When they returned for a fundraising event in 2018, however, they were struck by the area's rugged beauty.

After living outside Seattle in Bellevue, Washington, running businesses and raising two children, the couple had a newfound appreciation for Ellensburg's more relaxed environment.

"I'm able to take a breath," said Erickson, 62, the founder of France Luxe, a hair accessories and soap brand. "The pace is slower." She and Phil Erickson, 65, the president of Ocular Instruments, a medical device company, decided they wanted a home there. But when they looked at houses on the market, nothing seemed to be a good fit for their current stage of life.

"All the homes that I saw were homes that you would likely raise a family in," Laurie Erickson said. "And we'd already done that."

In August 2018, they bought roughly 35 acres of farmland for about \$350,000, with the dream of building a house. Soon after, an adjacent lot of about 22 acres became available, which looked like an even better site for a house, so they bought it too, for an additional \$250,000.

A friend introduced the couple to Dawn McConaghy, a principal of the architecture firm Tokul, who asked the Ericksons what they envisioned for the house.

"We wanted a place where we could stay for a long time, so we wanted it all to be one level," Phil Erickson said. "We wanted a place where we could entertain our adult friends."

With the goal of designing a house that would feel large

and gracious for numerous guests, but intimate when it was just the couple at home, McConaghy conceived a 4,680-square-foot structure composed of three volumes.

One volume contains the main living spaces, including the kitchen, dining area and a living room ending in glass sliders opening to a covered porch. A short hallway with glass walls leads to another volume containing the primary bedroom suite. The third volume contains three guest suites with direct access to the pool for family and friends, but the whole expanse can be closed off by a sliding door when it isn't being used.

"You can shut it down if no one's around, and then they're just living in the rest of the house," McConaghy said.

For the overall vibe of the house, Laurie Erickson cut photos from books and magazines and shared them with McConaghy for inspiration.

"It was this high-low concept," McConaghy said. "They wanted sturdy finishes that were going to stand the test of time — nice but not precious."

For the exterior, she used weathered Douglas fir siding made from reclaimed lumber. Inside, there is a

See **SCALE** on Page B10

Confirm grubs infiltrated lawn before applying treatment

By Jessica Damiano
ASSOCIATED PRESS

What does it mean when brown patches show up in a perfectly healthy lawn? The truth is, it could be anything from drought to dog urine, fungal diseases, pests or too much fertilizer. But many homeowners automatically blame grubs.

The problem with this is that it's often not the case, and even if grubs are present, small populations are not problematic.

Treatment should only be applied after confirming a true grub infestation. Fortunately, there's a simple way to check. Grubs are the early life forms of beetles and live close to the surface under lawns and other plants, where they feed on roots, disconnecting the roots from the plants' top growth.

Confirming their presence is easy: Dig up a 3- to 4-inch deep, 12-inch-square section of symptomatic lawn that partially overlaps the border of healthy grass.

If there are grubs in the lawn, the whitish, brown-headed, half-inch to 1-inch-long beetle larvae, which resemble shrimp, will be visible either on the underlying soil or on the underside of the sod-like square you removed.

Fewer than 10 grubs per square foot of soil is normal and does not indicate an infestation, so you should not take any action. Instead, seek out other potential causes.

Treatment against grubs

should only be applied if there are 10 or more of the insects present. Heavily infested lawn sections will easily roll up like a carpet when you attempt to remove them, their roots severed by the feeding insects.

Because grubs are most vulnerable to pest-control measures when they are young, those measures will only be effective if applied in late summer.

Beneficial nematodes are microscopic, nonsegmented

worms that attack soil-dwelling insects, including all types of grubs. They're a more universal approach, with higher success rates. They, too, are natural, as they already exist in the soil; you would just be adding more.

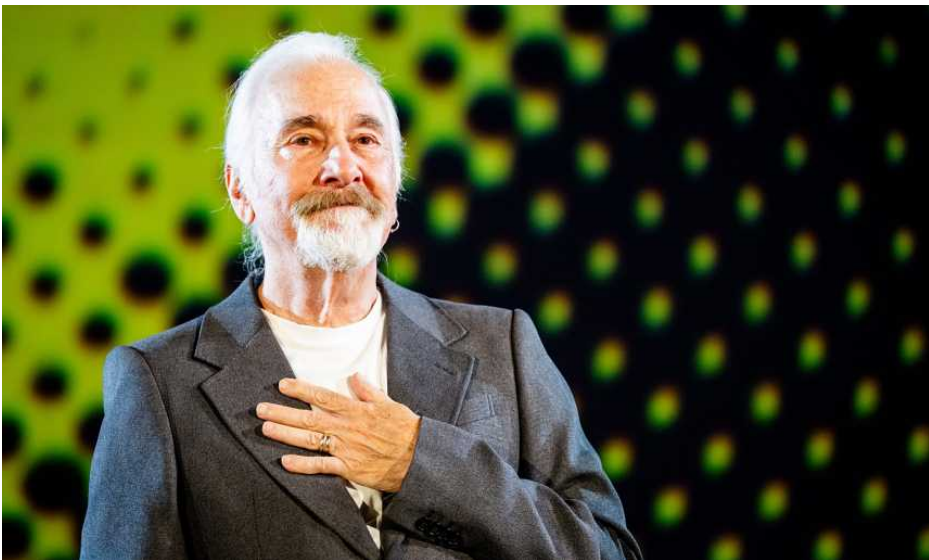
The nematodes work by infecting grubs with a bacterium that can kill them in as little as 48 hours.

To optimize effectiveness, water the soil well before applying either treatment. Avoid using chemical



June bugs are a species of white grubs. **BUGWOOD.ORG**

treatments, which can be toxic to earthworms, honeybees and other pollinators, pets and wildlife. Some are even toxic to humans.



Rick Baker, seen Aug. 12, was the film's makeup artist. **JEAN-CHRISTOPHE BOTT/KEYSTONE**

CELEBRITIES

‘Nutty Professor’ celebrates 30 years

FROM NEWS SERVICES

“The Nutty Professor,” starring Eddie Murphy, is celebrating its 30th anniversary with a special theatrical reopening Sept. 4.

Murphy plays seven roles in the film, and part of the trickery is due to makeup artist Rick Baker.

Baker has won seven Academy Awards for his creatures and designs. He executed the transformation from man to werewolf in “An American Werewolf in London,” created the massive bigfoot for “Harry and the Hendersons,” converted Martin Landau into Bela Lugosi for “Ed Wood,” fashioned the aliens for “Men in Black” and turned Jim Carrey into the Christmas-hating Grinch.

Baker himself did the work on Murphy’s multiple characters.

“I played with Eddie’s makeup,” he recalls. “I know when I’m doing it, I’m usually happier than when somebody else does it. (I think) there’s no way I’m going to be able to do this. I’ve done films where I’ve had five people doing elaborate makeup at the same time. It’s tough to get the staff. There’s not 90 people who can do this; they don’t exist. There’s more people who can do appliance makeup than

ever before because of all the ‘Star Trek’ TV shows and all that stuff. What’s disappointing is when you do a really elaborate makeup and put it on an actor who’s afraid to overact and doesn’t sell it. Eddie Murphy’s great at selling it.

“I always do makeup tests on myself before I put somebody else in it for many reasons,” says Baker. “For one, when they complain about it I can sympathize with them because I know. It’s also just to see how it works and how I can make it work better.”

Grint returning to ‘Harry Potter’ role: Rupert Grint — the original Ron Weasley from the “Harry Potter” movies — will slip into his old role on Broadway next year in “Harry Potter and the Cursed Child.” Grint, who starred in all eight “Harry Potter” films from 2001 to 2011, will join the play from Feb. 2 to May 30 in New York City.

“Ron Weasley has been a part of me since I was 11 years old, and I can’t wait to meet him again in this stage of life,” Grint said in a statement. “There is something so full-circle and so special about stepping back into Ron’s shoes now when we are both fathers; it is somehow both very familiar and

completely new.”

It will mark the second time a member of the film cast has joined the stage production. This year, Tom Felton reprised his role of Draco Malfoy, seeing box-office receipts jump.

The play picks up 19 years after the end of the final novel, “Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows.” An adult Potter is married to Ginny Weasley, sister of his best friend, Ron, who married Hermione. Both couples have children and all are in danger again. Ron runs the joke shop, Weasley’s Wizard Wheezes.

“His return creates a powerful bridge between the story audiences first fell in love with and the story of family, legacy and the passage of time that ‘Harry Potter and the Cursed Child’ carries forward,” producers Sonia Friedman and Colin Callender said in a statement.

Aug. 27 birthdays: Actor Tommy Sands is 89. Actor Tuesday Weld is 83. Actor Peter Stormare is 73. Bassist Glen Matlock is 70. Singer Yolanda Adams is 65. Actor Chandra Wilson is 57. Actor Sarah Chalke is 50. Actor Aaron Paul is 47. Actor Patrick J. Adams is 45. Singer Mario is 40. Actor Alexa PenaVega is 38. Actor Ellar Coltrane is 32.

Seat choice by pals’ adult child dampers conversation at parties



R. Eric Thomas
ASKING ERIC

Dear Eric: We are an empty-nester couple in our 50s. We entertain often, and in one group is a couple who have an adult child, W, who lives with them. This couple frequently asks if W is invited too. We always say yes.

The problem is that W tends to put a significant damper on gatherings. They never engage in conversation, literally zero other than to answer direct questions.

It might not be so obvious they weren’t engaging if it weren’t for the fact they always seem to choose a seat in the middle of things — middle of the table or the room or the couch, whatever — which makes it awkward, sometimes painfully so, to hold a conversation around them.

When I’m cooking in my too-small-for-more-than-one kitchen, W will absolutely reliably take the stool at the kitchen pass-through and turn their back to me to listen to those standing around outside the kitchen, which makes it difficult for others to easily engage with me.

I don’t think W intends any rudeness. I think they’re just taking whatever looks to them like the most appealing seat without thinking much about it.

I don’t know what to do. I want to be kind, but this has been going on for years, and I find it draining and anticipate the request to include W with something increasingly approaching dread every time we entertain this group.

I think it’s possible W is neurodivergent, although no one has ever told me that, which of course would call for even more kindness.

Is there any kind way to solve this? What possible way can you ask someone to sit somewhere less central without being unkind? — *Not Enjoying the Party*

Dear Party: Try bringing this up with W’s parents and ask if they can think of a way that W might be better integrated into gatherings. They’re likely used to W’s social habits and are, hopefully, adept at helping their child to move through the world.

You can also try putting out name cards at place settings the next time you entertain. This would allow you to mix and match people in whatever way you want. Not only could this enhance W’s experience at the dinners, but it could give the rest of the guests a chance to engage with folks they otherwise might not.

Dear Eric: Forty-five years ago, I married a widow with two sons. They are now grown with children of their own.

My wife and I have been supportive of them and their families. When one son was depressed over early hair loss, we got him counseling and a hair transplant. When he got colon cancer, I called often, giving him emotional support.

I have been encouraging and offered guidance to his sons while they attended college. Upon their graduations, I sent them congratulatory cards with a substantial monetary gift. I have provided my other son with thousands of dollars without expecting repayment when the IRS came calling because he hadn’t filed taxes for eight years.

When his wife suffered an early death from brain cancer, over the months she was hospitalized, I called him frequently providing emotional support and took him out for lunch or dinner.

After my wife, their mother, suffered a stroke, she was confined to bed for

nine years while I was her caretaker. The sons and grandchildren visited only on “obligatory” holidays like Mother’s Day or Christmas. They rarely offered me emotional support.

Since my wife passed, I’ve heard crickets from them. None of them calling, coming by again or inviting me to dinner to get out of my now lonely empty house.

I am considering moving across the country, not even telling them and, as they are not my blood, ceasing any relationship with them. What do you think? — *No Calls*

Dear No Calls: Your family has gone through so much; I’m very sorry. Your expectations of your stepsons aren’t unreasonable at all. When loved ones are ailing or in need, you show up, you call, you support.

It’s not clear from your letter whether you’ve ever had a conversation with them about your expectations or asked them to be more present. But even if you haven’t, there’s obviously a disconnect on your stepsons’ parts that’s not your responsibility to fix.

It may make the most sense to release this expectation and get support elsewhere. If you do so, however, consider closing this chapter with acceptance. This will help you move forward with less resentment.

Acknowledge that this is who your stepsons are, the relationships you have with them are not the relationships you want, you wish it was different, but you accept that it’s not. You might even choose to tell them this in a letter. But mostly this is a practice for yourself and your peace.

Send questions to eric@askingeric.com.

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Day reviving ‘Guild’ with Ren Faire twist

Creator plans fan-funded feature film to mark 20th anniversary

By Robert Lloyd
LOS ANGELES TIMES

In 2007, the actor Felicia Day debuted “The Guild,” one of the first works, maybe the first, to demonstrate that the web could be a legitimate platform for full-blown, character-driven, narrative comedy. (YouTube was only 2 years old at the time.)

Online since there was a line to be on, Day — also known for “Supernatural,” “Buffy the Vampire Slayer,” “Eureka,” “Mystery Science Theater 3000” and as the female lead in Joss Whedon’s “Dr. Horrible’s Sing-Along Blog” alongside Neil Patrick Harris and Nathan Fillion — played Cyd, aka Codex, a young woman at loose ends who finds community with a group of gamers whose quirkiness puts her own into perspective.

The series, which she created and wrote — from experience — grew more ambitious and technically impressive across its six seasons, with cameos by the likes of Fillion, Zachary Levi, Stan Lee, Brent Spiner, late Mythbuster Grant Imahara and Wil Wheaton. There was a cultural specificity to the setting and storytelling — lots of gaming jargon and jokes — but the humor in the characters was universal, and the show — for all its well-proportioned silliness — felt very alive.

Now, as the series’ 20th anniversary approaches, Day is reviving “The Guild” as a feature, “The Guild: Ren Faire’d,” through a Kickstarter campaign. By the time I pledged early on the first day of fund-raising, the campaign had already met its initial \$1.5 million goal — the minimum required, Day calculated, to pull off a version of her

script. As of this writing, the campaign has raised more than \$5 million. Everything over \$4.5 million will go to making the film even better, but also support “Conludo,” a new game-playing series with Wheaton along the lines of their “Table Top,” created in 2012 for the Day-founded YouTube channel Geek & Sundry.

Day is also the author of a charming memoir, “You’re Never Weird on the Internet,” and a mental exercise book, “Embrace Your Weird: Face Your Fears and Unleash Creativity.”

Earlier this year, Simon & Schuster published “The Lost Daughter of Sparta,” her graphic novel (with illustrator Rowan MacColl) about Philonoe, Helen of Troy’s lesser-known fourth sister, an on-brand tale of self-determination and embrace of one’s difference.

This interview with Day has been edited for clarity and length.

Q: How does it feel to be back wearing — or about to wear — the character of Codex?

A: It’s so empowering to go back to this world that I crafted and this character that means so much to me and my fans. She and I have diverged a lot over the years, but her voice is still strong and clear in my ear, and I’ve had so much fun writing for her again. I haven’t been in charge of my own stories on this scale in a long time, so this all definitely feels like coming home.

Q: It was an offer to turn “The Guild” into a television show that prompted you to get the film going. Had you thought of the possibility of bringing it back before then?

A: Early in 2025, I’d been thinking about the 20th

anniversary of the show and how to celebrate it, but a movie is a huge project, one I was wary of committing to. A phone call with a very nice Hollywood executive wanting me to reboot the show with younger actors was the kick in the pants I needed. The business has been so hard on me, and a lot of people, especially these last five or so years. To even think about having the one project I held dear taken away from me? That got my fire lit.

Q: How did you know to hang on to your IP?

A: I had met a few people in the early web days who’d sold their show to producers and networks, only to have them buried in development hell and never be seen again. My audience meant, and still means, so much to me, that I didn’t see the point in losing control of the show when it felt like we were doing all the right things on our own. The fans’ support gave me that confidence, and thank goodness for it, or I wouldn’t be able to make a movie today.

Q: How did you cast the original show? Were any of the actors already gamers?

A: I wrote two of the main parts for improv friends, Zaboo (Sandeep Parikh) and Vork (Jeff Lewis), and I found the rest of the actors from a Backstage casting call. Several of them were already gamers, but a few were anything but (namely, Amy Okuda, who played Tinkerballa — she took some arm twisting). Over the years, though, they’ve all turned into gamers. We’ve enjoyed many a Fortnite session together, especially during COVID times.

Q: How has your reunion



Felicia Day, seen July 21, is using Kickstarter to fund the making of “The Guild: Ren Faire’d.” The original series ran for six seasons starting in 2007. **ALBERTO E. RODRIGUEZ/GETTY**

been going?

A: I had to make sure the script was good enough before I asked my fans to support it, so in February I had a table read with the main cast. Truly, it felt like no time had passed. We were all laughing so hard, ribbing each other on any little mistakes. It was so much fun to rediscover our characters together again. What we have together as a group is magic, and I can’t wait to get the band back together on set again.

Q: The original “Guild” and the way you’ve mounted this campaign feels like the work of friends, like Mickey and Judy getting the gang together in a someone’s uncle’s barn to put on a show. (Which isn’t to say “amateur”)

A: The heart of everything

I do is this: I just want to play with my friends and my fans. I want to delight them with new ideas. I want to surprise them with laughs. The industry often divorces us from what got us into the business in the first place: making believe. Creating together. I like my work to embody the kind of spirit you can’t have in more mainstream media where there are levels of approvals over everything and the budgets are so high that the pressure takes the fun out of it. Yes, it’s challenging to make anything with fewer resources, but the community can see the ins and outs of my process and I hope that empowers them, in turn, to create their own things with their own friends one day.

Q: What inspired your new graphic novel “The Lost

Daughter of Sparta”? **A:** Being cut off from Hollywood over COVID made me brave enough to write a story I knew wouldn’t be anything an executive would care about if I pitched it. For many years, I didn’t allow myself to develop ideas like that. What was the use if they didn’t find it useful? But in allowing myself the space to write this story set in the world of Greek mythology, I’ve found new confidence as a writer. I want to keep telling stories only I can tell, in whatever format I can. I never want to discard them again because other people won’t find them useful. I hope that anyone reading the book feels the same encouragement to follow their inner muse. Because everyone deserves to be loved for exactly who they are, even our stories.

Firefighter turns backyard into edible paradise

Space behind Calif. bungalow teems with diverse types of food

By Sean Timberlake
SACRAMENTO BEE

Kyle Hagerty’s home in East Sacramento, California, looks unremarkable from the front. Less grandiose than his neighbors’, his is a quaint bungalow shaded by a canopy of established trees. His backyard, however, is a virtual Garden of Eden.

Hagerty began building out his garden when he purchased the house in 2019. Seeing its potential was one of the main selling points.

“The yard was almost completely empty, with the exception of a big orange tree and a couple camelia trees, but it was mostly just like a weed-filled lawn. Having a lot of sunlight is one of the most important things when you’re finding a space for a garden, and this was a yard that had plenty of sun and plenty of space. I just knew it would be an excellent spot to start a new garden from scratch,” the Sacramento firefighter said.

He spent the first year just observing, making sketches, feeling it out. Once he knew what he wanted, he broke ground.

“I really wanted a space where I could grow a lot of diverse types of food, but also a space that really balances style and function, where I could entertain people. I wanted a space that was beautiful to work in and was broken up into different sections. I wanted a raised bed area. I wanted a little orchard. I wanted a little lawn for the dog to run around. Over time, I’ve created those, and now I’m at a point where I sort of just maintain it,” Hagerty said.

Today, the yard is full, teeming with edible plants wrapped around a central open area covered in clumping grass that creates a wave-like texture.

The garden isn’t all that he’s cultivated. Hagerty fired up his Instagram



Kyle Hagerty holds white sapote fruit that he grows in his backyard garden Aug. 5 in East Sacramento, California.



A variety of fruit grown in Hagerty’s backyard is displayed Aug. 5. **HECTOR AMEZCUA/SACRAMENTO BEE PHOTOS**

account, @urbanfarmstead, when he was still gardening at his previous home, in 2014. Over the years, with regular updates, sage gardening advice — and the occasional thirst trap — he now has more than 300,000 followers.

Extending from Hagerty’s back porch is a straight path filled with decomposed granite, which doubles as a walkway and a bocce court. It is flanked on either side with fruit trees — Asian pears, peaches, nectarines,

avocados and figs.

It’s this area where he has introduced the greatest diversity. Having recently taken an interest in grafting, Hagerty has cultivated several trees to bear multiple varieties of each fruit. Of his three fig trees alone, he estimates each has around 10 varieties.

Toward the back, Hagerty grows a riot of vegetables. Peppers include fire-red Fresnos and bright yellow Habanadas, which have the fruity flavor of haba-

neros and none of the sting. Among his abundant tomatoes, this year’s most successful has been the Italian pear tomato, large, pendulous red fruit with a puckered top and wide bottom.

Hagerty is not content to stick with strictly mundane crops, however. On an arched trellis spanning two beds, a tangled vine produces cucamelon, also called Mexican sour gherkins or mouse melons. Resembling tiny watermelons, they have a crisp crunch and a bright, citric flavor.

Adjacent are two thickets of papalo, an herb popular in Mexico but little known elsewhere. It has a fresh, herbaceous flavor not unlike cilantro, but with a sturdier texture.

“With the heat and everything, it thrives here. It’s surprising that it hasn’t become more popular. The reason I started growing it is because I love cilantro and I love making salsas, but

cilantro is not a hot season crop. I would have to irrigate twice a day. I only irrigate this garden once every three days for the vegetable garden. So being able to grow something like papalo that has a similar flavor to cilantro, but clearly thrives in the heat with very minimal water, is exceptional,” Hagerty said.

Beyond the vegetables, things get exotic. Hagerty has leveraged his garden expertise to grow an orchard of tropical fruits, coaxing them to thrive in our Mediterranean climate.

“I stumbled upon a guy named Jeff in Modesto, who was growing avocados. And then on his page on YouTube, the Tropical GardenGuy, he was showing that he had a full tropical garden in his backyard, where he was growing mangoes and guavas and bananas and passion fruit and longan and lychee and all these tropical plants. That really opened my eyes to the idea that I might actu-

ally be able to grow some really unique things here in my backyard,” he said.

Weather wasn’t the only challenge growing tropical fruits. The soil also had to be considered.

“Even though I can’t control the climate, obviously one thing I could control was the soil. So I amended the soil so that these tropicals would have really good drainage, and they wouldn’t die of root rot in the winter time. And so far, it’s worked out,” he said.

Three years later, he’s seeing the literal fruits of his labor. There’s the oak leaf papaya, whose tiny, bite-size fruits have a tender texture and mild flavor, until you crunch into the peppery seeds. The babaco papaya’s large, yellow fruit is soft with a tart, citrusy flavor.

He has a stand of bananas, which have produced tremendous hands. Deeper in is his favorite fruit, the white sapote.

“If there was one subtropical that I would recommend to people growing in this region, it would be white sapote. They’re truly adapted to grow really well here in Sacramento. They have a creamy, custardy tropical flavor to them when they’re ripe, and they typically ripen in late summer, early fall,” he said.

Most exciting for him this year is the first appearance of star fruit.

“I was just cleaning up the garden yesterday. I planted a star fruit tree three years ago, and I just realized that it set its first fruit. So star fruit growing here in Sacramento, that’s pretty awesome,” he said.

In all, Hagerty thinks he may have more than 300 varieties of fruits and vegetables in the garden, accounting for grafts.

While his garden isn’t at a scale where he can supply restaurants with any given fruit or vegetable on a regular basis, he has done some pop-up events. He also hosts a plant starts sale in the spring at East Sacramento restaurant Canon.

Plant a tree in early fall

By Beth Botts
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Fall is nearly here. That makes it a good time to plant a tree.

“The most important job for a newly planted tree is growing roots,” said Sharon Yiesla, plant knowledge specialist in the Plant Clinic at The Morton Arboretum in Lisle. “If you plant it in early autumn, the soil will still be warm enough for root growth for at least a couple of months.”

Fall planting agrees with most kinds of trees, such as buckeye, catalpa, crabapple, hackberry, hawthorn, honey locust, elm, Kentucky coffee tree, linden, maple, oak, sycamore, pine and spruce.

Some tree species should be planted in spring because they need a whole growing season to get well established. They include bald cypress, American hornbeam,

ginkgo, larch, magnolia, hemlock, sweetgum, tulip tree and willow. Broad-leaved evergreens, such as rhododendrons, are best left for spring too.

Here are some tips from the Plant Clinic for fall tree planting. Learn more about tree planting at mortonarb.org/planting-trees.

Plant early in the fall: Get the tree in the ground while there’s still plenty of time for those roots to grow. “August to September is best,” Yiesla said. If the autumn is warm, you may be able to push the deadline to mid-October.

Don’t plant if the soil is too wet: Fall rains are usually a blessing to trees, but if there has been too much rainfall over the summer, the soil may be too wet to dig.

Buy a tree in a pot: A container-grown tree will

have all its roots. One that has its ball of roots wrapped in burlap was grown in a field and dug up, losing much of its root system in the process. “Wait until spring to plant a balled-and-burlapped tree,” she said.

Check that it’s healthy: Choose a tree that is fresh stock, or that has been watered and well cared for throughout the summer. A good garden center or nursery that guarantees its plants should be able to give you that assurance.

Select the right site: Be sure the place where you plan to plant will have space for the tree after it has grown to its full, mature height and width (check the label for that information). Look around for power lines and make sure it won’t interfere with them when it grows big.

Don’t plant too deep: This is the single most important thing about planting a tree. To figure out the right depth, locate the root flare —the place where the trunk flares out into the big anchoring roots, the way your neck flares out into your shoulder. That flare should sit right at the level of the surrounding soil and no deeper. Be aware that the root flare may be buried in several inches of soil in the pot when you buy the plant. Dig down to find the first fat roots growing out sideways; that’s the root flare. Remove all soil above that point.

Take two measurements: Measure the width of the root ball (on a potted tree, this will be the width of the pot). You’ll want to dig a hole at least two to three times as wide as that measurement. Then measure from the root flare to the bottom of the root ball; your hole must be no deeper than that measurement.

Dig a wide, shallow hole: It should be shaped like a low bowl, with sloped sides, so the roots have room to grow out sideways. Spreading a tarp to dump the soil will make it easier to refill the hole later.

Place the tree in the hole: Slip the pot off and place the tree in the hole. Double-check that the root flare is at or just an inch or so above the level of the surrounding soil. If it’s lower, remove the tree and put some soil back in the hole so it can sit at the right height.

Make it straight: Have someone steady the tree while you walk all around to check that it’s upright. “Tree trunks are rarely perfectly straight, but the overall direction should be vertical,” Yiesla said.

Refill the hole: Fill in soil around the tree in two or three layers, gently tamping it down between layers.

Water the tree: Pour at least

10 to 15 gallons of water gently onto the root ball. You will need to water the young tree often, whenever the soil is dry, so check the top inch or two of the soil for moisture every few days until the ground freezes.

Spread mulch: “It should be an even layer, not a pile,” Yiesla said. Rake it out to make a wide circle about 3 to 4 inches deep and at least 3 feet wide. The mulch will insulate the tree’s roots from fall hot spells and also keep the soil warmer after the air turns cold, so the roots can keep growing. “The more roots the tree can grow in fall, the better its chances to thrive next spring and for years to come,” she said.

For tree and plant advice, contact the Plant Clinic at The Morton Arboretum (630-719-2424, mortonarb.org/plant-clinic, or plantclinic@mortonarb.org). Beth Botts is a staff writer at the Arboretum.

GARDEN Q&A

When’s the best time to water the lawn?

By Tim Johnson
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Q: I am having a disagreement with my son-in-law over the best time to water my lawn. He thinks the best time to water is around 11 p.m., and I think it’s best to water early in the morning. To preserve family peace, can you please settle this argument?

— Linda Joseph, Arlington Heights
A: I am happy to provide some guidance to preserve your family’s tranquility. The best time to water your lawn is early in the morning for a few reasons. The main reason is that the lawn will dry out more quickly when it is watered in the early morning.

This is important because extended periods of wet conditions in the lawn can promote disease. Watering at night can extend the period that the grass is wet. There will be less evaporation of the water than when it’s applied in the early morning as the air temperatures are lower and the sun is less intense.

I often see lawns with automatic watering systems running three or more days a week. This leads to overwatered lawns. The best practice is to water your lawn infrequently and deeper to encourage a deep root system that will result in grass that is more resilient to stressful environmental conditions. One deep soaking a week should be adequate for your

lawn. The irrigation system should be set up with an automatic shut-off when there is enough rain. I hate to see irrigation systems running during a significant rain event that is providing adequate water for the

lawn. Another option is to stop watering the lawn and let it go dormant naturally during the typical warmer and drier months of summer. I do not water my lawn at home, and it takes on an

off-green to brownish color as it goes dormant during dry periods. I appreciate the break from mowing (once every two to three weeks) as the grass stops growing.

For more plant advice,

contact the Plant Information Service at the Chicago Botanic Garden at plantinfo@chicagobotanic.org. Tim Johnson is senior director of horticulture at the Chicago Botanic Garden.



A lawn takes on an off-green to brownish color as it goes dormant during dry periods. **RJ CARLSON/CHICAGO BOTANIC GARDEN**

Avoid mortgage traps set by major lenders

Experts share advice for homebuyers to navigate sales tactics

By Jeff Ostrowski
BANKRATE.COM

Buying a home is an exhilarating and exhausting process, one that tests the wits and resolve of even experienced buyers. And some of the very people you turn to for guidance might not always have your best interests in mind.

Some of the industry's sales tactics can make it unnecessarily difficult for you to shop around, or to claim down payment assistance packages designed to encourage homeownership.

To be clear, today's mortgage market is a kiddie pool compared to the shark-infested waters of 20 years ago. The Great Recession led to a flurry of regulations that cracked down on the abusive home lending industry practices that created the mortgage meltdown of 2008 and the foreclosure crisis that dragged on for years after that.

Even so, borrowers can misstep and cost themselves money, and you can't always count on others to look out for your best interests. As you wade into the market for a mortgage, there are some potential traps you should know how to avoid.

As mortgage volumes have slowed in recent years, some major lenders have adopted a new strategy: They draw you into an involved discussion with a friendly loan officer who keeps you on the phone for an extended period. The chat serves to build rapport, but also makes you feel as if comparison shopping is just too time-consuming.

"They definitely want to make that conversation long, drawn out. 'What kind of pets do you have? What are your kids' names?'" says Shawn Malkou, managing broker at X2 Mortgage, a mortgage brokerage in Chandler, Arizona.



DREAMSTIME

In one case, Malkou spoke to a borrower who had locked in a mortgage offer with a rate half a point higher and closing costs that were \$5,000 more than the competing offer Malkou could secure.

"When I said that, the client said, 'It's not that big of a deal,'" Malkou says. "That's a massive difference. But there was still a lot of pushback from the homeowner about not wanting to redo that process. Most borrowers go with the first lender they talk to."

Short-circuiting the shopping process is all too common, says Scott Harris, founder of Magnetic Real Estate in New York City and author of *The Pursuit of Home: A Real Estate Guide to Achieving the American Dream*.

"The reason people don't (mortgage comparison shop) is because it's so painful," he says. "The pain of going through the mortgage process is real. People just say, 'OK, this is a good-enough rate.'"

Benjamin Schieken, founder of mortgage shopping site Fincast, says the long conversations are an example of big lenders using

consumer psychology in their favor.

"It's smart business, it's just not good for consumers," he says. "You just need to provide six specific pieces of information to get a mortgage. You could make that conversation last less than 30 seconds. But consumers don't know that."

Part of the impetus behind the long conversations is for the loan officer to create camaraderie and persuade the borrower that the relationship outweighs any potential savings.

To avoid the trap, carve out time to shop for a mortgage. While you might feel locked in after a long phone conversation, you're still free to look for a better offer. Get at least three offers from lenders. Shopping around for a rate that's mere percentage points lower can potentially save you thousands of dollars over the course of mortgage repayment. Also, compare fees and types of lenders, such as a small or big bank, online company and a credit union.

Be prepared for what's actually required. A mortgage application requires six pieces of information: the borrower's name,

income and Social Security number, the property address, the purchase price and the loan amount. If the loan officer wants to carry on a longer conversation than that, feel free to politely let them know you need the call to move along — but with the knowledge that the person on the other end of the line probably has more practice at this conversation than you do.

Home prices remain at record levels, and that has created an affordability squeeze, especially for first-time homebuyers. There is a workaround, though: Down payment assistance programs, which are offered by every state as a way to encourage homeownership. Combine state programs with federal and local initiatives, and nearly 2,700 down payment programs are active nationally, says Rob Chrane, CEO of Down Payment Resource, a company that tracks homebuyer assistance initiatives.

Many buyers and even real estate agents are unaware of these programs. Chrane says that while 80% of borrowers using Federal Housing Administration mortgages are eligible for

down payment assistance, just 15% receive it. That means buyers are missing out on real money.

But the amounts can range much higher. In some cases, buyers — with the help of savvy loan officers — cobble together six-figure down payment assistance packages. Dozens of down payment programs now offer more than \$100,000 in assistance.

But qualifying for assistance takes time and effort. Buyers typically must complete a first-time buyer course. And maximizing the programs means applying not just to your state housing finance agency but also to other entities, such as your city or county housing program, your employer and perhaps the Federal Home Loan Bank.

All those steps and paperwork create extra work for loan officers, so many mortgage professionals don't even mention the availability of down payment assistance. If the borrower brings it up, Chrane says, the loan officer might respond with an objection, such as "These programs take too long and sellers don't like them," or, "We

don't really do those kinds of loans."

"Homebuyers never make it into the system because a loan officer effectively discourages them at hello," Chrane says.

To avoid this trap, research down payment assistance programs available in your state and municipality. If you're a first-time buyer who meets the income requirements, start the process of applying and look for a loan officer or real estate agent who can guide you through the process.

The regulations enacted after the financial crisis have reined in the worst abuses in the mortgage industry, but lenders still have wiggle room to charge some fees.

"Lender fees are a big variable," says Jeffrey Ruben, president of WSFS Home Lending at WSFS Bank in Wilmington, Delaware. "We are legally permitted to charge borrowers credit check fees, flood certification fees, tax service fees, overnight delivery fees, wire fees. We're allowed to charge them, but we don't have to charge them."

And there's the challenge, Ruben says. While his company doesn't pass on such fees to borrowers, lenders can charge you for some or all of them.

Just to make things even more complex, some other types of fees, such as appraisals and government recording, are almost always passed to the buyer. The average tab for closing costs is about \$3,000, not including recording fees and taxes, according to LodeStar Software Solutions.

Regulators encourage borrowers and lenders to focus on the annual percentage rate, which rolls in the costs of fees to calculate a more accurate rate. "You need to consider the cost of that loan, and not just look at the interest rate," Ruben says.



Each guest bathroom in the Ericksons' home has a different color of tile from Heath Ceramics, based in California.



A custom chandelier by Stefan Gulassa, a lighting and furniture designer in Seattle, was cast from a black cottonwood tree branch found on the property of the Ericksons' home. **RAFAEL SOLDI PHOTOS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES**

SCALE

from Page B7

two-sided concrete fireplace between the living room and patio, blackened steel shelving and ceilings lined in western red cedar between exposed steel beams.

"She created something that I couldn't have imagined in my wildest dreams," Erickson said, "but it captured the essence of what we were trying to do."

The Ericksons and McConaghy also brought on Pierce Lighting Studio for lighting design, Setstudio for interior design and Michelle Arab Studio for landscape architecture. Then, the Ericksons directed the team to use materials and fixtures from U.S. companies as much as possible.

For the kitchen, they chose custom oak cabinets from Ellensburg-based Cedar Mountain Woodwrights, and pulls from Idaho-based Sun Valley



Left: Laurie and Phil Erickson sit on their covered porch. **Right:** A two-sided fireplace and glass sliders separate the living room from the porch.

Bronze. To illuminate the dining table, they commissioned a custom bronze chandelier from Stefan Gulassa, a lighting and furniture designer in Seattle, who cast the piece from a black cottonwood tree branch found on the property.

Other light fixtures and furniture came from U.S. companies — including Roman and Williams Guild, BDDW, Allied Maker,

Workstead and Egg Collective — and many of the faucets were made by New York City-based Watermark.

In the guest suites, the Ericksons had more fun. They gave each suite a different color scheme — red, blue and saddle brown — and lined showers in handmade tile from California-based Heath Ceramics and bedrooms in custom

wallpaper. The wallpaper pattern, created by Oregon-based artist Kate Blairstone is based on images Erickson compiled and has an Ellensburg theme with illustrations of cowboys, tractors and the nearby Davidson Building, a local landmark.

In the powder room, Erickson decided to use Deco Monkeys, a popular hand-painted wallpaper from de Gournay. But she

had the artists add a surprise for her husband: They gave the monkeys cowboy hats and lassos, a nod to Ellensburg's famous rodeo.

Town & Country Homes began construction in April 2021, and the Ericksons moved into the house in December 2023. The construction cost a little more than \$5 million. The couple has since discovered that the house can feel as

serene or as lively as they want.

"You can dial it up in any direction you like," Phil Erickson said.

For their housewarming party in September 2025, for instance, they invited 120 guests. "We had two food trucks, a live band, two or three bars, and kids and adults in the pool," Laurie Erickson said. "It was so, so, so fun."



What to watch THURSDAY

August 27, 2026

All times Central. Start times can vary based on cable/satellite provider. Confirm times on your on-screen guide.

MLB Baseball: L.A. Dodgers at Atlanta

FS1, 6 p.m. Live

Shohei Ohtani and the L.A. Dodgers are at Atlanta's Truist Park to face Matt Olson and the Braves in the finale of a three-game series.

NFL Preseason Football

NFL Network & Prime Video, beginning at 6 p.m. Live

Catch the Pittsburgh Steelers at the Buffalo Bills (NFL Network), the New England Patriots at the Cleveland Browns (Prime Video) and the L.A. Rams at the L.A. Chargers (NFL Network) in Week 3 preseason matchups.

Miss USA 75th Diamond Celebration

The CW, 7 p.m. Live

The Miss USA competition celebrates its 75th year as it takes place at Ziff Ballet Opera House at the renowned Adrienne Arsht Center for the Performing Arts in Miami. Young women representing every U.S. state and the District of Columbia highlight their achievement, ambition and leadership in the hope of earning the Miss USA crown. The winner participates in the Miss Universe competition held in November in Puerto Rico.

Big Brother

CBS, 7 p.m. Live

The reality competition series celebrates its 1,000th episode with a look back at memorable moments from the show's historic 26-year run. Then, it's back to business with a live vote and an eviction. Julie Chen Moonves hosts.



PARI DUKOVIC, FX

Adults

FXX, 8 p.m. ■ Season Premiere

The comedy about young people trying to establish themselves in New York City returns for an eight-episode Season 2. In "The Scrub," the housemates uncover Paul Baker's (Jack Innanen) long-kept secret. In "Fake ID," Billie (Lucy Freyer) discovers the 20-year-old who inherited her fake ID is cooler than she ever was and younger than she'll ever be again.

CATCH A CLASSIC

Summer Under the Stars: Bette Davis

TCM, beginning at 5 a.m.

Bette Davis, one of classic Hollywood's most formidable stars, takes over TCM for a Summer Under the Stars day built around her intensity. The lineup includes **Of Human Bondage** (1934), the film that helped prove Davis could handle raw, unsympathetic roles, and **Jezebel (pictured)**, the 1938 Southern drama that brought her second Academy Award. The

Gordon Ramsay's Secret Service

Food Network, 8 p.m.

For the past 40 years, the family-run restaurant Dahlak has been a mainstay of Philadelphia's community. While the food is the shining light of the restaurant, unfortunate evidence of cockroaches and dust-covered surfaces calls for Gordon's intervention.



day continues with **The Old Maid** (1939), **Now, Voyager** (1942) and **Watch on the Rhine** (1943), followed by the evening's centerpiece, **All About Eve** (1950), with Davis as Margo Channing, the aging stage star facing a younger rival (Anne Baxter).

MOVIES YOU'LL LOVE



EVERETT COLLECTION

Sex and the City (2008, Romance-comedy) Sarah Jessica Parker, Kim Cattrall **E!, 5 p.m.**

The Parent Trap (1998, Children) Lindsay Lohan, Dennis Quaid **Freeform, 5:55 p.m.**

Sing 2 (2021, Children) Matthew McConaughey, Reese Witherspoon **NICK, 6 p.m.**

Normal (2025, Action) Bob Odenkirk, Henry Winkler **HBO, 6:25 p.m.**

Fast X (2023, Action) Vin Diesel, Michelle Rodriguez **USA, 7 p.m.**

Three Housewives and a Body (2026, Suspense) Rachel Hendrix, Christie Osterhus **LMN, 7 p.m.**

Anaconda (1997, Suspense) Jennifer Lopez, Ice Cube **BET, 8 p.m.**

Major League II (1994, Comedy) Charlie Sheen, Tom Berenger **BBC America, 8:30 p.m.**

The Secret Lives of Suburban Housewives (2026, Suspense) Analisa Wall, Ian Reier Michaels **LMN, 9 p.m.**

Venom (2018, Action) Tom Hardy, Michelle Williams **FX, 9 p.m.**

The Matrix Resurrections (2021, Science fiction) Keanu Reeves, Carrie-Anne Moss **TNT, 10 p.m.**

The Rock (1996, Action) Sean Connery, Nicolas Cage **AMC, 10 p.m.**

The Friend (2024, Drama) Naomi Watts, Bill Murray **SHO, 10:35 p.m.**

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TV NEWS

‘Harry Potter’ locks in Harington

FROM NEWS SERVICES

Kit Harington has returned to the realm of HBO's fantasy programming. Harington, popular for portraying reluctant hero Jon Snow in the television adaptation of George R.R. Martin's "Game of Thrones," has joined the cast of HBO's "Harry Potter" series, the network recently confirmed. HBO teased the casting on Instagram, revealing Harington will play Professor Gilderoy Lockhart.

"Superman" and "Renfield" actor Nicholas Hoult was initially cast in the role but departed the series over scheduling issues, according to Deadline. In the film adaptations of author J.K. Rowling's children's series, Kenneth Branagh portrayed the Hogwarts instructor. Emmy-nominated Harington comes to the TV series with some "Harry Potter" experience in hand. Last year he voiced Professor Lockhart for Audible's "Harry Potter" audiobooks.

Years after "Game of Thrones" ended in 2019, Harington reunited with HBO for its gritty finance drama "Industry," portraying a complicated tech CEO. HBO's "Harry Potter" is set to premiere on Christmas Day with Dominic McLaughlin as Harry Potter, Alastair Stout as Ron Weasley and Arabella Stanton as Hermione Granger. Other cast members include John Lithgow as Albus Dumbledore, Nick Frost as Rubeus Hagrid, Paapa Essiedu as Severus Snape, Janet McTeer as Minerva McGonagall, Luke Thallon as Quirinus Quirrell and Paul Whitehouse as Argus Filch.

Earlier this year, actor Gracie Cochrane's family announced that the young actor departed the series — she was to play Ron Weasley's younger sister Ginny — because of a "challenging



Kit Harington, seen May 12, will play Gilderoy Lockhart in the "Harry Potter" series. **EVAN AGOSTINI/INVISION**

decision" to "unforeseen circumstances." "We support Gracie Cochrane and her family's decision not to return for the next season of HBO's 'Harry Potter' series," HBO wrote in a statement at the time, "and we are grateful for her work on Season 1 of the show."

'Stick' sets release date for Season 2: Next up on the tee box, it's Season 2 of the Owen Wilson-led Apple TV show "Stick."

The golf comedy show, starring the actor as a former golf prodigy after a hard fall from grace, will return for Season 2 with two episodes Nov. 4, the streaming service recently announced. Subsequent episodes will drop weekly through Dec. 30.

The announcement also revealed that Golden Globe winner Rhea Seehorn will join the show's cast for Season 2. She joins Wilson and show regulars Peter Dinklage, Marc Maron, Mariana Treviño, Lilli Kay, Judy Greer and Timothy Olyphant.

The second season will see Santi (Dinklage) continue his professional golf pursuits while Pryce (Wilson) launches his own comeback bid, according

to a news release. Seehorn will play Pryce's new coach Amanda in Season 2.

'America's Sweethearts' renewed for fourth season: The Dallas Cowboys Cheerleaders are dancing right back onto Netflix in 2027.

The squad's popular reality show, "America's Sweethearts," has been renewed for a fourth season, the streaming service announced recently. The show will follow the cheerleaders during the 2026-27 season, including a new set of rookie candidates and some returning veterans. Season 4 is set for a 2027 premiere, according to a news release.

"Every season we get a little further past the performance and closer to the person," director Greg Whiteley said in the release. "I'm grateful we get another season to tell their stories."

Senior director Kelli Finglass and head choreographer Judy Trammell will return to lead the 2026 squad.

"We're proud to continue to share their stories and artistry with audiences, inspiring the next generation of young performers all over the world to dream big and pursue their passions," Finglass said in the release.

Crossword

1	2	3	4		5	6	7	8		9	10	11	12	13
14					15					16				
17					18					19				
20					21				22	23				
				24					25				26	
27	28	29							30				31	
32						33	34	35	36				37	38
39						40						41		
42						43						44		
	45		46	47						48	49			
					50				51	52				
						53				54			55	56
58	59	60						61	62			63		
64								65				66		
67								68				69		

By Stella Zawistowski. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC. All rights reserved.

8/27/26

ACROSS

- 1 Role in a movie
- 5 Crow's sounds
- 9 Trite
- 14 Potato, in South Asian cuisine
- 15 Federal workplace regulator: Abbr.
- 16 Author Diamant
- 17 Eucharistic sacrament
- 19 Male goat
- 20 Golf peg
- 21 School support group: Abbr.
- 22 Quick haircut
- 24 Saxophonist Getz
- 25 In the future
- 27 Water depth unit
- 30 Archipelago parts
- 32 Land measurement
- 33 Quechua speaker
- 37 Steal from
- 39 "Bearded" bloom
- 40 "Nifty!"
- 41 Discount event
- 42 Bone at a BBQ
- 43 Old Mexican empire
- 44 Not prerecorded
- 45 ___ with (saw to)

- 48 Shoelace hole
- 50 Direct a car
- 52 Stepped (on)
- 53 "Look what I did!"
- 54 Large pig
- 55 Smartphone program
- 58 Quick
- 61 Book with synonyms
- 64 Fully informed
- 65 Lack of difficulty
- 66 Tennis match parts
- 67 Actor O'Toole
- 68 Pigments
- 69 ___ Orange, NJ

DOWN

- 1 Treaty
- 2 Natural soother
- 3 Trevi Fountain city
- 4 Actor Cruise
- 5 Tainted
- 6 Chinese or Japanese, e.g.
- 7 "___ says so?"
- 8 ___ Claus
- 9 Infants
- 10 Zoo resident
- 11 Zero in soccer
- 12 Georgia airport: Abbr.
- 13 ___ it on the line
- 18 Until: 2 wds.

Solutions

↓	S	V	E		S	E	A	D		R	E	T	E	D
S	I	E	S		E	S	V	E		R	E	V	M	A
S	U	R	U	V	S	E	H	↓		D	I	P	V	R
P	D	V			O	H		V	A	E	↓			
					D	O	R	↓				E	L	S
↓	E	↓	E	A	E				↓	↓	V	E	↓	
E	A	↓	↓		O	E	↓	Z	V		B	I	↓	
↓	↓	S		O	↓	V	E	N		S	I	↓	↓	
B	O	R		N	↓	C	N	↓		E	R	↓	C	V
	S	E	↓	S	↓				W	O	H	↓	V	F
					D	V	E	H	V	N	V	↓	S	
					W	I	↓	R	↓	↓	E	↓	↓	
↓	↓	↓	↓	I	B		N	O	↓	N	↓	N	W	O
V	↓	↓	N	V		V	H	S	O		O	↓	V	
↓	N	V	B		S	M	V	C		↓	R	V	D	

- 23 Big-horned creatures
- 24 Mares and does
- 26 Throw off track
- 27 Decent, but not great
- 28 Harsh and irritating
- 29 "Survivor" teams
- 31 Figure out
- 34 Pince-___ glasses
- 35 "The ___ in the Hat"
- 36 Ingested
- 38 Red root veggie
- 41 Toboggan, e.g.
- 46 Garments

- 47 One with followers
- 49 Exercise with poses
- 51 Assigned a value to
- 52 "One of ___ days..."
- 55 Square footage
- 56 Lays (down)
- 57 "Hey! Over here!"
- 58 Hip-hop song
- 59 Amazement
- 60 Gentle touch
- 62 Horse's fodder
- 63 Put to good ___

Horoscopes



If August 27 is your birthday: Your mind could be busy but productive for the remainder of your birthday month. If there are fewer demands for the next few weeks, take the opportunity to give yourself a nice refresh. October could bring a big opening, but you'll need to be wise.

Aries (March 21-April 19): Lean in to the voice of inner wisdom and away from both self-aggrandizement and its root cause, low self-esteem.

Taurus (April 20-May 20): Friends could amaze you with genius or baffle you with nonsense today — and the vibe could switch up almost too quickly to keep up.

Gemini (May 21-June 20): Align with wise perceptions and don't buy in to dead-end, egotistical thinking going nowhere but down. It could be a fun time to investigate your ancestry or curate family pics or stories.

Cancer (June 21-July 22): Financial matters could be a focus but sliding Universal stars don't make this an optimal day for best returns on decisions or investments.

Leo (July 23-Aug. 22): Protecting your power above all else can make you too monolithic to connect in love, open to your inner softness to allow for the flow of love's sweetness.

Virgo (Aug. 23-Sept. 22): Show up with the strength of your mind, that's what you're likely leading with now as some old fears could be lifting. Stay present for the last little bit of a job to be sure it ends up getting done right.

Libra (Sept. 23-Oct. 22): If you don't look for the sources of present issues in your past, you'll forever repeat unhelpful patterns and only treat symptoms.

Scorpio (Oct. 23-Nov. 21): Allow a friend to talk themselves into a better outlook if they can. If they're stuck in fear, help them see the longer view.

Sagittarius (Nov. 22-Dec. 21): Your focus could move toward your living space, and the choice appears to be between being wise and being foolish.

Capricorn (Dec. 22-Jan. 19): Speak with wisdom, not with a fool's overconfidence or with a snake's forked tongue — those appear to be the most likely communication frequencies today.

Aquarius (Jan. 20-Feb. 18): There could be a push to make a financial decision or a major purchase today, but timing is wrong for either. Universal stars are heading downward, and your financial sectors aren't conducive either.

Pisces (Feb. 19-March 20): Relationships are highlighted but the vibe could fluctuate madly for a day or two. Don't make any decisions now and never from isolated incidents unless they are absolute deal-breakers. Patterns are what to watch.

— Magi Helena, Tribune Content Agency

The Argyle Sweater



Bliss



Bridge

North-South vulnerable, South deals

		North				East	
		♠ J 9 2				♠ A 6 4	
		♥ Void				♥ Q 8 7 4	
		♦ A K J 10 9 7 6 5				♦ 8 3	
		♣ 10 5				♣ Q J 9 7	
		South					
		♠ K Q 7 3					
		♥ A 3					
		♦ Q 4					
		♣ A K 6 3 2					

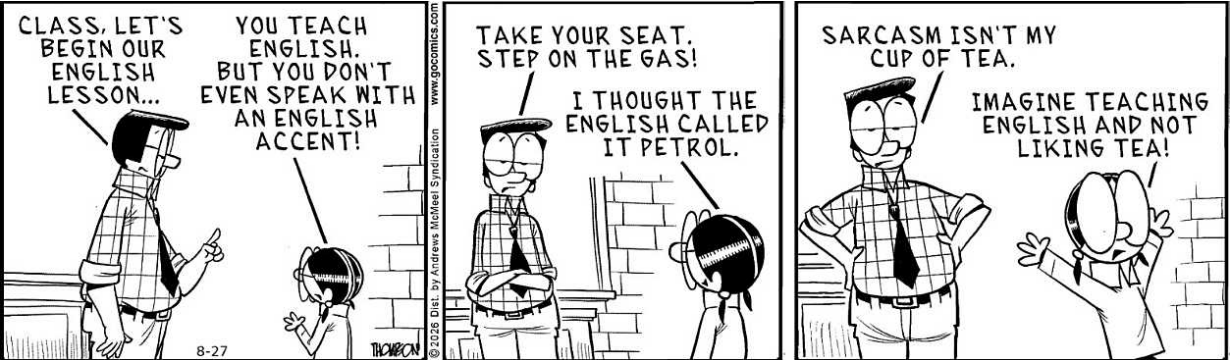
Today's deal is from a pairs competition in Austria. Auctions varied greatly from table to table, but many North-South pairs reached the cold slam in diamonds. Some tried for the extra points by bidding six spades. This failed despite the friendly 3-3 trump split as West was able to get a ruff after leading a diamond. A few pairs bid to six no trump, which seems hopeless on a heart lead, but a strange thing happened. Declarer could not afford to duck a heart or the defense would just cash the ace of spades. They won the opening heart lead and began to run the diamond suit. This was the position with one diamond left to cash:

		North				East	
		♠ J 9				♠ A	
		♥ Void				♥ Q	
		♦ 6				♦ Void	
		♣ 10 5				♣ Q J 9	
		South					
		♠ K Q					
		♥ Void					
		♦ Void					
		♣ A K 6					

When South cashed the last diamond, East had to discard his last heart. South then discarded a low club from his hand and led a spade to set up his twelfth trick in that suit. Making six! This is another example of the magical things that might happen when you run your long suit.

— Bob Jones
Tribune Content Agency

Grand Avenue



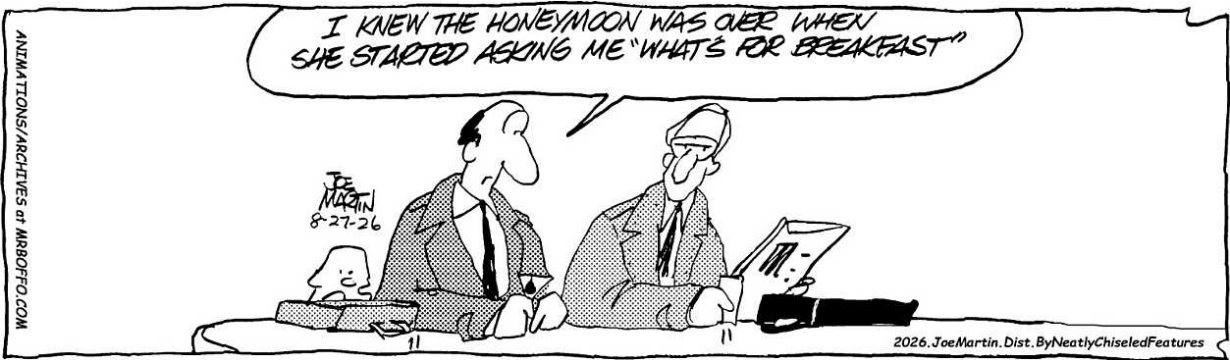
Baby Blues



Zits



Mr. Boffo



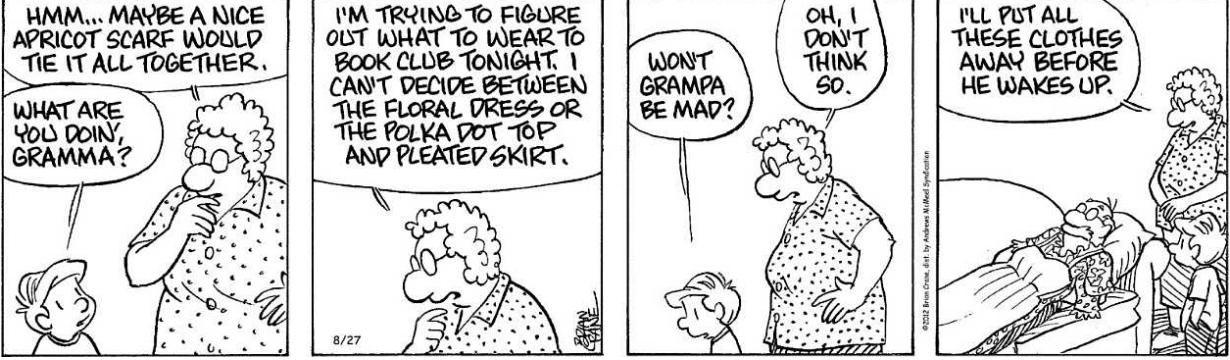
Frazz



Classic Peanuts



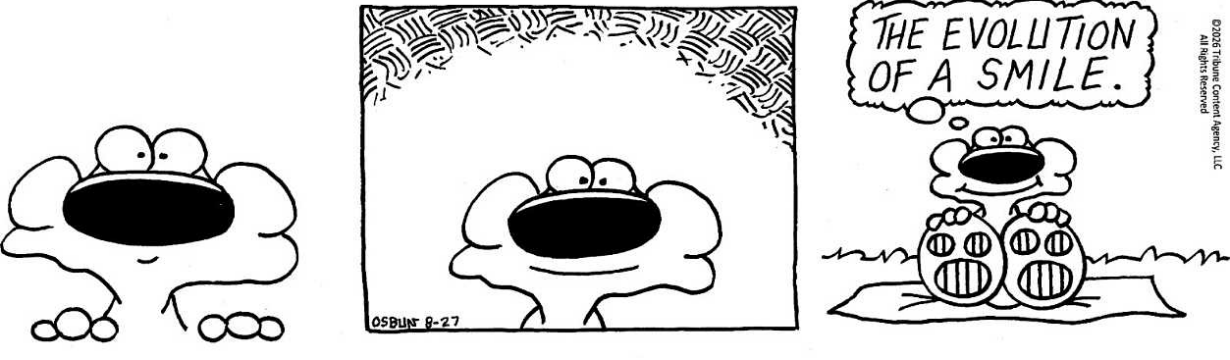
Pickles



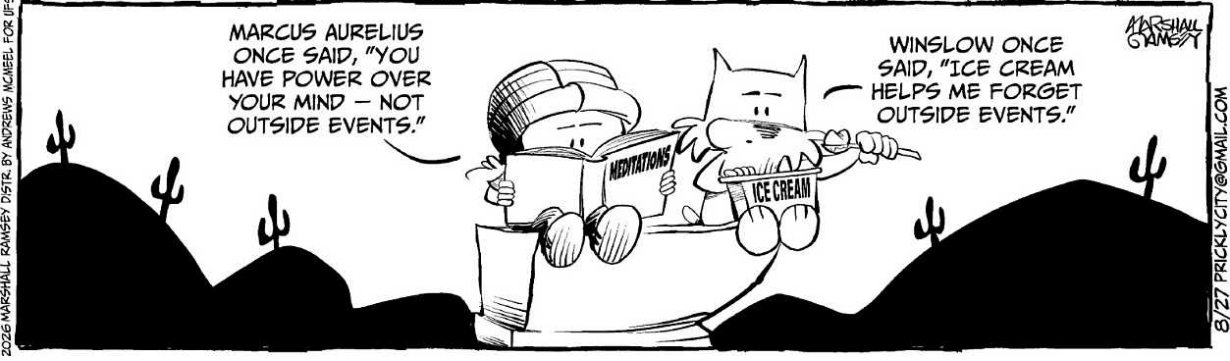
Dick Tracy



Animal Crackers



Prickly City



Dustin By Steve Kelley and Jeff Parker



For Better or for Worse By Lynn Johnston



Blondie By Dean Young and John Marshall



Hägar the Horrible By Chris Browne



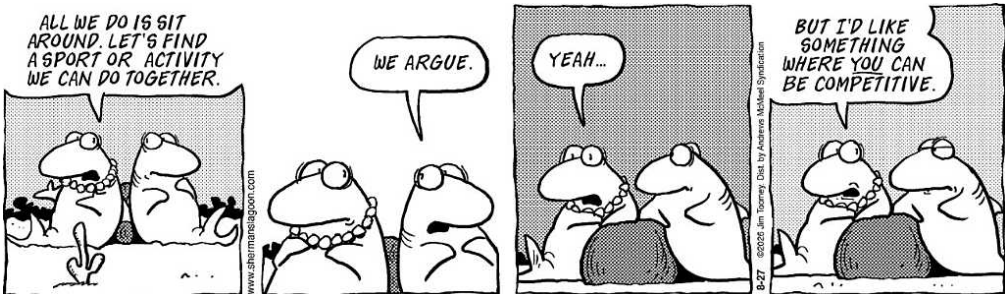
Mutts By Patrick McDonnell



WuMo By Mikael Wulff and Anders Morgenthaler



Sherman's Lagoon By Jim Toomey



Brewster Rockit: Space Guy! By Tim Rickard



Broom-Hilda By Russell Myers



Trivia Bits

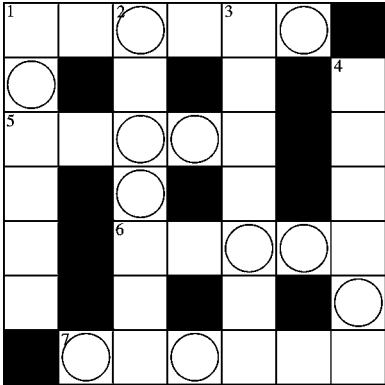
A 1987 opera by composer John Adams is based on whose travels to China?

- A) Pearl S. Buck
B) Richard Nixon
C) Marco Polo
D) Father Matteo Ricci

Wednesday's answer: In Uganda, a street food sandwich of a vegetable omelet wrapped in flatbread is called a rolex because it sounds like "rolled eggs."

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Jumble Crossword



CLUE: He was knighted by Queen Anne on April 16, 1705.

BONUS [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []

ANSWERS: 1-A-Window 2-D-Nomstop 3-D-Overeat 4-D-Legacy 5-B-Iseac Nelson 6-B-Iseac Nelson 7-A-Parthly 8-A-Parthly 9-A-Parthly 10-A-Parthly

- CLUE**
1. Picture ____
5. Narrow boat
6. Eighth Greek letter
7. Indifference
- CLUE**
1. ____ basket
2. ____ flight
3. Gorge
4. Heritage
- ANSWER**
ONWWD
NAOEC
HAETT
PYHTAA
- ANSWER**
KIERWC
NTOSNOP
RAEVETO
CGLYAE

How to play - Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

Sudoku 1234

8/27

		7				9	3
		1			8		
8	4			3		5	
6		8	2			7	
			1		9		
	9				7	6	2
				1		2	5
			9			3	
3	5					4	

7	6	1	5	4	8	3	2	9
9	3	8	2	1	6	4	7	5
4	5	2	9	7	3	6	8	1
3	4	9	6	2	1	8	5	7
8	2	6	4	5	7	9	1	3
5	1	7	8	3	9	2	4	6
1	8	3	7	9	2	5	6	4
2	7	4	3	6	5	1	9	8
6	9	5	1	8	4	7	3	2

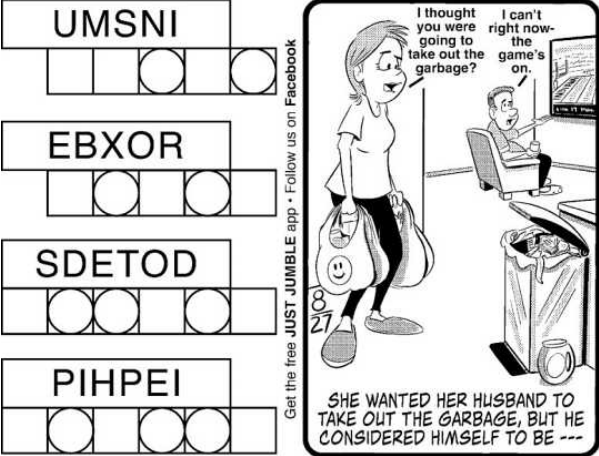
Complete the grid so each row, column and 3-by-3 box in bold borders contains every digit 1 to 9.

Wednesday's solutions

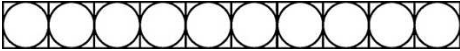
By The Mephram Group
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Jumble

Unscramble the four Jumbles, one letter per square, to form four words. Then arrange the circled letters to form the surprise answer, as suggested by this cartoon.



Answer here



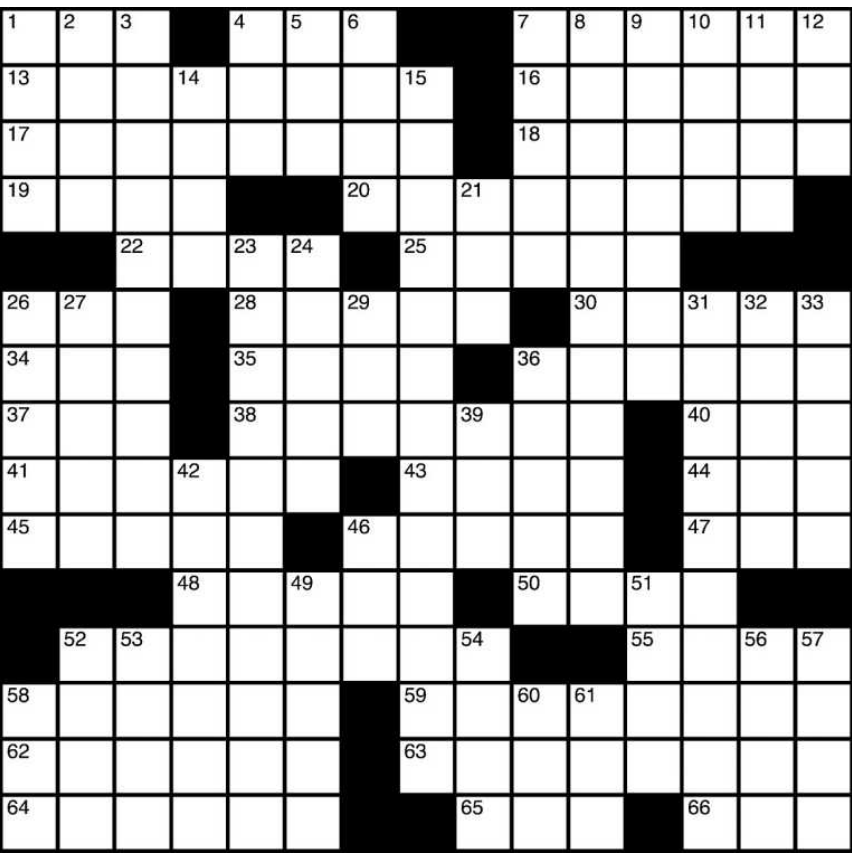
Wednesday's answers

Jumbles: DRAWL WHOSE MIRROR BLEACH
Answer: He graduated with a degree in street building, which made him a — "ROAD" SCHOLAR

By David L. Hoyt and Jeff Knurek. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC. All rights reserved. PlayJumble.com

Crossword

8/27



Across

- 1 "Mister Rogers' Neighborhood" network
4 Collision sound
7 Hill partner, in textbook publishing and country music
13 Big sellers
16 "That's old news"
17 "Could there possibly be a good explanation for this?"
18 Skating jumps similar to toe loops
19 Ruckus
20 Motorcycle attachments
22 Hair line?
25 Dangers
26 Disconnect
28 "Get ___ town!"
30 Ski area near Reno
34 Gold at the Milano Cortina Olympics?
35 Second, but not first

Wednesday's solution



By Rebecca Goldstein & Matthew Stock. Edited by Patti Varol. © 2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC.

- 36 Getting the check
37 ___ choy
38 Every evening
40 Prefix with political
41 Revises
43 Assessment, briefly
44 Boater or bowler
45 Greta of classic Hollywood
46 Hustle genre
47 Texting tech
48 Some natural hairstyles
50 Part of QED
52 Trench coat, wig, and big sunglasses, maybe
55 Sando spread
58 Patchy-patterned horses
59 Tacit
62 Certain spot
63 Application that combats dark circles
64 Gobbles (down)
65 Some GEs
66 ___/her/hers

- 9 Participate in decision-making
10 Motorola phone
11 Combative Olympian?
12 Dict. entries
14 Michael of "Juno"
15 Dance around what's really important
21 Opposite of noite
23 Links activity
24 North African capital
26 Emergency kit
27 Sweet smell
29 Comedian Notaro
31 With a lot on the line, or a phonetic hint to 3-, 8-, 15-, and 23-Down
32 Wee hour
33 Showbiz quartets
36 Come in second
39 Sports bar sets
42 Supreme court presence?
46 Eager agreement
49 Tricks
51 "Te quiero, ___ mío"
52 Singer Celine
53 Empire also known as the "Realm of the Four Parts"
54 New Age singer who speaks Irish
56 "Totes"
57 "I'll get the check"
58 [Praying emoji]
60 Org. with LSU Tigers, Auburn Tigers, and Missouri Tigers
61 WFH devices

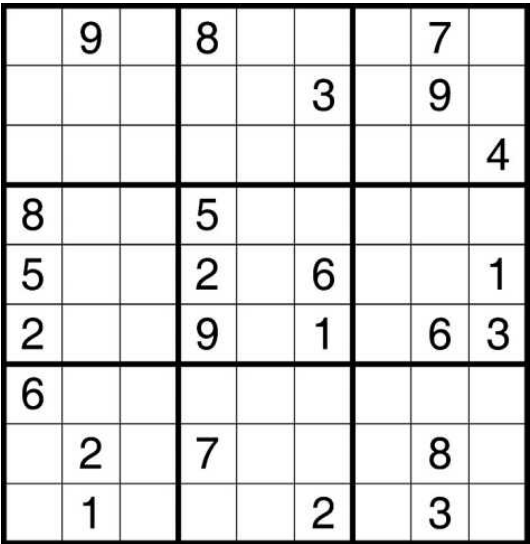
BONUS PUZZLE PAGE

An extra array of word games, search and Jumble. Want more? Play online at [PlayJumble.com](https://www.playjumble.com)



Scan QR code to play online.

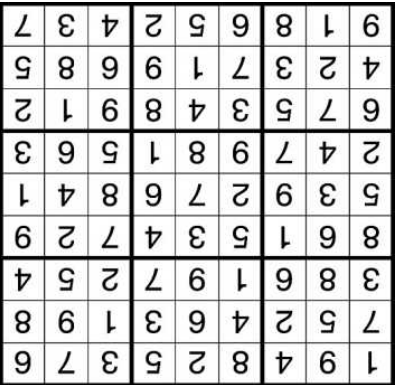
SUDOKU



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Level 1 2 3 4

Complete the grid so each row, column and 3-by-3 box (in bold borders) contains every digit from 1 to 9. For strategies on solving Sudoku, visit [sudoku.org.uk](https://www.sudoku.org.uk).



11/11/22

WORD SEARCH

Wordsearch: It's all free

1339

Can you find all the words hidden in the grid? Read backwards or forwards, up or down, or diagonally. The words will always be in a straight line. Cross them off the list as you find them.



ABSOLVE
AT LIBERTY
CLEAR
COMPLIMENTARY
DEVOID
EMPTY
EXEMPT
FORGIVEN
GIVEAWAY
GRATIS

INDEPENDENT
LET OFF
LIBERATED
LOOSE
OPEN
RELEASE
REMITTED
UNAFFECTED
UNATTACHED
UNBOUND

UNBURDENED
UNCHARGED
UNCONFINED
UNCONSTRAINED
UNFETTERED
UNHINDERED
UNRESTRICTED
UNSHACKLED
UNTIE
VACANT

Illustration: The Mephram Group. Distributed by Tribune Content Agency.

BOGGLE



By David L. Hoyt and Jeff Knurek



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INSTRUCTIONS: Find as many words as you can by linking letters up, down, side-to-side and diagonally, writing words on a blank sheet of paper. You may only use each letter box once within a single word. Play with a friend and compare word finds, crossing out common words.

BOGGLE POINT SCALE
3 letters = 1 point
4 letters = 2 points
5 letters = 3 points
6 letters = 4 points
7 letters = 6 points
8 letters = 10 points
9+ letters = 15 points

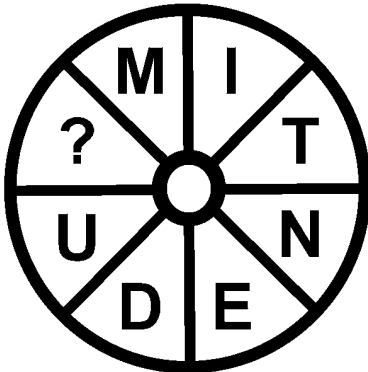
YOUR BOGGLE RATING
151+ = Champ
101-150 = Expert
81-100 = Pro
31-60 = Gamer
21-30 = Rookie
11-20 = Amateur
0-10 = Try again

Boggle BrainBusters Bonus
We put special brain-busting words into the grid of letters. Can you find them?

Find AT LEAST SIX MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS in the grid of letters.

DRUM HARP LUTE BUGLE FLUTE GUITAR

WordWheel

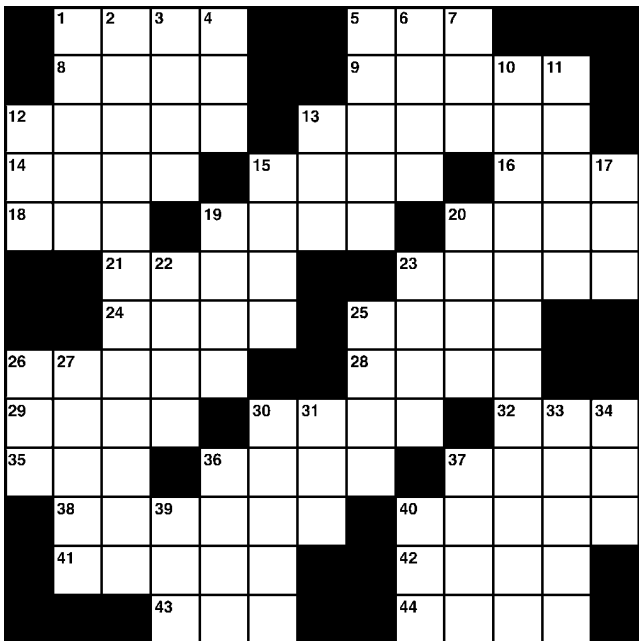


Insert the missing letter to complete an eight-letter word reading clockwise or counterclockwise.

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TV CROSSWORD

by Jacqueline E. Mathews



Created by Jacqueline E. Mathews

4/18/21

ACROSS

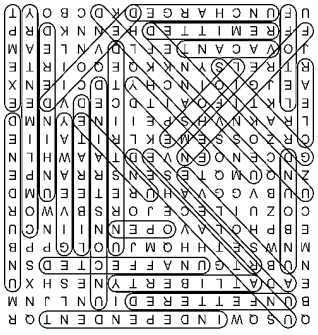
- 1 James or Scott
- 5 Actor Marienthal
- 8 Actress/model ___ Nicole Smith
- 9 Disney fawn
- 12 "Mork & ___"
- 13 Assistant
- 14 Opera solo
- 15 "___ the Explorer"
- 16 "___ Amsterdam"
- 18 Buck's mate
- 19 Dad on "Little People, Big World"
- 20 Annapolis acad.
- 21 Jack & Jill's receptacle
- 23 Woodwind instruments
- 24 Actress Sommer
- 25 Series for Sherman Hemsley
- 26 "___ of Two Cities"
- 28 Injure
- 29 Main role on "Boy Meets World"
- 30 "___ Little Rich Girl"; Shirley Temple film
- 32 Tax-collecting agcy.
- 35 Six-pointers, for short



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DOWN

- 36 Tyne or Tim
- 37 Soak up with a paper towel
- 38 Daisy Duck's beau
- 40 Field of films
- 41 Nighttime noise
- 42 Fratricide victim
- 43 Jazz guitarist Montgomery
- 44 Actor Richard
- 1 Egypt's largest city
- 2 Role on "This Is Us"
- 3 "Two ___ Half Men"
- 4 Anti's vote
- 5 Film critic Roger
- 6 "___ Land"; 2016 Ryan Gosling movie
- 7 Mischief-maker
- 10 Omar ___; actor on "The Unicorn"
- 11 Ryan of "The Beverly Hillbillies"
- 12 "___ About You"
- 13 "___ in Cleveland" (2010-15)
- 15 Actor Robertson
- 17 "How the West ___ Won"
- 19 Role on "All in the Family"
- 20 Taxi alternative
- 22 Actress Sheedy
- 23 ___ Sharif
- 25 Word from Popeye
- 26 "Sister ___"; film for Whoopi
- 27 Actor Bridges & others
- 30 Loses color
- 31 "No Country for ___ Men"; 2007 movie
- 33 Esther of "Good Times"
- 34 Phippen
- 36 "Where Eagles ___"; Richard Burton film
- 37 1995 movie about a pig
- 39 "I'm a Big Girl ___"
- 40 Hang limply

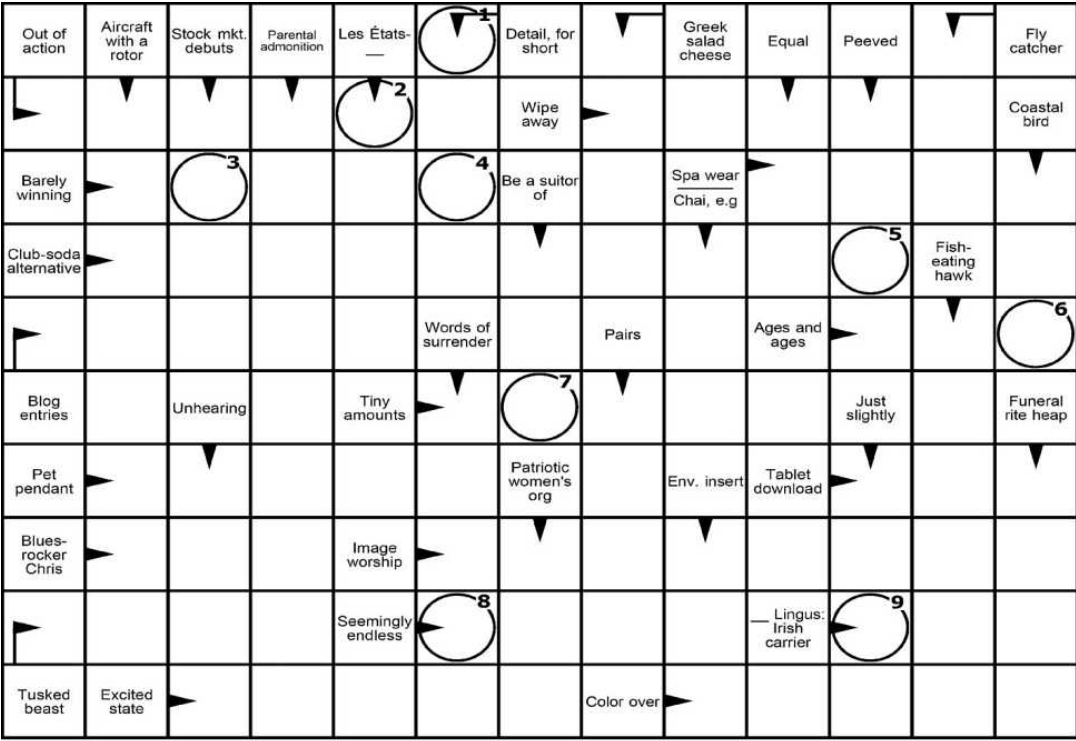


It's all free



ARROW WORDS

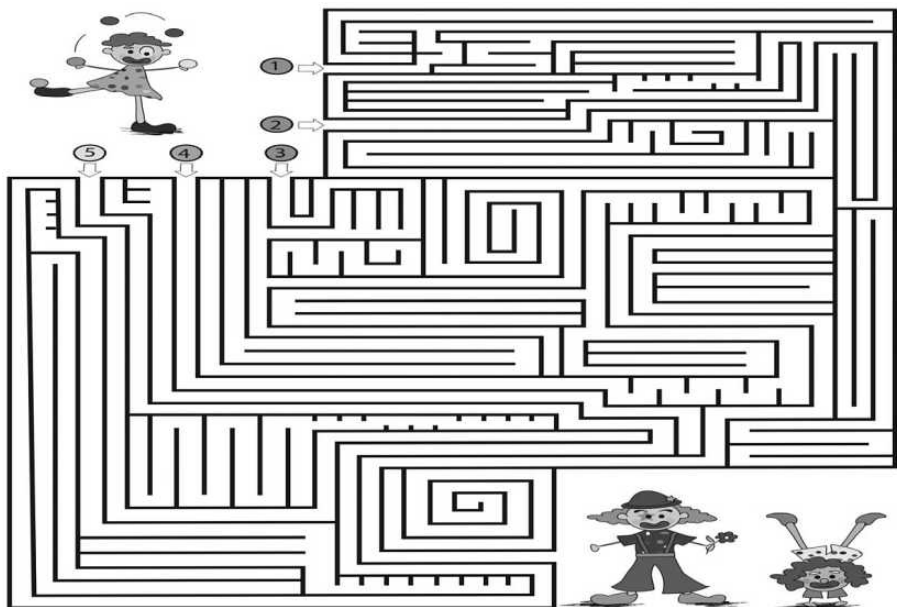
Fill in the grid using the clues provided in the direction of the arrows. When complete, unscramble the letters in the circles to reveal a mystery word.



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2/17/24

KIDNEWS FUN & GAMES



SPOT 5 DIFFERENCES





White Sox left fielder Tristan Peters celebrates at second base after driving in two runs on a double in the first inning against the Rangers at Rate Field on Tuesday. CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

WHITE SOX

‘He’s been incredible’

Sox outfielder Peters is on a hot stretch at the plate

By LaMond Pope
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Tristan Peters heard a partial list of White Sox players who had homered in four straight games. Names like Paul Konerko, Hall of Famers Jim Thome and Harold Baines, along with current teammate Colson Montgomery.

UP NEXT



White Sox at Twins
7:10 p.m. Friday,
CHSN

“That’s really cool company,” the outfielder said. Peters joined them on Tuesday with a home run in his fourth straight game when he connected for a long ball in the sixth inning of the 11-7 victory against the Texas Rangers at Rate Field. He entered Wednesday’s series finale one shy of matching the

franchise record of five straight, a mark shared by Munetaka Murakami (earlier this season), A.J. Pierzynski (2012), Konerko (2011), Carlos Lee (2003), Frank Thomas (twice in 1994), Ron Kittle (1983) and Greg Luzinski (1983). “He’s been incredible,” Sox starter Anthony Kay said. “He’s on a good streak. Having him on fire like he is, that deep into the lineup (seventh or eighth), creates more problems for the other team.” According to Elias Sports Bureau, Peters and Murakami

17-22) are the only pair of rookies in Sox history to record a home run streak of four games or more in the same season. And Peters, Murakami and Montgomery (four in a row from April 18-22) are the first Sox trio to record home run streaks of four games or more in the same season since Luzinski (five straight from May 20-24, 1983), Kittle (five straight from Sept. 2-9, 1983) and Baines (four straight from Sept. 15-18, 1983) accomplished the feat

See PETERS on Page C2

DIAMONDBACKS 2, CUBS 0

Missed balk call costly in loss

By Meghan Montemurro
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

PHOENIX — Pete Crow-Armstrong was still fuming two hours after the controversial call. The Cubs hadn’t done much against Arizona Diamondbacks left-hander Eduardo Rodríguez when Crow-Armstrong doubled to lead off the sixth inning Wednesday. In a scoreless game, Crow-Armstrong advanced to third on a groundout, putting the Cubs in position to break through with a series win on the line. Crow-Armstrong’s aggressive steps toward home during Rodríguez’s delivery on the lefty’s 2-1 pitch to Michael Busch seemingly got the Cubs on the board by inducing the lefty to balk when his back foot appeared to step off the rubber in reaction to the center fielder’s move to the plate. Crow-Armstrong and third-base coach Quintin Berry immediately gestured toward Rodríguez after he threw a ball, looking for a balk call in what became a pivotal sequence in the Cubs’ eventual 2-0 loss. The call ultimately would not go their way. Led by plate umpire and crew chief Alfonso Márquez, the umpires gathered for a conference in the infield to discuss Rodríguez’s pitch and determined the original ruling of no balk stood. Crow-Armstrong was immediately incensed and darted onto the infield toward third-base umpire Malachi Moore. Berry had to step between them and physically push Crow-Armstrong back into foul territory near the coach’s box to prevent him from getting ejected. Crow-Armstrong also did not appreciate that following the ump’s conference, second-base umpire Lance Barksdale came up to him after Berry had de-escalated the situation. “I saw four umpires miss a pretty obvious play,” Crow-Armstrong said. “They’re out there every day like we are. Their one job is to get calls right, and if they get it wrong,

See CUBS on Page C3



Cubs center fielder Pete Crow-Armstrong, center, and third-base coach Quintin Berry argue with umpire Lance Barrett during the sixth inning against the Diamondbacks on Wednesday in Phoenix. ROSS D. FRANKLIN/AP

UP NEXT



Reds at Cubs
1:20 p.m. Friday,
Marquee

Payton motivated by ‘the haters’ in new role as Score morning host



New Score personality Jarrett Payton made a cameo on the station Wednesday, a soft launch five days before he replaces Mike Mulligan as co-host of the morning show with David Haugh. Payton was a morning guest of Leila Rahimi and Mark Grote on the rebranded “Rahimi & Grote Show,” which Grote accidentally referred to

“Rahimi and Harris,” momentarily forgetting the Score also fired their former co-host, Marshall Harris. It’s hard to remember who is where these days at the Score, with vacations and firings and everything else going on. Payton said he was excited to be at the Score and that hosting a radio show was always his “passion.” He and Haugh will kick off the new “Haugh & Payton Show” on Monday morning. A revolving door of TV personalities has been co-hosting this week with Haugh on vacation and Mulligan let go Friday in a move that has sent Chicago sports radio observers into an uproar that

hasn’t died down. Mulligan hasn’t responded publicly to the news of the end of his nearly two-decade career as morning host at WSCR-AM 670 and FM 104.3, but friends have said he’s doing well after feeling “blindsided” by the decision. Hopefully he’s enjoying the longest-running Irish wake in history for a fired Chicago sports radio host. Internet-fueled anger over his firing — and the fact Mulligan wasn’t offered a chance to say goodbye to listeners — was more heated than the station bargained for.

See SULLIVAN on Page C2



Jarrett Payton speaks before the unveiling of a statue of his father, Bears great Walter Payton, outside Soldier Field on Sept. 3, 2019. ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Coming up

Team		Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday	Monday
	BEARS			@TEN (exh.) 5 p.m. Fox-32		
	CUBS		CIN 1:20 p.m. Marquee	CIN 1:20 p.m. Marquee	CIN 6:20 p.m. NBC-5	MIL 6:40 p.m. Marquee
	WHITE SOX		@MIN 7:10 p.m. CHSN	@MIN 1:10 p.m. CHSN	@MIN 1:10 p.m. CHSN	@HOU 7:10 p.m. CHSN
	SKY			@NY noon CBS-2		
	FIRE			@SEA 3:30 p.m. Apple TV		
	STARS			@DEN 7:45 p.m. Ion		

BEARS TRAINING CAMP REPORT

Burden, Wright return to practice

By Sean Hammond
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicago Bears wide receiver Luther Burden III and right tackle Darnell Wright returned to practice Wednesday at Halas Hall after dealing with injuries.

Burden hadn't participated since leaving practice Aug. 8 with a groin injury. He took part in only individual drills Wednesday as he ramps back up.

Wright exited practice with the trainers Tuesday after suffering what appeared to be a right elbow injury. He returned Wednesday with a brace on the elbow, which he has worn since initially injuring it last year.

The Bears practiced for less than an hour before heading to Nashville, Tenn., where they will hold a joint practice with the Tennessee Titans on Thursday ahead of their preseason game Saturday at Nissan Stadium (5 p.m., Fox-32).

Here's what stood out Wednesday at Halas Hall.

SEEN AND HEARD

Wright tore the ulnar collateral ligament in his right elbow in Week 3 last year and played through the injury the rest of the season, missing only one game. It appeared he tweaked the same elbow Tuesday, but the trainers may have pulled him out as a precaution.

There wasn't much full-team work during practice Wednesday, but Wright appeared to be a full participant.

Burden missed just shy of three weeks with the groin injury that reports indicated would keep him out through the preseason. Coach Ben Johnson hadn't given a specific timeline for Burden other than to say he would miss a "little bit of time."

Johnson wasn't made available Wednesday to comment on either player's return or the plan for either this week in Tennessee.

Notably, the Bears were without defensive tackle Gervon Dexter Sr., who left practice early Tuesday, and defensive end Austin Booker, who hasn't participated since last week's joint practice in Cincinnati.

On the practice field, the Bears did a brief 7-on-7 red-zone period. Quarterback Caleb Williams connected with Colston Loveland, Kalif Raymond and D'Andre Swift for short completions.

On Williams' final play of the period, he scrambled to his right and connected with Jahdae Walker for a touchdown after Walker found space with cornerback Jaylon Johnson covering him. Walker, never afraid to talk smack, let out a



Bears offensive tackle Darnell Wright practices Aug. 13 during training camp at Halas Hall in Lake Forest. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Bears wide receiver Luther Burden III answers questions during a news conference after practice Aug. 4 at Halas Hall. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

shout after the play and made sure the defense heard him.

Backup quarterback Tyson Bagent and wide receiver Scotty Miller connected for a touchdown in tight coverage for the second-team offense. Cornerback Terrell Smith and safety Xavier Woods were right in Miller's face, but he managed to catch a ball up the seam for the touchdown.

Fresh off the physically unable to perform list with a shin injury, safety Elijah Hicks took a few reps with the starters in 7-on-7. He could be in the mix with Woods and Cam Lewis in the battle for the starting safety job beside first-round draft pick Dillon Thieneman. Hicks has been mostly a backup during his four-year NFL career but has started 15 games.

Cornerback Jaylon Jones took some reps at nickel back with

the second-team defense. Jones returned Tuesday after missing nearly three weeks with an ankle injury.

The Bears did only one quick situational period with the full team. Facing fourth-and-4 near midfield, Williams connected with tight end Cole Kmet on a quick pass outside that led to a first down.

For the second team, a false-start penalty moved the offense back to fourth-and-9. Linebacker D'Marco Jackson broke up Bagent's pass to Walker over the middle.

PLAYER IN THE SPOTLIGHT: BEAU GARDNER

The Bears entered training camp with two untested long snappers: Gardner and Luke Elkin. Neither has played a regular-season snap in the NFL.

The position battle didn't last long. The Bears waived Elkin on Aug. 9, leaving Gardner as the only long snapper on the roster. The undrafted rookie out of Georgia won the Patrick Mannelly Award last year as college football's best long snapper.

He will be a player to watch early in the season. He may have been the best long snapper coming out of college football this year, but he's still untested at the NFL level.

For years, the Bears have gone with a veteran at that vital position. Patrick Scales played in 120 regular-season games for the Bears from 2015-23 before an injury during 2024 training camp cut his season short. The Bears went with veteran Scott Daly in 2024-25. Daly signed with the Tampa Bay Buccaneers in free agency this spring.

In steps Gardner.

The joint practice with the Bengals last week was a good test for the rookie, and special teams coordinator Richard Hightower expects another good challenge Thursday from the Titans.

"We got put in some tough situations and we're asking the Titans to do the same thing," Hightower said. "We want a challenge at all times because it's going to happen in a game."

"He showed some things, but he also showed that we need to continue to work on some things. That's going to be the case for every player and not just Beau. He held his own. So we were happy about that."

The two biggest points of emphasis for Gardner are his accuracy on snaps — Hightower is looking for "a good, clean, deliverable football" — and his blocking ability after the snap.

QUOTE OF NOTE

In addition to Hicks, the Bears activated rookie linebacker Keyshaun Elliott off the PUP list Tuesday. Elliott had yet to practice during camp because of a back injury. His goal for this season, prior to his injury, was to emerge as a "core four" special teamer — playing on the kickoff, kickoff-return, punt and punt-return teams.

The injury has been a setback, but Hightower said the fifth-round draft pick hasn't fallen behind because he has been so detailed in his preparation.

"That kid is dialed in," Hightower said. "Although he hasn't been on the field, he hasn't missed a beat in the meeting room and he comes up for extra meeting time. He's like a machine. Like he's in there, 'Coach, I'm in there at 6 o'clock every other morning. You're gonna be there?'"

The depth chart is crowded with more experienced linebackers ahead of Elliott, but special teams is an area where the rookie could make his mark.

INJURIES AND PARTICIPATION

In addition to Dexter's and Booker's absences, the Bears were without running back Kyle Monangai (right knee), cornerback Dontae Manning (undisclosed), tight end Hayden Large (undisclosed) and linebackers Tony Fields II (undisclosed) and Ruben Hyppolite II (undisclosed).

Defensive tackle Grady Jarrett and guard Joe Thuney were given veteran rest days. Defensive end Marcus Davenport, whom the Bears signed last week, has yet to practice.

around long enough to know that comes with the territory of a high-profile job, and he's a ubiquitous presence on the sports-media landscape.

"I don't know if he's human, honestly," Payton said jokingly, referring to Haugh's heavy workload at the Score and Chicago Sports Network.

It will be up to Haugh to steer the show, bring out the best in Payton and keep things interesting enough for loyal Score listeners who are either giddy or disgruntled over the latest Bears game. Unlike many Score hosts, Payton actually grew up in the Chicago area, played sports at St. Viator and apparently is a Cubs fan from childhood. That apparently was another sore spot for critics who think the Score waived a couple Sox fans in Mulligan and Harris and didn't replace either with a Sox fan.

I've known Payton, who is likeable and well respected in the business, since he was starting out on CLTV "SportsFeed" in the early 2010s. He has come a long way since then, and no one can say he hasn't paid his dues on the Chicago sports media merry-go-round.

Payton deserves a chance to be heard. And if you don't think he's worthy of debating sports in Chicago, punch another station or click on a podcast.

It's really quite simple.

PETERS

from Page C1

in 1983, according to Elias.

The run for Peters, 26, began with a unique home run in the third inning on Saturday against the New York Mets at Rate Field. Mets outfielder Carson Benge ran face-first into the fence in right field trying to chase down the long fly ball hit by Peters. He couldn't hang on to the ball, which went out of his glove and over the wall for a solo home run.

"It was funny because I thought it was a home run off the bat," Peters said after that game. "Then I saw he caught it, and I was like, 'Dang, I hit that one hard.' Then I saw it go over the wall and I was pretty pumped."

Peters left no doubt the next day, walking off the Mets with a solo home run in the ninth inning for a 2-1 Sox victory.

"It got in a little on me, and I know to center it's been tough in this ballpark," Peters said after that game. "But I also knew the ball was flying today, so I was just telling the ball 'keep going.'"

Peters provided all of the offense for the Sox in Monday's 11-2 loss to the Rangers, hitting a two-run home run in the second inning.

Tuesday's home run came as part of a three-hit evening. He came within a triple of hitting for the cycle for the second time this season. He hit for the cycle on July 10 against the Athletics at Rate Field, a day before he learned he earned an All-Star selection. Chairman Jerry Reinsdorf later presented Peters with a custom ring in recognition of the cycle.

"I was not expecting that, that was really special," Peters said.

Peters entered Wednesday tied for sixth on the team with 11 home runs.

"TP? Yeah, that has been unbelievable," third baseman Miguel Vargas said of Peters' stretch. "He's an All-Star. Seeing him, the way he is handling it, it's amazing. We are very happy for him and he has been helping this team since Day 1. It's great to see him doing that stuff."

He is one of seven Sox with at least 10 home runs this season.

"He flies under the radar because he's usually batting seventh or eighth," Kay said. "He does his job down there. He's incredible."

Peters is slashing .367/.466/.776 (18-for-49) over his last 18 games since Aug. 6.

"He's seeing the ball, he's making good swing decisions," manager Will Venable said. "I don't want to say predicting what is coming, but when you're in that spot, you're kind of in tune with how you're being attacked and we're seeing obviously great results."

According to OptaSTATS, Peters is just the third player in Major League Baseball history to hit for the cycle, hit a grand slam and walk-off home run, homer in four straight games, record six RBIs and reach base safely five times in a game in one season, joining Hall of Famers Jimmie Foxx (1933) and Joe DiMaggio (1937).

"I mean, it's crazy," Peters said of the season to date. "I would have never seen this like a year ago. God has blessed me just beyond measure, and I'm just so thankful for that and the people in this room that I get to play along with."



White Sox center fielder Tristan Peters runs the bases after hitting a two-run homer during the second inning against the Rangers at Rate Field on Monday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

SULLIVAN

from Page C1

Like any true Irish wake, any of his blemishes have been papered over, and he's being remembered mostly for his wit, passion and eccentricities. "Great stuff," as he liked to say.

The Score hasn't disclosed why he was let go, inviting speculation.

Payton, a longtime sports anchor and reporter at WGN-Ch. 9, walks into a difficult position as the new co-host of the morning show. He's replacing someone who obviously had more fans than anyone at Audacy realized and doesn't have a long history as a radio personality, much less one whose opinions are expected to help shape the always shifting narratives of the Chicago sports world.

Critics on social media and the internet have already taken aim, which led Payton to thanking them for the hateful comments during his introductory appearance.

"I try to stay off the socials a little bit, it's a dangerous place," he said. "I'll say this too: Thank you to the haters. Now I'm motivated."

He sounded a little like his dad, Bears great Walter Payton, who once said on "The Late Show with David Letterman" that the worst thing any opposing fan

could do was heckle him before a game.

"I can't deal with that," Walter told Letterman. "That upsets me so bad, it makes me play better."

Father knows best? Jarrett Payton said he and Haugh would disagree on some things, which is what makes sports radio work. He told listeners that his wife and mother-in-law read some of the social media commentary that called him out for saying he left WGN to be with his family.

Then why go back to work so quickly?

Payton said his kids told him: "Dad, you've got to do something else. You have to. We want to see you."

A morning shift actually leaves him more time to be with his kids and their activities, not less.

Payton mentioned his late dad only once to point out that "Pops" didn't make enough money in his career for his kids not to work.

"It's funny to see all these comments," he said.

Payton talked a little Bears with Rahimi and Grote — the left tackle spot, Montez Sweat, etc. — which seemed like a good idea since his knowledge of the NFL and the Bears organization was one of the main reasons for his hiring. It's fair to wonder about Payton's willingness to criticize Bears ownership, since the McCaskeys reportedly have

a good relationship with the Paytons, including Jarrett's mother, Connie.

If the Bears were to move to Hammond, would Payton criticize the McCaskeys like the rest of Bears fans? Or would he be the good cop to Haugh's bad cop?

The stadium issue wasn't discussed Wednesday, and neither was baseball, which is unfortunate since he'll also have to establish himself as an expert on the Cubs and White Sox as they navigate this stretch run.

But the 23-minute interview was just an appetizer from the Score to let listeners hear things straight from the horse's mouth.

Audacy has not made Payton available for interviews, another curious decision in a week full of them. You would think the station would want to promote his hiring instead of downplaying it.

Payton has been the target of some over-the-top criticism, which probably is something he'll have to get used to if he hopes to make it as a morning show host. A who's who of former Chicago radio personalities have chimed in on the Score moves, because old radio hosts never really fade away, even if their big paychecks do.

Haugh, a former Tribune sports reporter and columnist, also has been under attack on X in the wake of the Mulligan news, which was expected. He has been

CUBS



The Cubs' Carson Kelly, right, celebrates his home run against the Diamondbacks with third base coach Quintin Berry during the sixth inning Monday in Phoenix. **ROSS D. FRANKLIN/AP**

Brown suffers a setback with injury

By Meghan Montemurro
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

PHOENIX — The Cubs hoped right-hander Ben Brown could return to the pitching staff by the end of the season and be a potential multi-inning weapon in the playoffs. A setback is creating uncertainty for that vision. Sidelined by a stress reaction in his neck since June 21, Brown threw his live batting practice Tuesday morning at Sloan Park in Mesa, Ariz., in front of Cubs staff that included manager Craig Counsell and pitching coach Tommy Hottovy. If he had come out of the live BP, his second of the rehab process, feeling good, Brown would have started a rehab assignment in a significant step toward a return. However, Brown suffered a setback Tuesday when he became symptomatic near the end of Tuesday's two-inning live BP. His symptoms — the same as what he dealt with before — worsened as the day progressed. Brown will travel with the Cubs back to Chicago following Wednesday's 2-0 loss to the Arizona Diamondbacks and be reevaluated.

"We're going to have to kind of regroup, and he'll probably check back in with the doctors and see what it means," Counsell said. "He's felt great and he's felt so good that there's been nothing there — there'd been no bad news. This is the first day of bad news. "I'm not sure yet what this means, but it's going to slow it down in some way." The schedule is starting to work against Brown. With 4 ½ weeks remaining in the regular season and just 28 games left for the Cubs, there isn't much of a window for Brown to get through his throwing progression, especially if he's required to shut down again due to his neck symptoms. While the Cubs knew they couldn't bank on Brown returning before the end of the year, the 26-year-old's performance before the issue popped up was too dominant not to dream of having him for the postseason.

Brown was on his way to earning his first All-Star honor with a 1.85 ERA and 220 ERA+ in 20 games (eight starts) when his neck started bothering him following his June 19 start. The lingering ailment is especially concerning for Brown after the same problem cost him most of his 2024 rookie season, also initially cropping up in June that year. When Brown initially went on the injured list two months ago, he acknowledged he might need to adjust something within his mechanics to avoid the stress reaction continuing to come up since it's happened twice in three seasons.

"I could fix all my mechanics and do everything off the field to move better or to throw in a healthier way, but that's not going to take away from the fact that the bone has to heal, so that's the focus and priority No. 1," Brown said on June 27. "And then we're just navigating in the meantime what can I do that's asymptomatic. "Obviously it's frustrating in the midst of a season where I'm doing some really cool things, but also I can't lose sight of how talented I am and how much I can contribute, and ultimately that's the end goal is to get back to that."

Brouhaha a sign of the times

Pitch tipping incident highlights how teams try to find an edge in the PitchCom era

By Meghan Montemurro
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

PHOENIX — A day after tensions rose between the Cubs and the Arizona Diamondbacks over pitch tipping, the issue appeared resolved for both sides by Tuesday night. The situation reached a crescendo during the fifth inning of the Cubs' 7-0 win Monday. The Diamondbacks became incensed by Cubs third-base coach Quintin Berry relaying pitch information to his hitters from cues he picked up watching right-hander Merrill Kelly. The Cubs had done their due diligence through video work before the series, which Berry was then able to pick up from his vantage point in the third-base coach's box during Monday's game. The chirping escalated to finger-pointing, yelling and some f-bombs lobbed from coaches in each dugout in the top of the fifth. Berry was catching plenty of heat, too, from his on-field position directly in front of the Diamondbacks dugout on the third-base side. Diamondbacks bench coach Jeff Bannister and Cubs bench coach Ryan Flaherty were at the center of it, while Kelly was seen glaring at Berry from the mound and then the dugout after he was pulled in the sixth. Afterward, Kelly felt that Berry's efforts to relay pitches to the hitters were "bush league," while manager Craig Counsell said, "That's gamesmanship that goes on every day in the league." "If it's a guy on second base and they see the grip in your glove or the hitters can see something that you're doing with your glove, I think that's fair game, guys have been doing that since the beginning of baseball," Kelly told reporters. "Inside the lines is one thing. I think guys standing outside the lines, it's a little bush league." Emotions had cooled by pregame Tuesday. Diamondbacks manager Torey Lovullo called Counsell on Tuesday to apologize for his team's anger at Berry's actions, noting the league said his pitch relaying was legal from his position in the coach's box.

"I think the world of Torey," Counsell said Tuesday. "He felt like he wanted to do it, and I appreciate it." Bannister and Berry met at first base during Diamondbacks batting practice Tuesday to hash things out. The roughly five-minute conversation concluded with Bannister and Berry exchanging a handshake and hug. Berry plans to keep doing whatever he can to help his hitters. "It's pure emotional competition," Berry told the Tribune. "They're obviously playing for something, we're playing for something and I think when you're trying to do that you're trying to gain control of both sides of the situation. If they think we've got something, and they think I'm doing something, and they're yelling at me, trying to get me to stop, that makes sense too. "If they think I'm over there doing something that's going to give us an advantage, them barking at me as much as they can to try to get me to stop, I get it. I would do it too. So it's all good. It's part of it. Get through yesterday and try to do it again today and see what happens." Berry has always loved this part of the game, dating to his playing days. He always tried to create chaos when on base and looking to steal. PitchCom has neutralized many of the ways hitters and base runners could affect the game by picking up things on the bases. "It requires a lot of studying, no doubt," Berry said. "And then that's part of everybody trying to clean up their own stuff. Everybody's trying to make sure because if it is a thing, it's an advantage, and you don't want it to come back and catch you later in the season, especially when it's time for playoffs. So it's always good for everybody to take notice of stuff and get it before it becomes a problem." From the Cubs' perspective, this is just part of the game. The Cubs know they have had pitch tipping used against them this season, too, mostly frequently during Shota Imanaga's starts, including Sunday against the Seattle Mariners — which contributed to him lasting only two-plus innings for the short-



Diamondbacks bench coach Jeff Bannister, left, talks with Cubs third-base coach Quintin Berry at Chase Field on Tuesday in Phoenix. **MEGHAN MONTEMURRO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

est outing of his career. Every team is looking for an on-field edge. "It is a really frustrating thing when another team has a pitch or your pitches, and it's happened to us this year at times with other teams, and I'm sure times that we haven't been aware of it too," Cubs infielder Nico Hoerner told the Tribune. "Sometimes there's a gray area. I feel like the game is in a pretty understood place of what's happening on the field is fair game, and the league's obviously been strict about coaches and the coaching box. Like, you shouldn't have coaches on the outfield grass, in the dugout or way out of position. It's very frustrating when you're on the other side of it. But every team, I feel like, has the same resources." As the Cubs see it, it's on every other team to prevent the other side from picking up on something their pitcher might be doing. Being proactive and understanding what cues another team might try to exploit from the pitcher — anything from their glove positioning on different pitch types to the catcher's setup — is on the Cubs to hone in on. Pitching coach Tommy Hottovy takes it personally if a team is able to pick up something on their pitchers. "If that happens for us, I'm not mad at the other team," Hottovy

said to the Tribune. "They're doing what they can to get a competitive advantage. It's on me as a coach to help fix it and identify what's wrong, identify how we can make it better. We want to be the best team at controlling that part of the game. It's everywhere now, so you have to stay on top, and no one's going to be perfect." It's been a focal point for the Cubs all season. Hottovy said they talked a lot during spring training about controlling the running game, holding runners, not being predictable on pickoffs and varying their times to the plate. He views preventing pitch tipping as another layer to those efforts. Hottovy told all the Cubs pitchers in big-league camp that at some point this season they could expect him to come to them to talk about a pitch they're tipping. Monday's theatrics are a reminder of the small margins every team is searching for to swing in their favor. "It's the norm now, so being able to have a Plan B or a different setup or something you can go to to combat that is part of the game," Hottovy said. "And that's our job as pitching coaches, to make sure that we're on top of what our guys are doing, that we're watching video and making sure that we're in a good place, but also have plans in place when teams do pick up something."

CUBS

from Page C1

they're supposed to talk about it, figure it out, and get it right. And they didn't. ... I think they find new ways to screw something up every day. "Now, it's not to take away from what Eduardo was doing to us today because he was All-Star Eduardo Rodríguez, and he was nails. So when a guy is shoving it down your throat, you've got to find any way you can to make something happen, and that's exactly what I was just trying to do. And I executed, and it would have been nice if the umpires did the same." Márquez, via a pool reporter, acknowledged the umpires missed the balk call on Rodríguez, which would have advanced Crow-Armstrong home for a 1-0 Cubs lead. No part of the balk sequence was allowed to be requested by the umpires for video review in New York. "We just didn't see it," Márquez said. "After looking at the video (postgame), it looked like he stepped off." Although Busch ended up drawing a walk, Nico Hoerner struck out



Cubs manager Craig Counsell, right, argues with plate umpire Alfonso Márquez in the sixth inning against the Diamondbacks on Wednesday in Phoenix. **ROSS D. FRANKLIN/AP**

to end the inning. Diamondbacks center fielder Jordan Lawlar delivered a blow four pitches later by taking Matthew Boyd deep for a solo home run. The Diamondbacks added a run on a sacrifice fly in the eighth off reliever Ryan Zeferjahn while the Cubs (76-58) never got much going in their two-hit defeat

to finish the trip 2-4, which featured three walk-off losses. "They flat out missed it," manager Craig Counsell said. "It's obvious to everybody on TV. It's obvious to anybody. They missed it. I don't even know what to say. It's hard to argue when they just flat out miss it. The umpires said he did

not disengage from the rubber. He disengaged from the rubber in his windup. Tough call for the home plate and second-base umpire. Easy call for the first- and third-base umpire." When informed at his locker postgame Márquez admitted they missed the balk call, Crow-Arm-

strong said hearing that didn't make him feel any better. "They had as much time as they wanted to talk about it on the field," Crow-Armstrong said. "so they should have admitted that right after they got it wrong." The Cubs wasted a stellar performance from their three starters against the Diamondbacks. Kevin Gausman, Clay Holmes and Boyd combined to allow just one run in 20 innings. They get the chance to regroup from their wasted chances to pick up a few more wins on the road with Thursday's off day in Chicago leading into three games against the Cincinnati Reds and a huge four-game series versus the division-leading Milwaukee Brewers. Crow-Armstrong wasn't pleased by his performance in the series loss. He finished 1-for-12 with one walk and three strikeouts. "If I'm going to sit here and bitch about all this stuff, I should have done better today," Crow-Armstrong said. "Shouldn't have punched out three times. I should have had better at-bats all series. I was pretty nonexistent. So, I think you guys just saw my frustrations from the last three days kind of come out, and I'm going to stick by it and say rightfully so."

BASEBALL

AMERICAN LEAGUE									
EAST DIVISION									
	W	L	Pct	GB	WCGB	L10	Str	Home	Away
Tampa Bay	79	54	.594	—	—	5-5	W-1	43-23	36-31
New York	74	57	.565	4	+7½	6-4	L-1	33-29	41-28
Boston	73	60	.549	6	+5½	7-3	L-1	34-32	39-28
Toronto	65	69	.485	14½	3	5-5	W-1	34-34	31-35
Baltimore	64	68	.485	14½	3	5-5	W-1	34-34	30-34
CENTRAL DIVISION									
	W	L	Pct	GB	WCGB	L10	Str	Home	Away
Chicago	69	63	.523	—	—	5-5	W-1	40-27	29-36
Cleveland	68	66	.507	2	—	8-2	W-7	31-34	37-32
Minnesota	64	69	.481	5½	3½	4-6	L-1	35-31	29-38
Detroit	62	71	.466	7½	5½	2-8	L-1	33-33	29-38
Kansas City	59	75	.440	11	9	9-1	L-1	36-30	23-45
WEST DIVISION									
	W	L	Pct	GB	WCGB	L10	Str	Home	Away
Houston	66	66	.500	—	—	4-6	W-1	33-35	33-31
Texas	66	67	.496	½	1½	6-4	L-1	36-29	30-38
Seattle	64	70	.478	3	4	6-4	L-1	37-31	27-39
Athletics	52	81	.391	14½	15½	4-6	W-1	24-41	28-40
Los Angeles	52	82	.388	15	16	3-7	L-4	29-39	23-43

BOX SCORES

Rays 3, Tigers 0

Tampa Bay	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
Diaz dh	4	0	0	0	0	0	.301
Aranda 1b	3	1	2	0	0	0	.280
Caminero 3b	4	0	2	0	0	1	.280
Hicks c	3	0	1	1	0	1	.286
1-Piper pr	0	0	0	0	0	0	.250
Fortes c	0	0	0	0	0	0	.263
Simpson lf	3	1	1	0	0	0	.308
DeLuca rf	4	1	1	0	1	.277	
Palacios 2b	3	0	0	0	0	0	.228
Mateo ss	3	0	0	0	0	1	.231
Mullins cf	3	0	1	0	0	0	.205
Totals	30	3	8	3	0	4	
Detroit	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
Callahan lf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.261
McGonigle ss	4	0	0	0	0	1	.278
Torres 2b	3	0	0	0	0	0	.258
Keith dh	3	0	0	0	0	1	.264
Dingler c	3	0	1	0	0	0	.254
McKinstiry rf	3	0	0	0	0	0	.216
Torkelson 1b	3	0	0	0	0	3	.223
Clark cf	3	0	0	0	0	0	.239
Lee 3b	3	0	0	0	0	0	.272
Totals	29	0	2	0	0	6	

TB	020	001	000	—	3	8	0
DET	000	000	000	—	0	2	0

1-ran for Hicks in the 9th.

LOB: Tampa Bay 4, Detroit 2; **2B:** DeLuca (20), Aranda (21); **RBI:** DeLuca (38), Mullins (40), Hicks (73); **SF:** Hicks; **S:** Palacios, Simpson.

Runners left in scoring position: Tampa Bay 1 (Palacios), Detroit 0 for 0; **RISP:** Tampa Bay 2 for 6, Detroit 0 for 0, **GIDP:** Hicks. **DP:** Detroit 1 (Torkelson, McGonigle).

Tampa Bay	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Peralta	6	2	0	0	0	4	81	5.11
Kelly	2	0	0	0	0	1	23	2.04
Wells	1	0	0	0	0	1	15	2.66
Detroit	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Melton	7	7	3	3	0	4	84	1.86
Kinley	1	0	0	0	0	0	10	3.92
Finnegan	1	1	0	0	0	0	12	3.31
W: Peralta 6-11; L: Melton 7-3; SV: Wells 5-5 HBP: Melton (Aranda).								
ABS Challenge:	Melton	(Ball-Overturned to Strike), McGonigle (Strike-Overturned to Ball), Kelly (Ball-Overturned to Strike), Clark (Strike-Overturned to Ball), Callahan (Strike-Confirmed), Wells (Ball-Confirmed).						
Umpires: HP, Adrian Johnson. 1B, Dexter Kelley. 2B, Quinn Wolcott. 3B, Paul Clemmons. T: 2:02; A: 21,482 (41,083).								

Marlins 4, Red Sox 0

Boston	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
Sogard 1b	4	0	0	0	0	1	.267
Rafaela cf	4	0	0	0	0	1	.285
Abreu rf	3	0	0	0	1	0	.252
Durbin 3b	4	0	2	0	0	0	.256
Gasper dh	3	0	0	0	1	0	.275
Monasterio ss	2	0	1	0	1	0	.255
Duran lf	3	0	1	0	0	0	.210
a-White ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.234
Seigler 2b	3	0	1	0	0	1	.252
b-Jones ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.215
Wong c	3	0	0	0	0	0	.246
Totals	31	0	5	0	3	4	
Miami	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
Stowers dh	3	1	1	0	2	2	.242
Conine 1b	5	0	0	0	0	2	.253
Hernández lf	4	0	2	1	0	1	.234
Edwards 2b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.286
Marsee cf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.211
Lopez ss	4	2	2	0	0	0	.308
Caissie rf	4	0	0	0	0	0	.225
1-Ruz pr-rf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.241
Mack c	3	0	0	0	1	2	.233
Sanoja 3b	4	0	3	1	0	0	.280
Totals	35	4	10	2	3	8	
BOS	000	000	000	—	0	5	4
MIA	110	000	02x	—	4	10	0

a-struck out for Duran in the 9th. b-grounded out for Seigler in the 9th.

1-ran for Caissie in the 8th.

E: Sogard 2 (3), Wong 2 4; **LOB:** Boston 9, Miami 10; **2B:** Marsee (15); **RBI:** Hernández (55), Sanoja (51); **SB:** Sanoja 3 (9), Hernández (9).

Runners left in scoring position: Boston 5 (Sogard 2, Monasterio, Seigler, Wong), Miami 7 (Caissie, Conine 3, Edwards, Marsee 2); **RISP:** Boston 0 for 4, Miami 2 for 14.

Runners moved up: Jones, Conine, Edwards, Mack; **GIDP:** Gasper.

DP: Miami 1 (Edwards, Lopez, Conine).

Boston	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Gray	5	7	2	2	1	5	93	2.82
Morán	2	1	0	0	1	2	33	2.89
Olds	1	2	2	0	1	1	25	0.00
Miami	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Gusto	5½	4	0	0	3	2	89	3.98
Vodnik	1½	0	0	0	0	1	13	4.84
Junk	1	0	0	0	0	0	8	4.21
Fulton	1	1	0	0	0	1	10	4.20
W: Gusto 1-3; L: Gray 16-4.								
Inherited runners-scored:	Vodnik 2-0; HBP:	Gusto 2 (Wong,Monasterio).						
ABS Challenge:	Gusto	(Ball-Overturned to Strike), Seigler (Strike-Overturned to Ball), Gusto (Ball-Confirmed), Gray (Ball-Overturned to Strike), Seigler (Strike-Confirmed), Durbin (Strike-Con-firmed).						
Umpires: Home, Manny Gonzalez. First, Tom Hanahan. Second, Ron Kulpa. Third, David Rackley. T: 2:38; A: 17,472 (37,446).								

AMERICAN LEAGUE LEADERS

through Tuesday's games

BATTING AVERAGE	G	AB	R	H	AVG	
Alvarez	Hou	130	468	151	88	.328
C.Simpson	TB	124	465	143	50	.303
Ya.Diaz	TB	127	501	152	76	.303
DeLauter	Cle	110	413	119	52	.288
Rafaela	Bos	127	504	145	67	.288
Witt	KC	114	445	128	72	.288
Clement	Tor	129	494	140	54	.283
Contreras	Bos	121	420	118	66	.281
McGonigle	Det	128	492	138	84	.280
Caminero	TB	132	503	140	81	.278
Home Runs: Alvarez, Houston, 36, Caminero, Tampa Bay, 35, Rice, New York, 34, Alonso, Baltimore, 31, Murakami, Chicago, 29, M.Vargas, Chicago, 29, C.Montgomery, Chicago, 27, Contreras, Boston, 26, Dingler, Detroit, 26, Okamoto, Toronto, 26.						
RBI: Alvarez, Houston, 91, Alonso, Baltimore, 89, Caminero, Tampa Bay, 84, Dingler, Detroit, 82, Rice, New York, 82, Bell, Minnesota, 80, Adell, Cleveland, 80, Contreras, Boston, 78, Aranda, Tampa Bay, 78, Burger, Texas, 76.						
Pitching: S.Gray, Boston, 16-3, Rasmussen, Tampa Bay, 14-5, N.Martinez, Tampa Bay, 13-4, G.Williams, Cleveland, 12-7, Schlittler, New York, 11-6, L.Gilbert, Seattle, 11-7, Soriano, Toronto, 10-7, Messick, Cleveland, 10-8, Eovaldi, Texas, 10-9, B.Young, Baltimore, 9-3.						

NATIONAL LEAGUE									
EAST DIVISION									
	W	L	Pct	GB	WCGB	L10	Str	Home	Away
Atlanta	77	55	.583	—	—	4-6	W-2	43-23	34-32
Philadelphia	74	60	.552	4	+2	8-2	W-1	38-30	36-30
Miami	68	66	.507	10	4	5-5	W-1	42-27	26-39
Washington	62	73	.459	16½	10½	2-8	L-2	28-38	34-35
New York	60	72	.455	17	11	7-3	W-1	31-35	29-37
CENTRAL DIVISION									
	W	L	Pct	GB	WCGB	L10	Str	Home	Away
Milwaukee	81	51	.614	—	—	6-4	L-2	45-24	36-27
Chicago	76	58	.567	6	+4	4-6	L-2	38-27	38-31
St. Louis	66	67	.496	15½	5½	4-6	L-4	32-35	34-32
Pittsburgh	65	70	.481	17½	7½	5-5	L-1	34-32	31-38
Cincinnati	63	71	.470	19	9	4-6	W-1	32-36	31-35
WEST DIVISION									
	W	L	Pct	GB	WCGB	L10	Str	Home	Away
Los Angeles	80	52	.606	—	—	7-3	L-1	40-26	40-26
San Diego	72	62	.537	9	—	6-4	W-1	41-28	31-34
Arizona	71	63	.530	10	1	5-5	W-2	40-29	31-34
San Francisco	54	79	.406	26½	17½	3-7	L-1	31-34	23-45
Colorado	52	81	.391	28½	19½	3-7	W-2	27-38	25-43

Late Tuesday: Rockies 3, Nationals 1

Colorado	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
McCarthy lf	5	0	1	0	0	2	.292
Carrigg cf	4	0	0	0	0	3	.268
Goodman c	4	1	1	1	0	1	.251
Rumfield 1b	2	0	0	0	2	0	.286
Castro 3b	4	1	1	0	0	1	.264
Norby 2b	3	0	1	1	1	1	.218
Tovar ss	0	0	0	0	0	0	.209
Moniak dh	4	0	0	0	0	1	.257
Beck rf	4	1	2	0	0	1	.203
Ritter ss-2b	3	0	1	0	1	1	.143
Totals	33	3	7	2	4	11	
Washington	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg
Abrams dh	4	0	0	0	0	2	.276
Ortiz 1b	2	0	1	0	0	0	.221
a-Chaparro ph-1b2	0	0	0	0	0	1	.236
Crews rf-cf	4	0	1	0	1	1	.213
Lile lf-rf	3	1	2	1	1	1	.249
House 3b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.232
Vivas 2b	2	0	0	0	2	0	.237
Ford c	3	0	0	0	1	1	.190
Núñez ss	3	0	0	0	0	2	.217
c-Ruiz ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.279
Young cf	2	0	1	0	0	0	.248
b-Tena ph-lf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.233
Totals	31	1	5	1	4	10	

SCOREBOARD

NFL preseason

AMERICAN CONFERENCE

EAST DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Buffalo	2	0	0	1.000	60	21	
New England	1	0	1	.750	37	34	
N.Y. Jets	1	1	0	.500	33	24	
Miami	0	2	0	.000	10	46	
SOUTH DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Tennessee	2	0	0	1.00	38	29	
Jacksonville	1	1	0	.500	41	54	
Indianapolis	0	1	1	.250	19	47	
Houston	0	2	0	.000	27	49	
NORTH DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Cincinnati	2	0	0	1.000	43	23	
Baltimore	2	0	0	1.00	37	10	
Pittsburgh	1	1	0	.500	28	26	
Cleveland	0	2	0	.000	17	65	
WEST DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
L.A. Chargers	1	1	0	.500	44	48	
Las Vegas	1	1	0	.500	36	47	
Denver	1	1	0	.500	40	40	
Kansas City	0	2	0	.000	27	36	

NATIONAL CONFERENCE

EAST DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Dallas	2	0	0	1.000	51	20	
N.Y. Giants	1	1	0	.500	36	16	
Washington	1	1	0	.500	33	24	
Philadelphia	0	2	0	.000	28	48	
SOUTH DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Tampa Bay	2	0	0	1.000	40	31	
Carolina	2	1	0	.667	81	76	
Atlanta	1	1	0	.500	41	33	
New Orleans	0	2	0	.000	20	58	
NORTH DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
Detroit	1	1	0	.500	31	29	
Minnesota	1	1	0	.500	16	23	
Green Bay	1	1	0	.500	42	41	
Chicago	1	1	0	.500	43	37	
WEST DIVISION							
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA	
L.A. Rams	2	0	0	1.00	54	12	
San Francisco	1	1	0	.500	54	36	
Arizona	1	2	0	.333	70	81	
Seattle	0	2	0	.000	23	36	

WEEK 3

THURSDAY'S GAMES

Pittsburgh at Buffalo, 6 p.m.
New England at Cleveland (Prime), 7 p.m.
San Francisco at Las Vegas, 7 p.m.
L.A. Rams at L.A. Chargers, 9 p.m.
FRIDAY'S GAMES
Washington at Baltimore, 5 p.m.
Houston at Carolina, 6 p.m.
Atlanta at Miami, 6 p.m.
Tampa Bay at Jacksonville, 6 p.m.
N.Y. Giants at N.Y. Jets, 6 p.m.
New Orleans at Dallas, 7 p.m.
Arizona at Green Bay, 7 p.m.
Seattle at Kansas City, 7 p.m.
Cincinnati at Philadelphia (CBS), 7 p.m.
Minnesota at Denver, 8 p.m.
SATURDAY'S GAMES
Detroit at Indianapolis, noon
Chicago at Tennessee, 5 p.m.

Golf

TOUR CHAMPIONSHIP

Site: Atlanta.				
Course: East Lake GC.				
Yardage: 7,440. Par: 70.				
Prize money: \$40 million. Winner's share: \$10 million.				
Defending champion: Tommy Fleetwood.				
Next tournament: Biltmore Championship Asheville on Sept. 17-20.				
Rk-FedEx Cup ranking; Pts-FedEx Cup points; OW-WR-official world golf rankings ranking; Odds-FanDuel odds to win event.				
Golfer	RK	WR	Pts	Odds
Scottie Scheffler	1	1	4,986	35-1
Matt Fitzpatrick	2	4	3,463	22-1
Wyndham Clark	3	5	3,292	16-1
Cameron Young	4	3	3,206	20-1
Si Woo Kim	5	13	2,729	27-1
Chris Gotterup	6	8	2,588	22-1
Collin Morikawa	7	10	2,542	20-1
Sam Burns	8	9	2,453	15-1
Tommy Fleetwood	9	7	2,263	18-1
Ludwig Aberg	10	17	2,198	20-1
Rory McIlroy	11	2	2,095	19-2
Xander Schauffele	12	11	2,025	12-1
Jacob Bridgeman	13	28	1,961	70-1
Russell Henley	14	6	1,853	30-1
Akshay Bhatia	15	33	1,842	100-1
Hideki Matsuyama	16	24	1,637	30-1
Ryan Gerard	17	27	1,608	45-1
Gary Woodland	18	42	1,556	45-1
Patrick Cantlay	19	26	1,529	18-1
Kristoffer Reitan	20	30	1,523	60-1
Min Woo Lee	21	31	1,496	44-1
J.J. Spain	22	16	1,464	40-1
Alex Smalley	23	46	1,443	65-1
Alex Fitzpatrick	24	68	1,434	100-1
Robert Macintyre	25	18	1,428	55-1
Viktor Hovland	26	15	1,425	27-1
Justin Rose	27	14	1,405	45-1
Adam Scott	28	51	1,383	45-1
Tom Kim	29	29	1,378	45-1
Ryan Fox	30	25	1,368	100-1

PGA TOUR STATISTICS

SCORING AVERAGE

1, Scottie Scheffler, 68.654. 2, Rory McIlroy, 69.351. 3, Collin Morikawa, 69.468. 4, Matt Fitzpatrick, 69.524. 5, Sam Burns, 69.689. 6, Wyndham Clark, 69.698. 7, Chris Gotterup, 69.711. 8, Tommy Fleetwood, 69.723. 9, Xander Schauffele, 69.738. 10, Si Woo Kim, 69.759.

DRIVING DISTANCE

1, Aldrich Potgieter, 331.1. 2, Rory McIlroy, 330. 3, Michael Brennan, 327.1. 4, Nicolai Hojgaard, 325.1. 5, Marco Penge, 325. 6, Gary Woodland, 322.2. 7, (tie), Rasmus Hojgaard and Min Woo Lee, 323. 9, Chris Gotterup, 322.6. 10, Johnny Keefe, 319.7.

Odds

MLB			
Favorite	Line		Underdog
Thursday			
American League			
at NY Yankees	-155/+130		Houston
Kansas City	-109/-108		at Toronto
National League			
Colorado	-116/-102	at Washington	
Milwaukee	-225/+188	at NY Mets	
LA Dodgers	-110/-108	at Atlanta	
at San Fran.	Off/Off	Arizona	
Interleague			
at St. Louis	Off/Off	Baltimore	

NFL Preseason

Favorite	Line (O/U)	Underdog
Thursday		
at Buffalo	2½ (35½)	Pittsburgh
New England	2½ (35½)	at Cleveland
at Las Vegas	3½ (37½)	San Fran.
at LA Chargers	3½ (38½)	LA Rams
Friday		
at Baltimore	3½ (34½)	Washington
Houston	1½ (36½)	at Carolina
Atlanta	3½ (36½)	at Miami
Tampa Bay	3 (35½)	at Jacksonville
NY Giants	3 (36½)	at NY Jets
at Dallas	1½ (38½)	New Orleans
Arizona	2½ (37½)	at Green Bay
Seattle	2½ (36½)	at Kansas City
at Philadelphia	2½ (36½)	Cincinnati
at Denver	6½ (39½)	Minnesota
Saturday		
at Indianapolis	3½ (35½)	Detroit
at Tennessee	2½ (36½)	Chicago
College Football		
Favorite	Line	Underdog
Saturday		
at TCU	8½ (47)	N Carolina
at USC	39½ (50½)	San Jose St
at Virginia	4½ (53½)	NC State
at N Dakota St	7 (46½)	Jacksonville
at E Michigan	9½ (52½)	Sacramento St
at Stanford	3½ (48½)	Hawaii
at Florida St	31½ (53½)	N. Mexico St
at UNLV	4½ (56½)	Memphis

WNBA

EASTERN CONFERENCE

Team	W	L	Pct	GB
x-Atlanta	25	13	.658	—
x-Indiana	25	14	.641	½
x-New York	23	15	.605	2
x-Washington	23	15	.605	2
Chicago	15	24	.385	10½
Toronto	11	26	.297	13½
Connecticut	10	28	.263	15

WESTERN CONFERENCE

Team	W	L	Pct	GB
x-Minnesota	31	8	.795	—
x-Golden State	27	11	.711	3½
x-Las Vegas	26	13	.667	5
x-Dallas	23	16	.590	8
Portland	15	23	.395	15½
Los Angeles	13	25	.342	17½
Phoenix	13	25	.342	17½
Seattle	7	31	.184	23½

x-clinched playoff spot

WEDNESDAY'S RESULTS
Golden State 89, Connecticut 64
Toronto at Seattle, late

THURSDAY'S GAMES
Golden State at New York, 7 p.m.
Washington at Phoenix, 9 p.m.

FRIDAY'S GAMES
Connecticut at Indiana, 6:30 p.m.
Portland at Atlanta, 6:30 p.m.
Toronto at Las Vegas, 9 p.m.
Washington at Los Angeles, 9 p.m.

SATURDAY'S GAMES
Chicago at New York, noon
Toronto at Phoenix, 9 p.m.

TUESDAY'S RESULTS
Connecticut 87, Chicago 81
Dallas 96, Portland 78
Washington 94, Phoenix 84

Soccer

MLS

Eastern	W	L	T	Pts	GF	GA
Nashville	15	2	4	49	43	17
Miami	11	4	6	39	49	40
Chicago	11	6	3	36	37	26
N. England	10	7	4	34	33	26
Charlotte	9	7	5	32	38	32
Cincinnati	8	6	7	31	49	47
NYFC	7	8	6	27	35	30
NY Red Bulls	7	9	5	26	31	43
Orlando	7	11	3	24	34	51
Toronto	5	7	9	24	31	37
D.C. United	5	7	9	24	28	36
Atlanta	6	12	3	21	25	36
Philadelphia	5	10	6	21	31	38
Montréal	5	10	6	21	29	39
Columbus	5	11	5	20	30	36
Western	W	L	T	Pts	GF	GA
Vancouver	12	4	4	40	45	18
Houston	12	7	2	38	30	26
LAFC	10	7	5	35	36	22
San Jose	10	8	3	33	39	33
Dallas	9	6	6	33	38	34
St Louis City	9	6	6	33	30	27
Colorado	9	11	1	28	30	28
Salt Lake	8	8	4	28	34	32
Portland	8	9	4	28	38	37
Minnesota	7	7	7	28	27	29
San Diego	7	8	6	27	37	32
LA Galaxy	6	8	8	26	27	32
Seattle	7	9	4	25	22	27
Austin	5	10	6	21	26	40
Kansas City	4	14	3	15	20	51

Three points for victory, one point for tie.

SATURDAY'S MATCHES
Chicago at Seattle, 3:30 p.m.
Charlotte FC at Atlanta, 6:30 p.m.
New England at Columbus, 6:30 p.m.
Los Angeles FC at D.C. United, 6:30 p.m.
CF Montréal at Miami, 6:30 p.m.
Philadelphia at New York, 6:30 p.m.
New York City FC at Toronto FC, 6:30 p.m.
San Jose at Houston, 7:30 p.m.
Vancouver at Sporting KC, 7:30 p.m.
Orlando City at Minnesota, 7:30 p.m.
Cincinnati at Nashville, 7:30 p.m.
Real Salt Lake at Colorado, 8:30 p.m.
Austin FC at Portland, 9:30 p.m.
LA Galaxy at San Diego FC, 9:30 p.m.

SUNDAY'S MATCH
FC Dallas at St Louis City, 6 p.m.

FRIDAY, SEPT. 4
Nashville at New York City FC, 6:30 p.m.

SATURDAY, SEPT. 5
Houston at Charlotte FC, 6:30 p.m.
D.C. United at Cincinnati, 6:30 p.m.
Colorado at Columbus, 6:30 p.m.
Atlanta at Miami, 6:30 p.m.
San Diego FC at Orlando City, 6:30 p.m.
CF Montréal at Philadelphia, 6:30 p.m.
Chicago at Toronto FC, 6:30 p.m.
San Jose at Austin FC, 7:30 p.m.
Sporting KC at FC Dallas, 7:30 p.m.
New York at Seattle, 7:30 p.m.
New England at LA Galaxy, 8:30 p.m.
Los Angeles FC at Real Salt Lake, 8:30 p.m.
Minnesota at Portland, 9:30 p.m.
St Louis City at Vancouver, 9:30 p.m.

NWSL

Club	W	L	T	Pts	GF	GA
Gotham	13	3	5	44	26	13
Washington	11	6	4	37	30	19
Portland	11	6	4	37	35	29
Utah	11	7	3	36	37	27
San Diego	11	7	3	36	29	23
N. Carolina	11	7	3	36	38	30
Kansas City	9	8	4	31	32	29
Seattle	8	8	4	28	25	26
Angel City	7	8	5	26	27	22
Houston	7	9	5	26	28	29
Orlando	8	11	2	26	25	31
Denver	6	8	6	24	25	26
Louisville	7	12	2	23	32	40
Bay	6	10	4	22	21	27
Boston	5	11	5	20	24	34
Chicago	5	15	1	16	12	41

Three points for victory, one point for tie.

WEDNESDAY'S RESULT

North Carolina 2, Angel City 0

FRIDAY'S MATCHES

Portland at Gotham FC, 7 p.m.
Louisville at San Diego, 9 p.m.

SATURDAY'S MATCHES

North Carolina at Kansas City, 5:30 p.m.
Utah Royals FC at Orlando, 6 p.m.
Chicago at Denver Summit FC, 7:45 p.m.

SUNDAY'S MATCHES

Bay FC at Washington, 11:30 a.m.
Houston at Seattle, 6 p.m.

MONDAY'S MATCH

Angel City at Boston Legacy FC, 7 p.m.

FRIDAY, SEPT. 4

Boston Legacy FC at Utah FC, 8:30 p.m.
Kansas City at Bay FC, 9 p.m.

SATURDAY, SEPT. 5

Angel City at Louisville, 5:30 p.m.

SUNDAY, SEPT. 6

Gotham FC at Denver Summit FC, 1 p.m.
Washington at Portland, 3 p.m.
North Carolina at Chicago, 3 p.m.
Houston at Orlando, 6 p.m.
San Diego at Seattle, 8 p.m.

ENGLISH PREMIER LEAGUE

Club</

NATIONAL SPORTS REPORT

SHORTS

VANDERSLOOT REACHES 3,000 ASSISTS IN SKY LOSS

UNCASVILLE, Conn. — Aaliyah Edwards scored a career-high 26 points to go with 10 rebounds, and Diamond Miller added 21 points as the Connecticut Sun beat the Chicago Sky 87-81 on Tuesday. The Sun had a 78-58 lead — their largest of the game — early in the fourth quarter before the Sky clawed within 82-79 with 2:20 left after a 21-4 run. The Sun scored the next four points, highlighted by Edwards’ block and layup for a seven-point lead. Kennedy Burke added 19 points for the Sun (10-27). Edwards was 11 of 16 from the field in 26 minutes and eclipsed her previous best of 24 points. Britney Griner (left knee) and Olivia Nelson-Ododa (right knee) did not play. Kamilla Cardoso led the Sky (15-24) with 24 points and 13 rebounds for her 14th double-double this season. Azurá Stevens added 18 points. Courtney Vandersloot became the second player in WNBA history to reach 3,000 career assists, doing so with the highest average per game. The Sun led 44-29 at halftime after holding the Sky to 33% shooting, including 0 of 12 from 3-point range. Sun starters Edwards (15 points), Burke (11) and Miller (10) combined to outscore the Sky 36-29 in the first half.

US OPEN CELEBRATES FEDERER ON CENTER COURT

Five-time U.S. Open champ Roger Federer returned to Arthur Ashe Stadium on Tuesday night to play one last match for fun against longtime rival and friend Andy Roddick. The event billed as “An Icon Returns to New York” packed the stands full of fans there to watch the 45-year-old from Switzerland face 2003 champ Roddick — soon to be 44 — in a prime-time exhibition. Many wore hats with the distinctive “RF” logo that became commonplace in the sport during Federer’s decade and a half of dominance featuring 20 Grand Slam titles. “It’s great to be back in New York,” Federer said. “I have incredible memories of this court, the fans here, of the city.” Federer reminisced about visiting for the first time to play juniors in 1998 and reaching the final. Three years later, his debut on center court was a straight-sets loss to Andre Agassi. In 2005, Federer defeated Agassi to win the U.S. Open for the second of five titles in a row. Roddick credited the fans and Federer for his return. Federer, who retired in 2022 and will be inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame this weekend, then teamed up with John McEnroe and faced Roddick and Agassi in a doubles exhibition.

GOLD MEDALIST LIU TAKING BREAK, WILL RETURN

Olympic figure skating champion Alysa Liu is taking the season off following her triumph in Milan. This time, she is certain she will be back. The 21-year-old from California made history in February when she became the first American woman since Sarah Hughes in 2002 to stand atop the podium at the Winter Games. Liu also became the first women’s skater to win two golds in the same Olympics when she was part of the U.S. squad that successfully defended its team gold medal. It was a remarkable comeback for Liu, a one-time teen phenom who abruptly walked away from figure skating after the 2022 Beijing Olympics. Liu had become burned out by the grind of the sport and had no designs on ever returning to the ice. Yet she returned in 2024 with a fresh, effervescent outlook on the sport, and it carried her all the way to the Olympic title. It’s not uncommon for figure skaters to take a season off following the Olympics. Liu had been scheduled to begin her season at Skate America on Nov. 13. “Taking time so you can live life to the fullest and do things your way ... Love you girl,” three-time U.S. champ Amber Glenn wrote in reply to Liu’s announcement. — Associated Press

EXPLAINER



Tight end Dae'Quan Wright participates in a drill at the Eagles’ rookie minicamp in May. Wright, who was released by the Eagles and later also the Browns, recently filed a lawsuit to return to college for a fifth year and play for LSU. CHRIS SZAGOLA/AP

Back to school rules

As conferences take stand, can athletes turn pro, then return to college anyway?

By Eddie Pells
ASSOCIATED PRESS

These used to be among the fundamental facts about going to college in America: College lasts four years. And though that timeline had been flexible when it comes to sports, there was never much debate over the notion that once a player moved on to the pros, their days as a college athlete were over. A recent rule passed by the NCAA has resulted in confusion, lawsuits and the once unthinkable notion of players leaving college, signing with professional teams and then turning around to head back to college. Among this week’s headline grabbers were Dae’Quan Wright and Zxavian Harris, a pair of undrafted players out of Mississippi who had tryouts in the NFL over the summer, hoping to play this season at Ole Miss’ rival in the SEC, LSU. Wright and Harris are among a number of college athletes who have sued for the right to return to college to play as the start of both the college football and NFL seasons approach. Their moves, however, might not work out, as both the SEC and Big Ten passed new rules Tuesday barring pros from heading back to college in some sports, including football. On Wednesday, the Big 12 voted to ban pros from returning to play in any sport, while the ACC was considering its move. Still, the rules themselves could be challenged in court. Also on Wednesday, the NFL reiterated its policy that players who go back to college will be ineligible to play in the league that same season and would become a free agent for the next season. A quick look at how we got here:

NCAA GIVES ATHLETES 5 YEARS OF ELIGIBILITY
This part happened in June, and

by the NCAA’s plodding standards, it happened quite fast. The rule now allows athletes to play five seasons over the span of five years. Most college athletes now see the “clock” start on their eligibility either when they enroll full-time in college or at the start of the regular school year immediately following their 19th birthday, whichever comes first. The rule itself isn’t all that outlandish. A lot of players were taking redshirt years (and getting extensions due to the pandemic) to prolong their eligibility to five, six years and more, so putting some guardrails around it made some sense. But the NCAA’s decision to start applying this new rule to athletes who graduated high school in 2023 is what caused the chaos. By not including those from the Class of ’22, many of whom saw their fourth and final year of eligibility end after last school year, they opened themselves up to trouble. The members of the Class of ’22 are arguing they’re being deprived of education and potential NIL financial benefits by being excluded from the rule. Meanwhile, college athletes are suddenly looking at unexpected competition for roster spots and playing time coming from a class of players they thought would be gone this season. And teams, most of which have locked in their football rosters, are seeing a potential influx of talent they didn’t expect.

LAWSUIT FILED BY THOSE WHO ONLY GOT 4 YEARS
A basketball player named Brock Wisne filed a federal class-action lawsuit, saying the NCAA violated anti-trust law by excluding that Class of ’22 from the new rule. A judge in Denver ruled in favor of Wisne, opening the door for everyone in the class to come back to college, but only to their former college. The judge left NCAA transfer portal rules intact, meaning the players couldn’t come back, enter the (currently closed) portal and find a new school. An appeals court last Friday temporarily halted that judge’s order, though that was hardly the end of the confusion.

STATE SUITS PILE UP AS WORKAROUND
Despite the federal court ruling, players across the country have filed lawsuits in state courts and many judges granted orders allowing them to come back to school. This “find a local judge” approach has generally been successful for the athlete over the last couple of years. In some cases — including the case involving Wright in Louisiana — a judge not only said the players could come back, but also ordered a weeklong reopening of the transfer portal, which gave the players a chance to shop around. Sam Ehrlich, a former lawyer who follows college sports litigation at Boise State, said the state lawsuits were filed “just in case” the federal order got overturned. It did, and that federal case had no bearing on the various state lawsuits. According to Ehrlich’s College Sports Litigation Tracker, at least 26 eligibility cases have been filed in state and county courts. In at least 10 of those, judges have granted a restraining order or injunction favoring the players. In only one — involving basketball player Filip Borovicinanin — has an appeals court overturned the initial decision, leading to a favorable outcome for the NCAA.

WHEN WILL THIS ALL BE DECIDED?
Court cases move slowly, and in the Wisne case, odds are nothing will be final until long after football season is over and there’s no relief left to give to the impacted players. While football teams are madly scrambling, trying to make sense of it all, basketball teams are also feeling some pressure. Teams are allowed to start practice on Sept. 25. A notable instance of where confusion might set in is Gonzaga, which recruited two players from that Class of ’22 who (presumably) had their eligibility restored. One, however, is Javon Bennett, who was part of the Borovicinanin lawsuit that an Ohio court overturned. The other is Chauncey Wiggins, who comes from Florida State and was part of a case in Georgia, where the ruling favorable to the players remains in force.

SOCCER

Europeans won’t boycott FIFA over failed investor plan

ASSOCIATED PRESS

European soccer body UEFA is set to formally withdraw its threat to boycott FIFA competitions after receiving assurances Gianni Infantino’s failed World Cup sell-off plan will not be revived. UEFA’s member federations are meeting Thursday in Monaco ahead of the Champions League draw, where they are expected to end the boycott threat, a person familiar with the proposal told The Associated Press on Wednesday. The person spoke on condition of anonymity because the agenda of the closed-doors meeting was confidential. Ruling out a boycott will clear six European teams to continue preparing for the FIFA Under-20 Women’s World Cup that kicks off Sept. 5 in Poland. France and Spain named their squads last week for the 24-nation tournament which risked becoming an unwanted battleground in European soccer’s pushback against Infantino’s private investor plan. England, Italy, Portugal and host Poland also will play. The United States, Brazil and Argentina also are in the lineup. FIFA welcomed the update from UEFA in a statement, adding it “strongly believes that football has the power to unite, even in challenging circumstances, and looks forward to welcoming all teams and players to Poland.” Infantino infuriated soccer leaders worldwide last month when his plan for a \$20 billion subsidiary controlling FIFA commercial rights including the World Cup was revealed by British daily The Times. The spinoff was to be 20% owned by investors led by a New York fund created by Joshua Kushner, whose initial money was to pay offers of \$20 million to each of FIFA’s 211 member federations. They were given a mid-September deadline to accept. Kushner is the brother of United States President Donald Trump’s son-in-law Jared Kushner. The FIFA president dropped his proposal within four days amid a furious backlash led by UEFA, including the boycott threat, with support from the Asian Football Confederation and North American soccer body CONCACAF. The furor was fueled by criticism of the plan and of Infantino from senior FIFA officials. UEFA then said it wanted assurances the spinoff, to be called FIFA Forward Enterprise, would not be presented in a different form. That assurance was now received, the person told the AP. The European soccer body said Aug. 1 it had no confidence in Infantino’s leadership in a clear signal it would try to stop his reelection in March next year. The next set of FIFA competition games in Europe after the Under-20s event is qualifying playoffs for the 2027 Women’s World Cup scheduled Oct. 9-13. Qualifying games for the next men’s World Cup do not start until 2029.



FIFA President Gianni Infantino’s reelection chances remain uncertain even after his withdrawal of a plan to sell financial stakes in the global soccer organization’s top events, including the World Cup. TERESA SUAREZ/AP 2026

ELECTION TIMETABLE

FIFA previously set a Nov. 18 deadline for candidates to enter the presidential contest, four months ahead of the vote by 211 member federations in Rabat, Morocco. Infantino had seemed sure to be reelected unopposed for a fourth and final term in office through 2031 until the turmoil created by his investor plan. The 55 UEFA member federations are attending the meeting in Monaco four weeks after they united in an online call to agree the threatened boycott.

WANING SUPPORT

The Italian federation became the latest in a growing list of nations to withdraw its support for Infantino. The FIGC issued a statement on Wednesday saying it would no longer back Infantino’s bid for reelection in March because of “the recent initiatives promoted by the FIFA president concerning governance and the development of international competitions.” “We will continue to work alongside UEFA and the other European federations to promote a vision of soccer based on merit, solidarity, sustainability, and the centrality of fans,” FIGC President Giovanni Malagò said. “We identify with a model of dialogue, listening, and shared responsibility that has, until now, allowed soccer to grow, innovate and at the same time defend its founding principles.” Romania followed suit on Wednesday, with the soccer federation’s executive committee voting not support Infantino for a new mandate. “FIFA needs today a new leader who can produce consensus and unity, inspire trust and who has the ability to bring us all together,” FRF President Răzvan Burleanu said at the end of the meeting. The soccer federations in England, Wales and Ireland withdrew their support for Infantino’s reelection earlier this month, while Norway has called on him to step down as well as issuing a statement with five other Nordic countries — Sweden, Finland, Denmark, Iceland and the Faeroe Islands — to say they had “lost confidence” in his leadership.